

IELTS Academic Preparation

The full teaching manual for an 8-week IELTS Academic preparation class (16 classes × 90 minutes, including a diagnostic and two timed practice tests): lesson stages and timing, board plans, drilling and concept-check questions, pair-work, error correction, differentiation, and L1 watch-outs.

4 modules · 12 lessons

16 classes · 90 min · 8 weeks

Teacher copy · not for students

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Module 1 — The Test & Foundations

Four classes that give learners a map, a starting point and two language foundations. The course opens with an orientation class and a short diagnostic (C1), run calmly and framed as a map, not a verdict. Then three workshops: the format, bands and scoring of IELTS Academic, with the myths that waste learners' time and a personal study plan built on a realistic target (C2); academic vocabulary and paraphrase, the skill behind almost every Listening and Reading answer and a quarter of the Writing and Speaking marks (C3); and grammar for a high band: a controlled range of complex sentences, the right tense for each task, and an honest look at error density (C4).

3 lessons + orientation

Lessons 1.1–1.3

Classes C1–C4

Weeks 1–2

90 min per class

Target band 6.0–7.5

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. C1 is the orientation and diagnostic class; C2–C4 teach online lessons 1.1–1.3. These are **exam-skills workshops**, so every lesson class follows the same shape: **warmer** (review) → **lead-in** → **strategy or language** clarified as Meaning / Form / Pronunciation with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **guided practice** (workbook) → **timed practice** → **self-marking** against a key or against criteria *paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors* → a **freer pair task** → **targeted feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes. If you're running late, cut the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the timed practice or the self-marking: learning to work to the clock and to judge their own answers is what this course sells.
- Present from `slides/module-1-foundations.html`. Print `materials/module-1/classroom-materials.html` before C1. It holds the picture and word flashcards, the new identity cards, the C1 icebreaker and speaking-sample interviewer card, the C2 format information-gap cards and **Myth or Fact?** cards, the C3 **Paraphrase Relay** prompt cards, the C4 **Part 3 frame** cards with observer tallies, the **Paraphrase Bingo** game and all the listening scripts.
- The diagnostic paper is `assessment/diagnostic.html`; its key, the raw-score → band conversion tables and the paraphrased Writing and Speaking criteria are in `assessment/answer-keys.html`. Both are written separately from this guide. Always follow the timings and instructions printed on the paper itself. The C1 plan below budgets about 50 minutes for its three written parts.

- ◆ The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home. The online course is self-paced; the classroom is where learners practice **under time**, get **feedback** and learn to **mark themselves**.
- ◆ **Feedback on three things**. In every freer or timed task, take notes in three columns: **accuracy** (errors to fix: *the number of students are, an increase of, informations, six comma five*), **range** (well-chosen language to praise and spread: *a considerable proportion of, give rise to, Although..., which...*) and **task** (the exam habit: a blank left on the answer sheet, three words in a two-word answer, a copied prompt, a Task 1 chart described in the wrong tense). The task column is new for most learners and often the quickest band gain. In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, never with names.
- ◆ **Self-marking is a skill, so teach it**. Learners mark their own timed practice from a key (C2, C3) or against short criteria (C4). Model it once: "Right answer, wrong spelling? In IELTS that's wrong. Right meaning, three words when the limit was two? Wrong." Honest self-marking now makes the Practice Test debriefs in C9 and C16 far more useful.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard**. The online lessons use British spellings and words (*practise, recognise, prioritise, programme, centre, urbanisation, levelled, full stop*). Teach *practice, recognize, prioritize, program, center, urbanization, leveled, period*. **Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them**. IELTS accepts British and American spelling equally; the only rule is to be consistent within one answer, so tell learners to choose one and stick to it.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Know the test → know the words → control the grammar. C1 and C2 replace rumor with facts: what the four sections are, how bands are calculated, and where marks are actually lost (blanks, word limits, the clock, the question not answered). C3 builds the one language skill that runs through all four sections: **paraphrase**, in both directions (recognizing it in Listening and Reading, producing it in Writing and Speaking). C4 adds the other half of a high band: a **reliable handful** of complex structures, used accurately. Every class ends with something learners keep: a target and a study plan (C1–C2), a paraphrase bank (C3), a personal error log (C4).

HIGH STAKES, KINDLY: TEST ANXIETY AND REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS

For many learners this test decides something big: a university place, registration in their profession, a job, where their family will live. Some have taken IELTS before and paid for it more than once. Treat that with respect, and **never** use fear as motivation ("If you don't do this, you'll fail"). Say instead: "This is a skill we can train, and we'll train it together."

Be honest about gains. In eight weeks, a gain of about **half a band** is common for learners who come to class and do the homework. A full band is possible for some, especially when most of the gap is technique (timing, word limits, answering the question), but it is **not guaranteed**, and nobody in the room should promise it, including you. (Online lesson 1.1 mentions a rule of thumb of "about 12 weeks per half band at higher levels." Both statements fit: technique gains come early and fast; vocabulary and grammar gains come slowly.) If a learner's target is 1.5 bands above their diagnostic and their test is in six weeks, talk to them privately about options: a later test date, or a plan that focuses on the one or two skills with the biggest gap.

Scores are private. Hand back diagnostic and practice-test results on folded slips. Never rank learners aloud, never display a class list of bands, and never ask anyone to share a score. The workbook **band tracker** is for the learner alone.

Personal information is optional. Learners never have to say why they need IELTS, which country they come from or what happens if they miss their target. For every personal task (the course contract intro, the study-plan interview, speaking topics) offer a **new identity card**. Migration, visas and immigration policy are never discussion topics in this course.

USING THE DIAGNOSTIC AND THE TWO PRACTICE TESTS DIAGNOSTICALLY

The course has three measurement points: the **diagnostic** (C1), **Practice Test 1** (C8: timed Listening + Reading) and **Practice Test 2** (C15–C16: all four skills). Present every one of them as information, not judgment. The diagnostic is short and "cold" (learners haven't met the format yet), so it usually **underestimates** learners; say so in advance. What matters is the pattern: which skill is weakest, which question types cost the most marks, and whether the problem is **language** (didn't understand) or **technique** (ran out of time, broke the word limit, misread the instruction). Learners record each result in the workbook band tracker and write one "next focus" line each time. Band results from the diagnostic are **estimates**: say "about 6.0" or "5.5 to 6.0," never a single number stated as fact.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print one **diagnostic** per learner ([assessment/diagnostic.html](#)) and one copy of its key and conversion tables for you ([assessment/answer-keys.html](#)). Prepare the Listening audio or script as the diagnostic instructs, and test the speaker in the room.
- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): feelings pictures and the test-day pictures (C1–C2), test vocabulary (C2), AWL word families (C3), complex-sentence frames and the band-limiting seven (C4). Cut them before C1.

- For C1: the **Find Someone Who** icebreaker (one per learner), the **speaking-sample interviewer card**, name cards, sticky dots, a phone timer, and a folder per learner to keep their diagnostic.
- For C2: the **format information-gap** cards (A/B, one pair per two learners) and the **Myth or Fact?** cards (one set per group of 3).
- For C3: **Paraphrase Relay** prompt cards (one set per pair) and **No-Echo** examiner cards. **Paraphrase Bingo** (one card per learner, A and B versions alternated) for the C4 warmer or early finishers.
- For C4: **Part 3 frame** cards and **observer tallies** (one set per group of 3), and every learner's **marked diagnostic writing sample**, returned in a folded folder: they use it privately for the error-density audit.
- Put the **new identity cards** on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- After C1, before C2: mark the Listening and Reading sections (a raw score out of the diagnostic's total, converted with the table in the answer key) and write each learner's **results slip**: L and R band estimates, one strength, one focus. Mark the writing and speaking samples against the paraphrased criteria by C4 at the latest, as a band *range*.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
—	C1 • wk 1	Orientation + diagnostic : welcome, a test-anxiety-aware introduction to the course, the course contract , a short diagnostic (Listening and Reading sections, a writing sample and a 3-minute speaking sample), and each learner's target band	explain how the course works and what they have agreed to; complete the diagnostic calmly; write down their exact target (overall and any per-skill minimum) and their test date
1.1	C2 • wk 1	IELTS overview : Academic vs General Training; the four sections and their timing; the 9-band scale and the overall-band rounding rule ; raw scores; scoring myths ; three strategic principles (the clock, no blanks, answer the question asked); the word-limit trap	describe the test's format and timing, calculate an overall band, separate facts from myths, follow a word limit under time pressure, and write a personal study plan built on their target and their gap
1.2	C3 • wk 2	Academic vocabulary & paraphrasing : the five techniques as a paraphrase ladder ; AWL-style word families and their stress; everyday → academic upgrades with natural collocation; topic banks; synonym traps in Listening and Reading questions; paraphrasing a Task 2 prompt	recognize an answer that is worded differently from the question and reject a trap that only shares a word, paraphrase a sentence using at least two techniques, choose the right member of a word family, and restate a Task 2 prompt aloud in their own words

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
1.3	C4 • wk 2	Grammar for a high band: what Grammatical Range & Accuracy rewards; the complex-structure toolkit ; tenses by task; the band-limiting seven errors; error density (how many sentences are error-free); range vs accuracy	combine simple ideas into accurate complex sentences, choose the tense each task demands, upgrade a flat paragraph without adding errors, find and fix high-frequency errors, and estimate the error density of their own writing

C1 · ORIENTATION

Welcome, the Course Contract & the Diagnostic

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ name the four sections of IELTS Academic in outline and say how this 16-class course is organized (lessons, two practice tests, online homework)
- ◆ agree to a short **course contract** with the group and know what the teacher has promised in return
- ◆ complete a short diagnostic (Listening and Reading sections, a writing sample, a 3-minute speaking sample) knowing that it is a starting map, not a verdict
- ◆ write down their exact **target band** (overall and any per-skill minimum) and their test date, and rate their confidence in each skill

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook "Welcome" pages (course map, course contract, My target card, band tracker)
- ◆ Slides 1–5 · Feelings picture cards (*nervous, worried, excited, happy*) · Find Someone Who sheets · name cards · sticky dots · New identity cards
- ◆ [assessment/diagnostic.html](#) (one per learner) · its Listening audio or script · speaking-sample interviewer card · phone timer · one folder per learner

BOARD PLAN

Left: today. 1 Welcome · 2 Our course + contract · 3 Diagnostic (Listening · Reading · Writing sample · Speaking sample, 3 min) · 4 My target. "The diagnostic is a map, not a verdict."

Center: the course. 16 classes · 8 weeks · 90 min. Module 1 Foundations → Module 2 Listening & Reading → **C8 Practice Test 1** → Module 3 Writing → Module 4 Speaking → **C15–C16 Practice Test 2**. Homework = the online lessons (📶).

Right: the gap. My target ____ (overall) · no skill below ____ · test date ____ · weeks ____ . Target – now = **my gap** (we find "now" in C2).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome and names	8	T–S → S–S	Greet learners at the door; everyone makes a name card (the name they want to be called). Find Someone Who (materials, set C): learners mingle for 5 minutes and find a classmate for each line ("...has taken a test on a computer," "...reads something in English every day," "...prefers mornings for studying"). Anyone

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			may say "Pass" to any question. Close by asking two or three learners to introduce a classmate with one fact. Note names and one strength you hear.
Feelings check	4	T-S	Slide 2 (pictures: <i>nervous, worried, excited, happy</i>). "How do you feel about the IELTS test today?" Learners put a sticky dot on the flipchart under one picture: anonymous, no names. Look at the result together: "Lots of nervous. That's normal and it's useful: it means this matters to you. Today nobody is being tested for a grade."
The course and the contract	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 4. Walk through the course map (16 classes, two practice tests, online homework with 📶). Workbook: Course contract . Read your four promises aloud first (below). Groups of 3 propose two more class agreements (for example, "Phones silent during timed practice," "We correct ideas, not people"); take one from each group to the board, agree as a class, and everyone signs. Keep it light and adult: this is an agreement, not a list of rules.
How the diagnostic works	5	T-S	Slide 3. The four parts and their times; what happens to the results (L and R bands on a private slip in C2; writing and speaking as a band range by C4). Say the key sentence: "This is a map, not a verdict. Most people score a little lower today than they will after two weeks, because they haven't learned the format yet." Show the one-breath routine (below). ICQs.
Diagnostic: Listening	10	S	Follow the instructions printed on assessment/diagnostic.html . Play or read the recording once only, as in the real test. Don't explain vocabulary during the section.
Diagnostic: Reading	20	S	Strict time. Announce "five minutes left" once. Remind: "No penalty for wrong answers: fill every gap." (This is the first strategic principle of C2; let them feel it now.)
Diagnostic: Writing sample (+ speaking samples)	20	S · T-S	Learners write the writing sample. While they write, call learners one at a time to a side table for the 3-minute speaking sample (see "Running the speaking sample" below). Give each learner you call their missed minutes at the start of the next stage.
My target and my gap	8	S → S-S	Slide 5. Workbook: My target card. Learners write the exact requirement they know (overall + any per-skill minimum), their

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			test date (real or provisional) and the number of weeks, then rate each skill 1–4 for confidence. "Don't know the exact requirement? That's your first homework." Pairs may compare <i>test dates and weeks only</i> , if they want to. Explain: "In C2 you get your diagnostic slip. Target minus now = your gap, and your study plan attacks the gap."
Homework and close	5	T–S	Show the online course home page and lesson 1.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Collect diagnostics into the folders. Close with one sentence: "Thank you for your courage today. The hardest class of the course is finished."
Total	90		8 + 4 + 10 + 5 + 10 + 20 + 20 + 8 + 5

◆ A TEST-ANXIETY-AWARE ORIENTATION – WHAT TO SAY AND DO

- ◆ **Name it, then normalize it.** "Almost everybody feels nervous before IELTS. Nervous energy can help you concentrate; we just don't want it to drive." Never tell a learner "Don't worry." Say "It makes sense that you're worried; this matters."
- ◆ **Your four promises** (read them aloud, and they're printed in the workbook contract): 1. Your scores are private: I'll never share or compare them. 2. I'll tell you honestly where you are and what will help most. 3. Every practice test is practice: it's information for us, not a judgment of you. 4. You never have to share personal information to take part.
- ◆ **The one-breath routine** (teach it once; use it before every timed task in the course): "Feet flat. Breathe in slowly for four. Hold for two. Out slowly for six. Read the first instruction." It takes 15 seconds and gives nervous learners a starting ritual. Do it with them, without comment.
- ◆ **Be careful with the stakes.** Don't ask "Why do you need IELTS?" in front of the class. The My target card has an optional line ("I need IELTS for: study / work / professional registration / other / prefer not to say"); nobody reads it but you.
- ◆ **If a learner becomes distressed** during the diagnostic, let them stop, step outside or simply sit. Say quietly: "That's fine. We'll finish it another time or skip it; it doesn't matter today." The diagnostic is replaceable; their trust is not.

◆ RUNNING THE SPEAKING SAMPLE

- ◆ Use the questions printed in `assessment/diagnostic.html` and the **interviewer card** in the materials (set C). Three minutes per learner: about one minute of familiar questions, then a short long-turn or opinion question, as the paper describes. Keep a phone timer on the table where the learner can't see it.

- ◆ Sit at the side of the table, not opposite (it feels less like an interrogation). Smile, but don't nod "yes" to every answer: a real examiner is neutral, and you want a natural sample. Take notes on the four areas only after the learner leaves.
- ◆ **Class of up to about 6:** you'll reach everyone during the writing sample. **Larger class:** reach about 5 in C1, then take the rest at the side table during C2's study-plan stage and C3's controlled-practice stage (never during timed practice). Alternatively, a learner can record the sample at home: a friend or family member reads the questions from the interviewer card, or the learner reads them aloud and answers, and brings the recording on their phone.
- ◆ With the learner's permission, record the sample on your phone so you can mark it later and play a few seconds back to them in Module 4 as a "before" recording. Delete recordings at the end of the course and say that you will.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DIAGNOSTIC

SAY: *Is this a real IELTS test? (No, a short practice map.) Does today's score go on a certificate or to anyone else? (No, only to you.) In Listening, will you hear it twice? (No, once, like the real test.) Is there a penalty for a wrong answer? (No, so fill every gap.) If I call your name, what happens? (A 3-minute speaking sample at the side table.) Do you lose time? (No, you get the minutes back.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some learners are strong speakers but slow readers or writers, often because they learned to read in a non-Latin script or had interrupted schooling. Tell them privately before the diagnostic: "If you don't finish Reading, that's useful information, not failure. Answer what you can and guess the rest." Offer a large-print copy if you can. In the course contract, read every line aloud. On the My target card, a learner can dictate the requirement to you. Note (privately) who ran out of time: reading speed is a strategy target for Module 2.

STRETCH

Learners who finish a section early should **check**, not relax: "Check every answer for spelling and the word limit." In the target stage, stronger learners (aiming for 7.0–7.5) add a second line: "The one sub-skill I think will be hardest to lift: ____" (for example, Reading passage 3, Task 2 coherence, Part 3 abstract answers). Ask them to bring one example of a university or professional body's exact requirement to C2 to share (the requirement, not the reason).

◆ WATCH-OUTS FOR THE FIRST CLASS

- ◆ **Previous IELTS results.** Some learners arrive with a real score from a previous test and feelings about it. Acknowledge it privately and use it: a real score is better data than our diagnostic. Never ask about it in front of the class.

- ◆ **Exam cultures.** Learners from systems where tests were ranked publicly (common in many East Asian, South Asian, Middle Eastern and Eastern European schools) may expect you to post results or may ask classmates for their score. Say early and clearly: "In this class, scores are private."
- ◆ **Copying the prompt** in the writing sample and **memorized answers** in the speaking sample are very common and tell you a lot. Don't correct them today; note them for C2 (the myth "memorized answers score well") and C3 (paraphrasing the prompt).
- ◆ **Decimal commas.** On the My target card, learners who use a decimal comma (Spanish, Portuguese, French, German, Russian, Vietnamese and others) may write "6,5." Accept it today; teach "six point five" in C2.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online course home: <https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/>. Read the first half of online lesson 1.1 ("What IELTS Is" and "The Four Sections"): https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_01.html. Find your **exact requirement** (overall and any per-skill minimum) on the website of your university, professional body or employer, and complete the My target card in the workbook. Optional: two lines in the journal on how the diagnostic felt.

◆ CHECK — AFTER CLASS

Mark Listening and Reading with [assessment/answer-keys.html](#) and convert to band estimates. Write a results slip per learner: $L \approx _ \cdot R \approx _ \cdot \text{one strength} \cdot \text{one focus}$ (for example, "Strength: you answered every question. Focus: spelling of numbers and names in Listening"). Keep a private class record of who ran out of time, who copied the writing prompt and who gave memorized speaking answers.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- describe the four sections of IELTS Academic (Listening about 30 min, Reading 60 min, Writing 60 min, Speaking 11–14 min), what each involves, and how Academic differs from General Training
- explain the 9-band scale, convert a rough raw score to a band, and calculate an **overall band** with the rounding rule (to the nearest half band; an average ending in .25 rounds up to .5, one ending in .75 rounds up to the next whole band)
- separate **facts from myths** about scoring (no penalty for wrong answers; spelling counts; Task 2 is worth twice Task 1; memorized answers and "big words" don't earn marks by themselves)
- apply three strategic principles: manage the clock, never leave a blank, answer exactly what was asked (especially **word limits**)
- write a **personal study plan**: exact target, per-skill minimum, test date, current estimate, gap, weakest skill first, weekly commitment

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 1.1 (New words, Test map box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, My IELTS plan, self-check)
- Slides 6–10 · test vocabulary flashcards · test-day picture cards (*passport, pencil*) · **format information-gap** cards (A/B) · **Myth or Fact?** cards (12, one set per group of 3) · New identity cards · folded **diagnostic results slips**
- Listening scripts 1.1-A (the results conversation) and 1.1-B (dictation: numbers and scores)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the map. Listening ~30 min · 4 recordings · 40 Qs → Reading 60 min · 3 passages · 40 Qs · no transfer time → Writing 60 min · Task 1 (150+ words, ~20 min) + Task 2 (250+ words, ~40 min, **counts double**) → Speaking 11–14 min · Parts 1, 2, 3 · a real examiner.

Center: the bands. 9 expert · 8 very good · 7 good · 6 competent · 5 modest · 4 limited. Overall = average of 4, to the nearest half: 6.125 → 6.0 · 6.25 → **6.5** · 6.375 → 6.5 · 6.625 → 6.5 · 6.75 → **7.0**. Say "six **point** five" (not "six comma five"). Raw score (rough): $30/40 \approx 7$ · $23/40 \approx 6$.

Right: the strategy. 1 Manage the clock (hard Q = 1 mark = easy Q). 2 Never leave a blank (no penalty). 3 Answer what they asked: NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS → 3 words = 0. My plan: target – now = gap → weakest skill first.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: results and reflection	8	S → S-S	Hand back the diagnostic results slips , folded, with a quiet word to anyone who may be disappointed. Learners copy the L and R estimates into the workbook band tracker . Pairs discuss (not scores!): "What surprised you about the diagnostic? What was the hardest part: the language, the time, or the instructions?" Take a few answers; board "language / time / instructions." "Today is about the last two."
Lead-in: guess the test	5	T-S	Slide 6, with the answers hidden. Quick-fire class guesses: "How long is Reading? How many questions in Listening? Who do you speak to in Speaking: a computer or a person?" Reveal. Most classes discover they had at least one wrong belief: "Good. That's why we start here."
Format: information gap	12	S-S → T-S	Workbook Ex 2. Pairs get the format cards : A has the facts about Listening and Writing, B about Reading and Speaking. They ask and answer to complete the test map (time, number of parts or questions, what you do, one warning). ICQs first. Check on slide 6. Highlight: Reading has no transfer time; Task 2 carries twice the weight of Task 1; Speaking is always a real examiner; paper or computer, same content and scoring.
Bands and the rounding rule	14	T-S → S	Slide 7. The band scale (names and a plain-English meaning, paraphrased), raw scores out of 40 (rough guide only; exact tables vary by test), and the rounding rule with CCQs (below). Drill saying scores (Drill script, round 1). Then Workbook Ex 1: read Script 1.1-A once; learners write four skill bands and calculate the overall. Then Ex 3 (band maths, four profiles) alone, check in pairs.
Myth or Fact? card sort	12	S-S → T-S	Slide 8. Groups of 3 get 12 cards and sort them into MYTH / FACT / NOT SURE in 6 minutes. Rule: one person reads, one decides, one must disagree once (with a reason). Check the NOT SURE pile first, then any card the groups disagreed on. Learners record their answers in Ex 4. Spend the most time on the myths that change behavior: memorized speaking answers, "big words," and "wrong answers lose marks."
Strategy + timed word- limit drill	13	T-S → S	Slide 9. The three principles, one example each. Then the word-limit trap : board "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER" and CCQs (below). One-breath routine, then Workbook Ex 5: 3 minutes, timed , five completion items from a short

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			notice. Self-marking (3 min): project the key; learners mark their own answers strictly (spelling and word count). "Right meaning, three words? Zero." Ask for hands: "Who lost a mark to the rule, not to English?" There are always several.
Freer: my study plan + interview	16	S → S-S	Slide 10. Workbook: My IELTS plan (8 min): target, per-skill minimum, test date and weeks, diagnostic estimate, gap, skills ranked, weakest first, weekly commitment, "if a week goes wrong" line. Then the study-plan interview (8 min): pairs interview each other with the questions in the workbook and give one suggestion ("You could put Writing first, because..."). A new identity card is always fine. ICQs first. Stronger pairs: model the interview first. (Larger classes: this is when you take missing speaking samples at the side table.)
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns. Accuracy: "six comma five" · "the Listening have 40 questions" · "I have to rise my Writing." Range: "a per-skill minimum of 6.0," "my weakest skill is..., so I'll prioritize..." Task: a blank left in Ex 5 · three words in a two-word answer · a plan with no weekly number. Learners fix.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.1 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 14 + 12 + 13 + 16 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the overall band. Not a pass or fail: a profile of four skill bands plus their average, rounded to the nearest half band. Institutions often set **two** numbers: an overall band and a minimum for every skill.

SAY: "Overall 6.5, no band below 6.0." Listening 7.5, Reading 7.0, Writing 5.5, Speaking 6.5: overall? (6.625 → 6.5.) Is that enough? (No! Writing is below 6.0.) So which skill do you study first? (Writing.) · Can a great Reading score rescue a low Writing score? (For the overall, a little; for the minimum, no.)

SAY: L 6.0, R 6.5, W 6.0, S 6.5. Average? (6.25.) Is 6.25 closer to 6.0 or 6.5? (Exactly in between.) What does IELTS do with .25? (Rounds up: 6.5.) And 6.125? (Down: 6.0.) And 6.75? (Up: 7.0.)

Meaning: the word limit. The limit is part of the instruction. An answer that breaks it scores zero even if the meaning is right.

SAY: "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER." Can I write one word? (Yes.) Three words? (No.) "two weeks": how many words? (One word and a number: fine.) "well-known": one word or two? (One:

hyphenated words count as one.) "the library": is "the" a word? (Yes! Often you can drop it: "library.")

Meaning: technique vs language. Two learners with the same English can score half a band apart because of timing, blanks and instructions. That part improves fastest.

SAY: *A learner knew the answer but wrote three words. Is that a language problem or a technique problem? (Technique.) Which is faster to fix? (Technique.) Does that mean language doesn't matter? (No: technique helps you show the language you have.)*

Form. (Workbook "Test map" box.)

Listening	about 30 min · 4 recordings · 40 questions	paper: extra time to transfer answers · computer: a short check at the end
Reading	60 min · 3 long passages · 40 questions	no extra transfer time: about 20 min per passage
Writing	60 min · Task 1 (describe a graph, chart, table, map or process; 150+ words) · Task 2 (essay; 250+ words)	Task 2 counts twice as much: about 20 + 40 min
Speaking	11–14 min · Part 1 interview · Part 2 long turn from a cue card (1 min to prepare, up to 2 min talk) · Part 3 discussion	always a real examiner, face to face or by video call
Overall band	average of the four, to the nearest half band	.25 → up to .5 · .75 → up to the next whole band

Pronunciation. Scores: "six **point** five" or "six and a **half**" (both fine); never "six comma five." Word stress: *Overall* (adjective, first syllable) · *exAminer* · *ACAademic* → a-ca-**DEM**-ic · *de**SCRIPT**or*. Numbers that sound alike: *thir**TEEN*** / ***THIR**ty*, *four**TEEN*** / ***FOR**ty*: in Listening they are a classic trap, so drill them now.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Say the score** (choral, then individual): T writes 6.5 → S: "six point five." 7.0 → "seven." 5.5 → "five point five." T: "Overall six and a half." → S repeats. T: "No band below six." → S repeats, stress on **below** and **six**.
- 2 Round it:** T: "six point one two five" → S: "six." T: "six point two five" → "six point five." T: "six point six two five" → "six point five." T: "six point seven five" → "seven." T: "seven point three seven five" → "seven point five."
- 3 Teen or ty?** T says one; S shows fingers (1 for -teen, 2 for -ty): "thirteen · forty · fifteen · fifty · seventeen · seventy." Then pairs: A says, B writes the number.

- 4 **Word-limit judge:** T: "Two words. Answer: 'the old library.'" → S: "Too many! 'Old library.'" T: "Two words and/or a number. Answer: '15 May.'" → S: "OK." T: "One word. Answer: 'car park.'" → S: "Too many!"

◆ MYTH OR FACT? – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** with roles: **reader** (reads each card aloud), **decider** (places it after discussion) and **challenger** (must disagree at least once, with a reason). Give the challenger job to a quiet learner: it's a safe way to practice disagreeing.
- ◆ Sorting (6 min): MYTH / FACT / NOT SURE. Check (6 min): NOT SURE pile first, then disagreements. The key is in the answer key and printed small on the back of each card set.
- ◆ Keep the tone light: myths are normal ("Everyone hears these from friends"). Spend time only where a myth changes behavior. For "Memorized answers get high marks in Speaking" say: "Examiners are trained to notice rehearsed answers, and a memorized answer doesn't show what you can do. Prepare **ideas and phrases**, not scripts."
- ◆ Don't overstate details you can't check for this learner's test center (rules about what to bring, retake options, how results are sent). Say: "Check the official IELTS website or your test center for that."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE INFORMATION GAP AND THE PLAN INTERVIEW

SAY: *Information gap: Can you show your card to your partner? (No, ask and answer.) Who has the Reading facts? (B.) What do you write? (The missing facts in the test map.) · Plan interview: Do you have to give your real target? (No: real, or a new identity card.) Do you have to say why you need IELTS? (No.) What does the interviewer give at the end? (One suggestion, with "because.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the test map as a **half-completed table** so the learner only fills in numbers. In band maths, allow a calculator on a phone: the skill is the rounding rule, not arithmetic. In the word-limit drill, give a strip with the rule in large print and three examples ("2 words: ✓ old library ✗ the old library"). For the study plan, the learner can dictate to a partner. Fewer items: Ex 3 profiles 1–2, Ex 4 cards 1–6.

STRETCH

Learners aiming at 7.0–7.5 work out **what it would take**: "Your profile is L 7.0 R 6.5 W 6.0 S 6.5. What's the smallest change that gets an overall 7.0?" (One skill up a full band, or two skills up half a band each: for example, W 6.5 and R 7.0 → $27/4 = 6.75 \rightarrow 7.0$.) In the plan interview they must justify their weekly commitment with a number ("two timed Reading passages a week, because my diagnostic shows passage 3 is where I lose time").

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Decimal comma:** Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, German, Russian, Turkish, Vietnamese and others write and say "6,5 / six comma five." Teach "point" as part of the test vocabulary; examiners and university staff will expect it.
- ◆ **-teen / -ty:** stress confusion is common for speakers of Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese and Arabic. Listening Part 1 uses numbers, dates and prices constantly, so drill it now.
- ◆ **"I have to rise my score":** *rise* (no object) vs *raise* (with an object) is confused by nearly everyone. "My score **rose**. I want to **raise** my score."
- ◆ **Pass/fail thinking:** in many school systems a test is passed or failed. Learners may say "I passed with 6.0." Gently model: "I got an overall 6.0," "I reached my target."
- ◆ **Reading speed in a non-Latin script background:** Arabic, Persian, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Thai, Amharic and other readers may read English more slowly than they speak it. The "20 minutes per passage" rule matters more for them; reassure them that speed grows with practice and that Module 2 teaches skimming and scanning.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_01.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 1.1: finish My IELTS plan, "My new words" and the journal (target, test date and weakest skill at the top; one sentence naming the biggest obstacle and one thing you'll do about it this week). Optional: try one free official practice Listening section, untimed, just to feel the format.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** Zero · Q2 **A** 6.5 ($25.5 \div 4 = 6.375$) · Q3 (new) **B** Task 2 carries more weight than Task 1, so give it about 40 minutes. Results conversation (Ex 1): L 7.0 · R 6.0 · W 5.5 · S 6.5 → average 6.25 → overall **6.5**; Amal's required minimum is 6.0, so Writing is the priority.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain why paraphrase decides answers in Listening and Reading and lifts Lexical Resource in Writing and Speaking
- ◆ climb the **paraphrase ladder**: synonym → change the word class → change the voice → change the structure → use a more general word, combining at least two moves without changing the meaning
- ◆ use the right member of an **AWL-style word family** (*analyze · analysis · analytical · analytically*) with the right stress
- ◆ upgrade everyday words to academic ones only where the **collocation** is natural (*have a detrimental effect on*, not *a detrimental adolescent*)
- ◆ recognize a reworded answer under time pressure, and reject a **synonym trap**: a sentence that shares a word with the question but not its meaning
- ◆ restate a Task 2 prompt aloud in their own words, and answer a Speaking Part 1 question without echoing the examiner's words

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, paraphrase relay frame, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 11–15 · AWL word-family flashcards · topic picture cards (*school, bus, mobile phone, vegetable, park, desk*) · **Paraphrase Relay** prompt cards (8) · **No-Echo** examiner cards · phone timer · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.2-A (the workshop registration call) and 1.2-B (dictation: paraphrase pairs)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the ladder (climb at least two rungs). 1 synonym (*cars* → *vehicles*) · 2 word class (*pollute* → *pollution*) · 3 voice (*drivers cause it* → *it is caused by drivers*) · 4 structure (*when they drive* → *by driving*) · 5 general word (*cars* → *private transport*). ✗ one word swapped · ✗ meaning changed.

Center: word families. **AN**alyze · a**NA**lysis · ana**LYT**ical · **SIG**nify → sig**NIF**icant · sig**NIF**icance · e**CON**omy · eco**NOM**ic (money) · eco**NOM**ical (cheap to run) · **BEN**efit · bene**FIC**ial · con**TRIB**ute → contri**BU**tion. Upgrade + collocation: *have a detrimental effect on* · *give rise to* · *a considerable amount of*.

Right: traps. Q: "Visitor numbers doubled." ✗ "Visitor numbers rose." (not double) ✗ "Visitors doubled their spending." (same word, other meaning) ✓ "Twice as many people visited." Hunt the **meaning**, not the word.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: bands and myths	8	S-S	Review C2. Board two profiles; pairs calculate the overall (L 6.5 R 6.0 W 6.0 S 6.0 → 6.125 → 6.0; L 7.0 R 7.0 W 6.0 S 6.5 → 6.625 → 6.5). Then three Myth or Fact? cards read aloud, class votes with thumbs. Glance at the study plans: check each has a weekly number.
Lead-in: find the answer	5	T-S	Slide 11. A question ("The museum's income fell after the entry fee was removed.") and three passage sentences. "Which one says the same thing? Which words match?" Elicit that no key word is repeated. "Today: how to see the same meaning in different clothes, and how to dress your own ideas."
The paraphrase ladder	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 12. Build the five rungs on the board with one base sentence ("Young people pollute the air when they drive cars."). For each rung, elicit one change. Then show the two failures: too little (one word swapped) and too much (meaning drift). CCQs (below). Drill script round 1.
Word families and stress	10	T-S → S	Slide 13. The AWL idea in one sentence: a list of about 570 word families common in university texts. Show four families with the stress moving; drill (round 2). Then everyday → academic upgrades, always with a collocation. Slide 14: topic banks with pictures (education, transport, technology, health, environment, work).
Listening: synonym traps	10	T-S → S-S	One-breath routine. Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.2-A once only (a student registers for a study-skills workshop). Learners complete the form (NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER). Self-mark from the slide. Then read it a second time: pairs find the trap for each answer (the first time/day/price mentioned, then corrected) and the paraphrase that gave the answer ("the session won't be going ahead").
Timed reading	12	S	Workbook Ex 4: 8 minutes, timed , a 250-word original passage on rooftop gardens with six items (matching paraphrases and synonym-trap multiple choice). Announce "two minutes left" once. Self-mark (4 min) from the slide or key; for every wrong answer, learners write the trap word that fooled them. Ask: "Who chose an answer because the same word was there?"
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (word families) and Ex 3 (climb the ladder) alone, then compare in pairs. Board-check only the disagreements. Ex 5

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			(upgrade with collocation) is homework unless a pair finishes early. (Larger classes: remaining speaking samples at the side table now.)
Freer: Paraphrase Relay + No-Echo	14	S-S → T-S	Slide 15. Relay (8 min) : pairs, one prompt card each. A reads a Task 2-style prompt aloud; B has 30 seconds to restate it as a spoken introduction, using at least two rungs of the ladder and without repeating any key noun or verb. A checks the card's "don't repeat" words. Swap. No-Echo (6 min) : A reads a Speaking Part 1 question from the examiner card; B answers in 2–3 sentences without echoing the question ("Do you enjoy cooking?" → not "Yes, I enjoy cooking" but "Yes, I really like making meals..."). A taps the table when B echoes. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns. Accuracy: "an economical growth" · "a significant adolescent" · "the analyze of the data." Range: "a considerable proportion of," "give rise to," "it is sometimes argued that." Task: a prompt repeated word for word · an answer chosen because one word matched · four words in a two-word answer.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 10 + 10 + 12 + 9 + 14 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: paraphrase. The same meaning in different words and a different structure. A good paraphrase is not shorter or longer on purpose; it is equal in meaning.

SAY: "Young people pollute the air when they drive cars." → "Adolescents contribute to air pollution through their use of vehicles." Same meaning? (Yes.) How many rungs? (Synonym: adolescents, vehicles; word class: pollute → pollution; structure: when they drive → through their use.) · "Young people pollute the air when they drive vehicles." Is that a paraphrase? (Not really: one word changed.) · "All teenagers are destroying the planet with their cars." Paraphrase? (No: the meaning has changed. "All," "destroying" = drift.)

Meaning: synonym trap. A trap sentence repeats a word from the question but says something different, or uses a near-synonym that is stronger or weaker.

SAY: Question: "Visitor numbers doubled." Text: "Visitor numbers rose considerably." Same? (No: rose is not doubled.) Text: "Visitors doubled their spending." Same word; same meaning? (No: spending, not numbers.) Text: "Twice as many people visited." (Yes: twice as many = doubled.) · "cheap" and

"affordable": same? (Close, not the same: cheap can mean low quality; affordable housing is a fixed phrase.)

Meaning: word family. One root, several word classes. The grammar of the sentence decides which one you need.

SAY: "The ___ of the data took three weeks." Noun, verb or adjective? (Noun: analysis.) "She is very ___." (Adjective: analytical.) · "economic growth" vs "an economical car": which is about the economy? (Economic.) Which one saves money? (Economical.)

Form. (Workbook grammar box.)

The ladder	1 synonym · 2 word class · 3 voice · 4 structure / connector · 5 general word	Climb at least two rungs. Keep the meaning, the numbers and the hedges (<i>some, may, most</i>).
Word family	verb · noun · adjective · adverb	analyze · analysis · analytical · analytically · benefit · benefit · beneficial · beneficially · vary · variation / variety · various / variable · — · sustain · sustainability · sustainable · sustainably
Upgrade + collocation	everyday → academic	get → acquire (skills) · big → substantial (increase) · bad for → have a detrimental effect on · cause → give rise to · help → facilitate (communication) · a lot of → a considerable amount of (research)
Prompt → intro	restate, don't copy	"Some people think..." → "It is sometimes argued that..." · children → young learners · start → be introduced to

Pronunciation. Word families move the stress, and Listening answers are often the other member of the family: learners who expect *ANalyze* may not recognize *aNALysis*. **ANalyze** → **aNALysis** → **anaLYTical** · **Economy** is wrong: **eCONomy** → **ecoNOMic** · **conTRIBute** → **contriBution** · **VARY** → **variAtion** → **VARious** · **susTAIN** → **susTAINable** → **sustainaBILity**. The suffix *-ity* and *-ic* pull the stress to the syllable just before them.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 One rung at a time** (T gives the sentence and the rung; S changes it): "Many students find exams stressful. Synonym." → "Many learners find examinations stressful." "Word class." → "Exams cause stress for many students." "Voice." → "Stress is experienced by many students during exams." "General word." → "Many students find assessments stressful."
- 2 Family ping-pong** (choral, then individual; exaggerate the stress): T: "analyze, noun" → S: "a**NAL**ysis." T: "economy, adjective" → "eco**NOM**ic." T: "benefit, adjective" → "bene**F**icial." T: "vary, noun" →

"variAtion." T: "sustain, noun" → "sustainaBILity." T: "significant, noun" → "sigNIFicance."

3 **Upgrade with a partner word:** T: "big + increase" → S: "a substantial increase." T: "bad for + health" → "a detrimental effect on health." T: "get + skills" → "acquire skills." T: "help + communication" → "facilitate communication."

4 **Trap or match?** T: "Question: most staff welcomed it. Text: some staff welcomed it." → S: "Trap! Most isn't some." T: "Text: the majority of employees responded with enthusiasm." → "Match!"

◆ PARAPHRASE RELAY + NO-ECHO – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs**, A and B. Each prompt card has a Task 2-style prompt (original, neutral topics: cycle lanes, online degrees, school gardens, four-day weeks, museum fees, shared workspaces...) and three **"don't repeat"** words printed underneath for the checker.
- ◆ **Round 1 (8 min):** A reads the prompt aloud. B has 30 seconds to think, then says a one- or two-sentence introduction that restates the prompt and (optionally) gives a position. A listens for the "don't repeat" words and says which rungs B used. Swap after each card. Aim for three cards each.
- ◆ **Round 2 (6 min):** A is the examiner with a No-Echo card (Part 1 questions: study, work, hometown or a new identity card's town, free time, food, technology). B answers in 2–3 sentences. A taps the table once for each echoed phrase. Swap after five questions.
- ◆ **Share:** two learners give their best introduction; the class names the rungs. Praise any version that keeps the meaning, including a simple one.
- ◆ **Keep it honest:** a **shorter**, accurate paraphrase beats a long, risky one. If B freezes, A can offer a starter from the card ("It is sometimes argued that...").

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE RELAY

SAY: *How long does B have to think? (30 seconds.) Must B agree with the prompt? (No: restate it; the opinion is optional.) What does A listen for? (The "don't repeat" words.) In Round 2, what does A do if B repeats the question? (Tap the table.) Do you have to talk about your real hometown? (No: a new identity card is fine.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **ladder strip** with the five rungs and one example each, and a set of ready-made chunks for the relay (*It is sometimes argued that...* · *Many people believe that...* · *There is some debate about whether...*). In the timed reading, the learner answers items 1–4 only and highlights the matching words in two colors (question, text). In Ex 2, give the word families with one form already filled in each row. Target: one accurate two-rung paraphrase, spoken and then written.

STRETCH

Push toward **precision**, the sign of band 7.5+. In the relay, B must keep the prompt's hedges and scope exactly ("some people" ≠ "people"; "should" ≠ "must"). Give strong learners the "less common" upgrades with their collocations (*exacerbate a problem, mitigate the effects of, a marked contrast, disproportionately affect*) and ask them to use two in speech with no collocation error. In the timed reading, they explain in one sentence why each wrong option is wrong.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **False friends** that look academic: Spanish/Portuguese/French *actual* / *atual* / *actuel* (= current, not "actual"), *eventual* / *éventuel* (= possible, not "eventual"), *asistir* / *assister* (= attend, not "assist"), *carrera* (= degree program, not "career"), German *konsequent* (= consistent), Russian *аккуратный* (= neat, not "accurate"). Check any "upgrade" against a learner's dictionary.
- ◆ **Collocation calques**: "do a mistake" (Spanish *hacer*, French *faire*), "make a research," "strong rain" (Chinese, Russian), "big / high knowledge," "learn knowledge" (Chinese 学习). Teach upgrades as **chunks**, never as single words.
- ◆ **Word class without inflection**: Chinese, Vietnamese and Thai don't change a word's form for its class, so learners may say "the economy growth," "an analyze," "very benefit." Point to the position: after *the* → noun; before a noun → adjective.
- ◆ **Stress on long words**: learners who read far more English than they hear often stress by rule from their L1 (Spanish and Italian on the penultimate, French on the final syllable): *ana-LY-sis*, *eco-no-MY*. Use the Pronunciation note: stress errors can hide a Listening answer.
- ◆ **Over-paraphrasing numbers and hedges**: in several languages the equivalent of "most" and "many," or "may" and "will," overlap. In paraphrase, the quantity and the certainty must survive exactly.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_02.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back with the right word stress; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the paraphrase bank task (three topics, collocations not single words). Workbook 1.2: Exercise 5, "My new words" and the journal (the paraphrase technique you find hardest, and one small thing you'll do this week to practice it).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** "The plant's production rose over the period." · Q2 **B** Technology facilitates communication. · Q3 (new) **B** "Twice as many people visited as in the previous year." Registration call (Ex 1): 1 Thursday · 2 4:30 (p.m.) / half past four · 3 Room 12 · 4 (a) laptop · 5 \$15 / 15 dollars · 6 Okafor. Timed reading (Ex 4): 1 C · 2 A · 3 D · 4 B · 5 B · 6 C.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain what the Grammatical Range & Accuracy criterion rewards (in words *paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors*): variety of structures and control of them, with more error-free sentences at each higher band
- ◆ produce a **reliable handful** of complex structures accurately: subordinate clauses, defining and non-defining relative clauses, first and second conditionals, participle clauses, noun clauses and comparatives
- ◆ choose the tense each task demands (Task 1 dates decide the tense; process = present passive; Task 2 = present simple and conditionals)
- ◆ find and fix the **band-limiting seven**: articles, subject-verb agreement, prepositions, run-ons and comma splices, uncountable nouns, word form, and one structure on repeat
- ◆ estimate **error density** (how many sentences in a paragraph are error-free) and use it to decide whether to work on range or accuracy next
- ◆ upgrade a flat paragraph for range **without adding errors**, and use complex frames in a spoken Part 3 answer

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Grammar Upgrade frame, error log, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 16–19 · complex-frame flashcards · band-limiting-seven flashcards · **Part 3 frame** cards + **observer tallies** · each learner's marked **diagnostic writing sample** (in a folder) · colored pens · New identity cards · Paraphrase Bingo (warmer)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.3-A (three answers to one Part 3 question) and 1.3-B (dictation: complex frames)

BOARD PLAN

Left: GRA = range + accuracy. 5: mostly simple · frequent errors. 6: a mix · some errors, meaning clear. 7: a variety of complex · frequent error-free sentences. 8: wide range · most sentences error-free. (paraphrased) 5 → 6 = add range · 6 → 7 = keep it accurate.

Center: the toolkit. Although X, Y. (✗ Although..., but...) · Students **who**... · Solar power, **which** is cheaper, ... · If + present, will · If + past, would · **Having** risen, prices... · **The fact that**... / **What** is clear is... · far higher **than**. Tense: chart 1990–2010 → past · up to now → present perfect · forecast → *is expected to* · process → *is chopped* · opinion → present.

Right: the band-limiting seven. articles · agreement (*the number of X is*) · prepositions (*increase in*, *responsible for*) · comma splice · uncountables (*information*) · word form (*affect / effect*) · one structure

on repeat. **Error density:** error-free sentences ÷ all sentences. Aim: most.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Paraphrase Bingo	8	T-S → S	Review C3. Learners get a bingo card of academic words and chunks. You read everyday paraphrases from the caller list ("to get skills" → learners find <i>acquire</i> ; "twice as many" → <i>double</i>). First full line wins; the winner reads the line back as academic words, with the right stress. Collect or glance at the paraphrase banks.
Lead-in: which paragraph scores higher?	5	T-S	Slide 16: three short paragraphs on the same topic: A simple and correct, B ambitious and broken, C ranged and correct. "Rank them for grammar." Most learners rank B above A at first. Discuss: B's errors blur the meaning. "Today: range you can control."
The toolkit (MFP)	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 17. Build the toolkit from the lead-in paragraph C: learners find the structures. Then the paraphrased GRA band table (5–8). CCQs (below) on <i>although</i> vs <i>but</i> , defining vs non-defining relatives, first vs second conditional, participle clauses.
Drill: frames	6	T-S → S	Four rounds (Drill script): join with a frame, choral then individual. Hold up a frame flashcard; learners complete it with a class topic.
Listening: three answers	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.3-A : three candidates answer the same Part 3 question. Learners tick the structures each one uses and decide which answer shows range <u>with</u> control. Pairs compare. (Answer: C.)
Tenses and the band- limiting seven	10	T-S → S	Slide 18. Tense by task: "Read the dates first." Then the seven errors, each with one quick fix. Workbook Ex 3 (tense by task) alone, 3 min, self-mark from the slide. Introduce error density : "Count the error-free sentences, not the errors." Model it on lead-in paragraph B (1 of 4 sentences error-free).
Freer: Grammar Upgrade workshop	20	S-S → T-S	Groups of 3. Round 1, Upgrade (8 min) : Workbook Ex 5: the flat paragraph about a neighborhood library. Rewrite it with at least four different complex structures and no new errors . Round 2, Error hunt (6 min) : Workbook Ex 4: the flawed paragraph about remote study. Mark each sentence ✓ or ✗, calculate its error density, correct it. Round 3, Speak it (6 min) : Part 3 frame cards:

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			A asks a Part 3 question, B answers for about 45 seconds using the two frames on the card, C ticks the observer tally (structures heard, and any error that blurred meaning). Rotate. ICQs first.
My error-density audit	8	S	Return the marked diagnostic writing samples in folders. Privately, learners count their sentences and their error-free sentences, write the ratio in the band tracker, and start the error log : their three most frequent errors from the seven. Walk round; speak quietly. Nobody shares numbers.
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns. Accuracy: "Although it is cheap, but..." · "If it will continue..." · "the number of cars are." Range: "Having doubled, ...," "What is clear is that..." "far higher than." Task: a past chart in the present · the same opening three times. Learners fix.
Module wrap-up and homework	10	T-S → S	Slide 19 recap: "know the test, know the words, control the grammar." Learners tick the three "I can..." lists and write any unticked item on a sticky note for you. Set the homework (below). Preview Module 2: Listening and Reading strategy, then Practice Test 1 in C8 (timed Listening and Reading; "information, not judgment").
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 6 + 10 + 20 + 8 + 5 + 10

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: range and accuracy. Range = how many different structures you use; accuracy = how many of your sentences have no errors. The criterion needs both; neither alone lifts the band.

SAY: Paragraph A: five short, perfect sentences. Range? (Low.) Accuracy? (High.) Paragraph B: long sentences with many errors. Range? (Some.) Accuracy? (Low.) Is B better than A? (Not necessarily: the errors make it hard to follow.) What does band 7 want? (A variety of complex sentences, and many of them error-free.)

Meaning: error density. Not "Did I make a mistake?" but "How many of my sentences are completely correct?" One error in a long script is normal at band 7; errors in most sentences hold a script around band 5–6.

SAY: A paragraph has eight sentences; three are error-free. Is that "most"? (No, fewer than half.) What should this writer work on first: more range or more accuracy? (Accuracy.) Another writer: eight sentences, seven error-free, all simple. Next step? (Range: add complex structures she can control.)

Meaning: the toolkit.

SAY: "Although online learning is convenient, it lacks face-to-face contact." Two ideas: do they agree or contrast? (Contrast.) Can I add "but" before "it lacks"? (No: although already contrasts.) · "Students who study abroad become more independent." All students? (No, only the ones who study abroad.) Commas? (No: defining.) · "Solar power, which is now cheaper, is expanding." Is the "which" part necessary to know which solar power? (No: extra information, so commas.) · "If fees were lower, more people would attend." Are fees lower now? (No: hypothetical.) · "Having risen sharply, prices leveled off." Which happened first? (Rising.) Who or what rose? (Prices: the subject must match.)

Form. (Workbook grammar box.)

Subordinate clause	although · while · whereas · because · since · if	Although car use rose, bus use also increased. (✗ Although..., but...)
Relative clause	defining (no commas) · non-defining (commas, never <i>that</i>)	Students who work part-time... · The bridge, which opened in 1932, ...
Conditionals	1st: if + present, will · 2nd: if + past, would	If cities invest in cycling, congestion will fall. · If fees were lower, more people would enroll. (✗ If it will continue)
Participle clause	-ing / having + past participle / -ed opener; same subject	Having doubled in a decade, the population then stabilized.
Noun clause	The fact that... · What is clear is that... · One reason why... is that...	What is clear is that demand will keep growing.
Comparison	far / considerably / slightly + comparative · the + superlative	Spending was far higher in 2020 than in any earlier year.
Tense by task	Task 1: dates decide · process: present passive · Task 2: present simple, conditionals	rose (1990–2010) · has risen (to now) · is expected to rise (forecast) · is ground (process)

Pronunciation. In Speaking, complex sentences need **chunking**: a small pause after the subordinate clause and a fall-rise on it signals "more is coming": "Although it's convenient ↗ | it lacks face-to-face contact ↘." Non-defining clauses are said like a parenthesis, lower and a little faster: "Solar power | *which is now cheaper* | is expanding fast." Weak forms keep long sentences fluent: *was* /wəz/, *than* /ðən/, *that* /ðət/ in "the fact that...".

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Join it** (T gives two sentences and the signal): "Online learning is flexible. It can feel isolating. Although." → S: "Although online learning is flexible, it can feel isolating." "Some students work part-time. They often manage time well. Who." → "Students who work part-time often manage time well."

"Traffic keeps increasing. The city may charge drivers. If." → "If traffic keeps increasing, the city may charge drivers."

- 2 **Kill the double connector:** T: "Although it was expensive, but it worked." → S: "Although it was expensive, it worked." T: "Because prices rose, so people bought less." → "Because prices rose, people bought less." (or "Prices rose, so people bought less.")
- 3 **Date → tense:** T: "1995 to 2005, rise." → S: "rose." T: "2010 to now, rise." → "have risen / has risen." T: "2030, forecast, reach." → "is expected to reach." T: "process, grind." → "is ground."
- 4 **Frame it** (T shows a frame card and a topic; S speaks): "What is clear is that... / cycling" → "What is clear is that cycling is becoming more popular in cities." "The fact that... / screen time" → "The fact that children spend so much time on screens worries many parents." "Not only... but also..." (stretch: inversion) → "Not only does cycling reduce traffic, but it also improves health."

◆ GRAMMAR UPGRADE WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3** with roles: **writer** (holds the pen), **checker** (reads every new sentence aloud and asks "Is it correct?") and **counter** (ticks structures on the checklist and, in Round 2, counts error-free sentences). Rotate the pen each round. Give the checker role to a confident learner who tends to over-reach: it teaches control.
- ◆ **Round 1 (8 min):** Ex 5 paragraph (neighborhood library, six short error-free sentences). Checklist: ☐ 4+ different complex structures ☐ no new errors ☐ same facts ☐ no sentence longer than about 30 words. A 3-sentence answer that is correct and ranged beats a 1-sentence monster.
- ◆ **Round 2 (6 min):** Ex 4 paragraph (remote study, eight sentences, nine errors from the band-limiting seven). Mark ✓ / ✗ per sentence first, then write the error density (✓ ÷ all), then correct. Groups check with the key on the slide at the end of the round.
- ◆ **Round 3 (6 min):** Part 3 frame cards. The observer's tally has two columns: **structures heard** and **errors that blurred meaning** (not every slip: only ones that made the listener unsure). Each speaker gets one strength and one suggestion.
- ◆ **Share:** one group reads its upgraded paragraph; the class names the structures and checks for new errors. Praise the group that **removed** a risky structure because they weren't sure of it: that is the strategy.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: *In Round 1, how many different complex structures? (At least four.) Can you add new facts? (No.) What's worse: a short correct sentence or a long broken one? (The long broken one.) In Round 2, what do you count? (The error-free sentences.) In Round 3, does the observer write every mistake? (No, only errors that made the meaning unclear.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **frame strip** with four frames only (*Although..., ... · ... who ... · If ..., ... will ... · far more ... than ...*) and ask for two structures in Round 1, not four. In Round 2, underline the sentences with errors in advance so the learner's job is to find and fix, not to find. For the audit, sit with the learner and count together; point to one error type only for the error log. Target: two accurate complex sentences, written and then said aloud.

STRETCH (TOWARD 7.5+)

Flexibility, not just variety. Ask strong learners to write the same idea three ways with different structures (*Although... / Despite + -ing... / ...; however, ...*) and to say which one fits the paragraph best. Introduce **inversion** for emphasis (*Not only does..., Rarely have...*) and **mixed conditionals** (*If the city had invested earlier, traffic would be lighter today*), with the warning that one well-placed example is enough. Their error-density target is "almost all sentences error-free."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"Although..., but..." and "Because..., so..."**: Chinese (虽然...但是...), Vietnamese (*tuy...nhưng · vì... nên*), Korean, Japanese and Thai use paired connectors. It is one of the most frequent errors in IELTS writing. One clause, one connector.
- ◆ **Articles**: speakers of Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Thai, Persian, Hindi-Urdu and Turkish drop them ("Government should build hospital"); Spanish, French, Portuguese, Italian and Arabic speakers may add *the* to general statements ("The pollution is a problem"). Teach one rule at a time; the error log helps.
- ◆ **Comma splices**: Spanish, Portuguese, Vietnamese, Chinese and Arabic writing traditions allow long chains joined by commas or *and* (Arabic *wa*). In English, two sentences need a period, a semicolon or a connector.
- ◆ **"If it will..."**: many languages use a future after *if* (for example, Russian, Polish, Chinese, Korean, Arabic). Drill "If + present, will."
- ◆ **Tense with dates**: Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian/Malay mark time with words, not verb forms, so a whole Task 1 answer may stay in the present. "Read the dates first" is the fix.
- ◆ **Uncountables**: "informations, advices, researches, equipments, knowledges" transfer from French, Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, Russian and others where these nouns are countable.
- ◆ **Subject-verb agreement across long subjects**: "The number of students who study abroad are..." The verb agrees with the head noun (*number*), not the nearest one. Everyone does this, including advanced writers.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_03.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and copy the chunking; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Upgrade & Correct"

task. Workbook 1.3: the error log, "My new words" and the journal (your three most frequent errors from the diagnostic, the fix for each in your own words, and the two complex structures you'll drill this week). Before C5, look at online lesson 2.1 (Listening) and note one question.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** The number of tourists is increasing, causing an increase in demand for information. · Q2 **C** As prices rose, people bought less. · Q3 (new) **B** Although the course was short, it was useful. Three answers (Ex 1): Candidate C shows range with control (subordinate clause, non-defining relative, second conditional, comparative, no errors); A is accurate but simple; B is ambitious but has errors that blur meaning ("Although..., but," "If people will," "the number of families are").

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C4: MODULE 1 WRAP-UP

Recap on the last slide, "know the test, know the words, control the grammar": **overall = average to the nearest half · no blanks · obey the word limit** (know the test) → **climb two rungs · hunt the meaning, not the word · word family + collocation** (know the words) → **a reliable handful of complex structures · most sentences error-free · read the dates first** (control the grammar). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you: review it in the C5 warmer (Paraphrase Bingo or a two-minute error hunt).

Watch for in Module 2: the synonym-trap work in C3 is the foundation of Listening (2.1) and of True / False / Not Given (2.3); refer back to it by name ("That's a trap: same word, different meaning"). The word-limit rule returns in every completion task. The "number of...is" and article fixes from C4 return in Task 1 (3.1). The C1 one-breath routine opens every timed section of **Practice Test 1 (C8)**.

Practice Test 1 (C8) is timed Listening and Reading only. It uses the Module 1 foundations indirectly: completion items with word limits and spelling, answers that are paraphrased rather than repeated, and distractors that share a word with the question. The Module 1 grammar and vocabulary work comes back directly in Practice Test 2 (C15–C16), where Writing and Speaking are marked against criteria paraphrased from the public band descriptors.

Module 2 — Listening & Reading

Three workshops and a practice test on the two "receptive" papers, where marks are won by habits, not by knowing more English. First, **Listening**: predicting the answer type, following signposts, taking the **correction** rather than the distractor, and protecting every heard answer from spelling, plural and word-limit traps across form, note, map and multiple-choice tasks. Then **Reading**: skimming to map a passage, scanning for a keyword's **paraphrase**, and budgeting 60 minutes across three passages with no transfer time. Last, the "tricky types": **True / False / Not Given**, matching headings and matching features, built on one routine, **Prove it**. The module ends with **Practice Test 1** under exam conditions (C8), returned and analyzed in the C9 warmer.

3 lessons + Practice Test 1

Lessons 2.1–2.3

Classes C5–C8

Weeks 3–4

90 min per class

Target band 6.0–7.5

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One block = one 90-minute class. C5–C7 follow the exam-skills workshop shape used across this kit: **warmer** (review of the last class) → **lead-in** → **strategy**, clarified with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → a short **drill** → **guided practice** → **timed practice** (exam conditions, once only) → **self-marking** and an **error-type tally** → a **freer pair task** → **feedback** → **homework**. C8 is the practice test itself and has its own plan.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-2-listening-reading.html`. Print `materials/module-2/classroom-materials.html` before C5. It holds the flashcards, the **caller identity cards** and receptionist forms for the Part 1 information gap, the **Explain your route** cards, the **Prove it** debate cards, the **Number & Spelling Trap Bingo** game, the C8 kit (briefing script, door sign, calm card, error-type tally sheet, results tracker) and every **listening script you read aloud**.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons (UK or US voice, adjustable speed), so learners can hear the signpost and model sentences again at home.
- These are skills classes, so protect the practice.** In every class, at least a third of the time is learners doing questions under a clock, then marking them strictly. If you are running late, shorten your explanation and the guided stage, never the timed practice or the self-marking. Learners improve in Listening and Reading by *doing and diagnosing*, not by hearing about strategies.

- ◆ **Every set ends with an error-type tally.** After each timed set, learners do not just count a score; they write a code beside every wrong answer. **Listening:** **D** took the distractor · **S** spelling or plural · **W** word limit / wrong form · **N** misheard a number, letter or date · **L** lost my place or froze · **P** missed the paraphrase. **Reading** shares **P S W** (S = copied a word wrongly) and adds: **M** word-match trap · **O** looked in the wrong place · **T** ran out of time or left a blank · **F** confused False and Not Given · **K** used my own knowledge · **Q** missed a qualifier · **H** heading matched a detail. Both sections also use **X** transfer error (right answer, wrong box or hard to read) once there is an answer sheet. The same codes are used on Practice Test 1 and in C9, so by the time learners mark the test the routine is automatic. The full list is in the workbook and on the tally sheet (materials, Set F).
- ◆ **Mark strictly, speak kindly.** In the real test a misspelled or over-limit answer scores zero. Mark that way from the first day, because it is the fastest route to more marks. But frame each lost mark as **information** ("That's an S. Good: an S is the easiest leak to fix") rather than failure.
- ◆ **Your voice is the recording.** All listening in this module is teacher-read. That is a strength: you can read at test speed, but you can also stop and replay a sentence in the guided stages. In the **timed** stages, read **once only**, at a natural pace, without stressing the answers. Rehearse each script once aloud before class. Two-voice scripts work best with a colleague or a confident learner who has seen the script (not one who is doing the task), or record them in advance on a phone.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard; the test is international.** The online lessons use British spellings and some British words (*practise, colour, car park, £, organise*). IELTS accepts British or American spelling in answers if it is correct and consistent. Teach American forms, accept both, and point out the British words learners are likely to *hear* in the real test: *car park* (parking lot), *ground floor* and *first floor* (the first floor is one level **up** in British English), *queue, timetable* (schedule), *postcode* (zip code), prices in pounds (£).
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Hear it coming → find it fast → prove it. In C5 learners stop listening to everything and start listening *for* something: they predict the answer type, hear the signpost, wait for the correction and write the final version exactly. In C6 they stop reading every word: they skim to build a map, then scan for a keyword's paraphrase, and they spend their minutes where the marks are. In C7 they learn to defend each answer with evidence: point to the words that agree (True), the words that clash (False), or show that the text is silent (Not Given). The same idea runs through all three: **the answer is almost never in the question's words**, so every class trains learners to recognize paraphrase under time pressure. C8 puts all of it under exam conditions, and C9's warmer turns the results into a personal plan.

STAKES, NERVES AND REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS

Your learners are sitting a high-stakes test: a university place, professional registration, a visa. Many have taken IELTS before and been a half band short of what they needed; some have spent a lot of money on it. Anxiety is normal, and it shows up most in Listening ("It goes too fast, I panic and lose everything"). Say plainly and often that **these are trainable habits, not a judgment of intelligence or of their English**. Never say "you'll fail" or "that's a band 5 answer"; say "that's one mark we can win back." Be honest about progress, too: across an 8-week course, **a gain of about half a band is common and realistic; bigger jumps happen but are not guaranteed**, and they depend on many hours of practice outside class. Listening and Reading usually move first, because technique alone recovers marks, so these two classes are a good place to build confidence. Scores are private: never read them aloud, never rank learners, and let learners keep their results to themselves if they want to. For learners who have been through interviews or exams that decided where they could live, a timed test can bring back difficult feelings. Tell the class what will happen before every timed set, keep your tone calm, and allow anyone to put the pen down and breathe for a moment.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board): correction cues, signposts and direction words (C5); skim/scan and question-type cards (C6); qualifier cards and **T / F / NG answer cards** (C7: one set of three per learner, ideally on three colors of paper).
- ◆ For C5: the **caller identity cards** and **receptionist forms** (Set B, one card and one form per learner). The identity cards are fully invented (name to spell, number, dates), so no learner has to share personal details.
- ◆ For C6: the **Trap Bingo** grids (Set E, one per learner, cut apart) for the warmer, and the **Explain your route** cards (Set C, one A/B pair per pair).
- ◆ For C7: the **Prove it** debate cards (Set D, one set per pair) and the T / F / NG answer cards.
- ◆ For C8: the **Practice Test 1** papers from [assessment/practice-test-1.html](#) (question booklet and answer sheet for every learner, plus 2 spares), the teacher's Listening script that goes with the test, and the **C8 kit** (Set F: briefing script, door sign, calm card). For C9: the **error-type tally sheets** and **results tracker** (Set F) and the key and conversion table in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#).
- ◆ Rehearse every read-aloud script (Set G) once, with a timer. Mark where you will pause. For the two-voice scripts, arrange a second reader or record them.
- ◆ Check the room: can the back row hear you clearly with the door shut? Is there a wall clock everyone can see? (Bring a large clock or project a countdown timer for the timed stages.)
- ◆ Optional but powerful: find one short public-domain or open-license text on a neutral topic (a science-news article, a museum page) and write three T / F / NG statements of your own for C7 early finishers. Writing statements is the best way to understand them.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.1	C5 • wk 3	Listening: the four parts (social → academic, one play only); four habits (read ahead and predict, follow signposts, take the correction, never freeze); form / note completion, map and plan labeling, multiple choice; spelling, plurals, numbers (-teen / -ty), letters, dates and word limits	complete a Part 1 form, label a plan, and answer Part 3 and Part 4 questions from one hearing, writing every answer in the exact form and within the word limit, and say which habit won (or lost) each mark
2.2	C6 • wk 3	Reading: 3 passages, 40 questions, 60 minutes, no transfer time; skim (map) vs scan (locate); keyword → paraphrase ; passage order; the word-match trap; strategies for completion, multiple choice, short answer and matching information; time budgeting	skim an original ~600-word academic passage in two minutes, answer 13 mixed questions within a time budget, and explain to a partner exactly where each answer was and which words paraphrased the question
2.3	C7 • wk 4	True / False / Not Given (and Yes / No / Not Given): confirm • clash • silence; qualifiers that flip truth; matching headings (main idea, not detail); matching features (whole passage, do last); the Prove it routine	label T / F / NG statements on an original passage and defend each label with evidence (the paraphrase pair, the clashing words, or the missing piece), and match headings and features while avoiding the detail trap
PT1	C8 • wk 4	Practice Test 1: timed Listening (teacher-read, about 30 minutes) and Reading (up to 60 minutes) under exam conditions	complete a full Listening and Reading practice test calmly under exam conditions, then (in C9) mark it strictly, estimate a band, tally their error types and choose two "leaks" to fix before Practice Test 2

2.1 · C5

IELTS Listening — Strategies & Question Types

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- describe the four parts of IELTS Listening (Part 1 social conversation, Part 2 social monologue, Part 3 academic discussion, Part 4 lecture), the rising difficulty, and the fact that each recording is heard **once only**
- use the reading time to **predict the answer type** for each gap (number, name, date, place, plural noun, verb) and underline keywords in multiple-choice options
- hear **signposts** (*The main problem was... · What you need to remember is...*) and **correction cues** (*actually · sorry, I mean · no, wait · it's not X, it's Y*) and write the **final** version
- write numbers, dates, spelled names and plurals exactly, telling *thirTEEN* from *THIRty* and confusable letters (A/E/I, G/J, B/P/V, M/N), and keep within the word limit
- follow directions to label a plan (*on your left, opposite, beyond, in the far corner*) after fixing their orientation
- keep going after a missed answer instead of freezing

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 2.1 (key words, language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Part 1 information-gap frame, self-check, error tally)
- Slides 2–9 · Flashcards: correction cues, signposts, direction words, Part 1 picture contexts · **Caller identity cards + receptionist forms** (Set B) · a countdown timer
- Listening scripts **2.1-A** (letters and numbers), **2.1-B** (Part 1: the course enrollment call), **2.1-C** (Part 2: the Student Center plan), **2.1-D** (Part 3: the project tutorial), **2.1-E** (Part 4: the urban heat lecture)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the test. 4 parts · 40 questions · about 30 min · **ONE play only.** Part 1 social, 2 speakers (forms) → Part 2 social, 1 speaker (maps, talks) → Part 3 academic, 2–4 speakers (discussion) → Part 4 academic, 1 speaker (lecture). Easy → hard.

Center: four habits. 1 **Read ahead + predict** (number? name? place? plural?) · 2 **Signposts** (*The main problem was... / What you need to remember...*) · 3 **Take the correction** (*actually · sorry · no, wait · or rather* → the second answer wins) · 4 **Never freeze** (missed it? let it go, catch the next one).

Right: protect the mark. thirTEEN ≠ THIRty · "double L" = LL · "oh" = 0 · A/E/I, G/J, B/P/V · book ≠ books · NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS → 3 words = 0 · \$ or km already printed? don't write it again. CAPITALS are fine.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: paraphrase ping-pong	7	S-S	Review C2-C4 (paraphrasing and grammar for a high band). Board six short phrases: <i>the cost went up</i> · <i>lots of people</i> · <i>at the start</i> · <i>not allowed</i> · <i>the most important reason</i> · <i>it was built in 2019</i> . Pairs say each one a different way, fast (<i>prices rose</i> · <i>a large number of people</i> · <i>initially</i> · <i>prohibited</i> · <i>the main factor</i> · <i>it was completed in 2019</i>). Then say: "In today's listening, the recording will almost never use the question's words. It uses <i>your partner's</i> words." Note one strong paraphrase and one error for feedback.
Lead-in: once only	5	T-S	Slide 2. Read one sentence at normal speed, once: "The meeting's on Tuesday — oh, no, sorry, they moved it to Thursday." Ask: "When's the meeting?" Most say Thursday; some say Tuesday. "In IELTS you hear everything once . No replay. So today is not about better ears. It's about better habits ." Slide 3: the four parts (quick, from the learners: who has taken IELTS before? what was Part 4 like?).
Strategy: four habits	10	T-S	Slides 4-6. Predict : show three gaps (<i>The tour leaves from the main ____ at 9:30</i>) and elicit the answer type before anyone hears anything. Signposts and corrections : stick the flashcards on the board in two columns ("the answer is coming" · "the answer is changing"). Never freeze : "Missing question 14 costs one mark. Freezing on it costs 15, 16 and 17 too." CCQs (below).
Drill + dictation: letters and numbers	8	T-S → S	Slide 7. Quick choral drill of <i>-teen</i> / <i>-ty</i> stress and the confusable letters (Drill script), then read Script 2.1-A (10 items, each twice). Learners write in Workbook Ex 1. Check on the board at once; learners correct in a second color. Anyone with 10/10: "Now write the <i>spoken</i> form of item 8 so your partner can read it aloud."
Guided practice 1: the Part 1 form	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2. Give 2 minutes of reading time: learners write a prediction beside each gap (<i>number</i> · <i>surname</i> · <i>day</i> · <i>plural noun</i> ...). Pairs compare predictions (1 min). Read Script 2.1-B once, at test speed. Learners compare answers in pairs, then you read it a second time, pausing after each correction cue ("Did you hear the change?"). Check against the key and ask: "Which answers had a trap? What kind?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Guided practice 2: plan labeling	10	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 3 (the Student Center plan; project slide 8 too). Before listening, fix the orientation together: "Where are you standing? (At the entrance, at the bottom.) Which way is left?" Learners write the position of each letter in words (<i>A = inside the entrance, left</i>). Read Script 2.1-C once; learners label. Check, walking the route on the projected plan with your finger. Point out the two unused letters: "Were they mentioned? (Yes!) Were they answers? (No.)"
Timed practice: Parts 3 and 4	12	S	Exam conditions. Workbook Ex 4. Give 30 seconds to read Questions 21–24, read Script 2.1-D once; give 30 seconds to read Questions 31–35, read Script 2.1-E once. No pausing, no repeating, no talking. Then 1 minute of "transfer time" to check spelling, plurals and blanks. Tell learners before you start exactly what will happen.
Self-mark + error tally	6	S → S-S	Project or read the answers for Ex 2–4. Learners mark strictly (spelling and plurals count; over the limit = 0) and write a code beside every wrong answer (D S W N L P , see workbook). They total each code in the tally box. Pairs compare: "What was your biggest leak today?" Hands up for each code; board the class totals without names.
Freer: Part 1 information gap — "Build the trap"	12	S-S	Slide 9. Pairs: A is a caller with an invented identity card; B is a receptionist with a blank form. The caller must spell the name, give a phone number and a date, and build in one correction (" <i>It's the 14th — sorry, no, the 15th</i> "). B completes the form, then reads it back. They compare with the card, then swap roles with a new card. ICQs first (below).
Feedback	3	T-S	Delayed correction. Board what you heard: letter names (" <i>G said as /dʒeɪ/</i> "), <i>fifteen</i> / <i>fifty</i> stress, dates ("the fifteen of May"). Praise good trap-building ("Oh, did I say Tuesday? I meant Wednesday."). Learners fix and repeat.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.1 on screen and point at a  button and the UK/US voice switch. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 10 + 8 + 12 + 10 + 12 + 6 + 12 + 3 + 5

Meaning: prediction. Before the recording starts, the gap already tells you most of what you need: the grammar around it gives the word class, and the context gives the type (a time, a price, a place).

SAY: "The library closes at ____ on weekdays." What kind of answer? (A time.) Could it be "Monday"? (No: the sentence already says "weekdays.") · "Bring two forms of ____." Singular or plural? (Plural or uncountable: "two forms of identification / ID.") · Do you predict the exact word? (No, the type. The exact word comes from the recording.)

Meaning: distractor and correction. A distractor is a possible answer that the speaker says and then rejects or changes. It is deliberately placed to test whether you follow the whole idea.

SAY: "The deposit is fifty dollars — sorry, they've just put it up to sixty." How much is the deposit? (Sixty.) Is "fifty" in the recording? (Yes.) Is it the answer? (No.) Which word told you it was changing? (Sorry.) · "Most people pick yoga, but the included class is actually Pilates." Which class is included? (Pilates.) Why is "yoga" there? (To catch people who write the first thing they hear.)

Meaning: the word limit. "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER" is part of the marking, not advice.

SAY: The answer you hear is "student identification cards." The limit is two words. Can you write all three? (No: zero marks.) Can you write "card"? (No: it's plural, and you lost a word.) What's safe? ("identification cards" or "ID cards.") · A price, and "\$" is already printed. Do you write "\$70"? (No need: just "70." Writing it again can break the limit.) · Do hyphenated words and numbers count? (A number counts as a number; "twenty-one" written in figures is safest: 21.)

Form: numbers, dates, letters.

-teen vs -ty	stress at the end vs the start; -teen has a long vowel	thirTEEN /θɜːr'ti:n/ · THIRty /'θɜːrti/ · fifTEEN · FIFTy
Phone numbers	"oh" = 0 · "double" = two the same · said in groups	"oh-seven-seven-double-oh" = 07700
Dates	spoken with <i>the ... of</i> ; written clearly either way	"the nineteenth of March" → 19 March / March 19
Spelled names	"double R" = RR · confusable pairs	F-E-double R-E-I-R-A → FERREIRA · A/E/I · G/J · B/P/V · M/N · Q/U · Y/I
Corrections	the final version wins	actually · sorry, I mean · no, wait · in fact · on second thought · or rather · it's not X, it's Y
Directions	fix where you stand first	on your left / right · opposite · next to · halfway along · beyond · at the far end · in the far corner · in the middle

Pronunciation. The *-teen* / *-ty* contrast is mostly **stress and length**: *fourTEEN* has a long, stressed final syllable; *FORty* has a short, weak one, and in American English the *t* in *thirty*, *forty*, *sixty* often becomes a quick "d"-like tap (/ʔɜːrɪ/), which helps. In a list or at the end of a phrase the stress can shift ("**FOUR**teen **DOLL**ars"), so train learners to listen for the **length** of the "-teen" vowel as well. The English letter names that cause most trouble: **A** /eɪ/, **E** /i:/, **I** /aɪ/, **G** /dʒi:/, **J** /dʒeɪ/, **R** /ɑːr/, **Y** /waɪ/, **W** "double-U", **Z** "zee" (American) or "zed" (British: IELTS speakers may use it).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Teen or ty?** (choral, then individual) T says a number; learners hold up 1 finger for *-teen*, 2 for *-ty*: *thirteen · fifty · fourteen · forty · seventy · sixteen · eighteen · ninety*. Then learners say pairs back: "fifTEEN, FIFTy."
- 2 **Letter pairs:** T: "A" → S: "A, /eɪ/." T: "E" → "/i:/." T: "I" → "/aɪ/." T: "G" → "/dʒi:/." T: "J" → "/dʒeɪ/." Then T spells, S writes: *G-A-I-J-E · double L · Y-W*.
- 3 **Take the second one** (fast): T: "Room fourteen — sorry, forty." S: "Forty." T: "Tuesday — no, wait, Thursday." S: "Thursday." T: "a blue folder — well, any color, but I'd bring a red one." S: "Red." T: "The talk starts at 9:30. Get there by 9:15." S: "Which question? Start or arrive?" (Praise that answer: it's the right instinct.)

◆ "BUILD THE TRAP" INFORMATION GAP — HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs, two rounds.** Learner A takes a **caller identity card** (Set B: six invented people, each with a name to spell, an address number, a phone number, a date, a choice between two options and a built-in correction). Learner B takes a **receptionist form** for the same business (a sports center, a language school, a clinic, a bike rental, a museum tour, a community garden).
- ◆ **The call (3 min):** B runs the call ("Good morning, how can I help?"), asks for each detail and writes it on the form. A reads naturally, spells the name, says the phone number in groups ("*oh-seven-seven...*") and **must deliver the correction** printed on the card, in natural words.
- ◆ **The check (1 min):** B reads the completed form back; A compares it with the card. Any mismatch? Find out why: a letter, a number, the correction?
- ◆ **Swap** with a new card. In round 2, A may invent one extra trap of their own (a *-teen* / *-ty* pair is the favorite).
- ◆ If a learner prefers not to speak much, they can be the receptionist in both rounds: it is the listening role, and the one that practices the test.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE INFORMATION GAP

SAY: *Callers: is this your real name and number? (No: the card's.) What must you include? (A correction.) · Receptionists: can you see the caller's card? (No.) What do you do at the end? (Read the form back.) · When do you swap? (After the check.)*

LITERACY SUPPORT

Most IELTS candidates read well, but some learners are strong speakers with slow reading or handwriting in the Latin alphabet (for example, learners schooled mainly in Arabic, Chinese, Amharic or Tamil script). The pressure point today is **writing while listening**. Let them write answers in **CAPITALS** (allowed in the test, and easier to read back), give them the reading-time predictions pre-filled for Ex 2 items 1–4, and let them do Ex 4 Part 3 only (4 items) and add Part 4 at home with the online lesson. In the dictation, reduce to items 1–6. Target: every answer they *do* write is spelled exactly.

STRETCH (BAND 7+)

Band 7+ listeners lose marks in Part 4, where there is no pause and the paraphrase is dense. Ask them to write the **paraphrase pair** beside each Part 4 answer ("*dark materials*" → "*surfaces such as roads and roofs*") and to note the signpost that came just before it. In the information gap, they build **two** traps, one a "not X but Y" and one an answer that depends on the question ("The talk starts at 9:30; get there by 9:15"). Early finishers: write a four-line Part 1 script with two distractors for the class to use in the C6 warmer.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Letter names:** Spanish, Portuguese, Italian and many other speakers hear English **E** /i:/ as their "I" and English **A** /eɪ/ as their "E", so *Ferreira* becomes "Farreira" or "Firreira." French and Spanish speakers often swap **G** and **J** (their names for these letters are roughly the reverse of English). Arabic speakers may confuse **P/B** and **V/F** when writing a spelled name; Japanese and Korean speakers may confuse **R/L**. Drill the pairs, and in any spelled answer, tell learners to write the letters as they hear them, then read them back.
- ◆ **"Actually" is a false friend:** Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, Portuguese *atualmente*, Italian *attualmente*, German *aktuell* and Russian *актуально* mean "currently." In English, *actually* usually introduces a **correction or surprise**, one of the most important cues in the test. Make this explicit.
- ◆ **Large numbers:** Chinese, Japanese and Korean group large numbers by ten thousand (*wàn* / *man*), and Hindi and Urdu speakers may think in *lakh* (100,000) and *crore*. "Two hundred and forty thousand" can come out as 24,000. Practice writing big numbers from dictation. Many European languages use a **decimal comma** (3,5): in the test, write 3.5.
- ◆ **Final consonants and plurals:** Vietnamese, Cantonese, Mandarin, Thai and some other speakers may not hear (or write) a final -s or -ed, which turns *batteries* into *battery* (zero marks). Use the grammar around the gap: "spare ____" + "bring" = probably plural.
- ◆ **Dates:** American month/day and British day/month orders both appear. 3/5 is ambiguous; tell learners to write dates with the month as a word: **19 March** or **March 19**. Both are accepted.
- ◆ **British words in the recording:** *car park*, *ground floor* / *first floor*, *queue*, *postcode*, *timetable*, *flat*. Learners who know American English may not recognize them. In the real test a "first floor" room is one

level above the entrance.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_04.html. Listen to the five signpost sentences with 🗣️ (try the UK voice, then the US voice) and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz; build the "predict-then-listen" practice set (a 150–250-word transcript with one built-in distractor) and swap it with a partner if possible. Workbook 2.1: Exercise 5 (spot the correction), the error tally if not finished in class, "My new words" and the journal (your hardest question type and the one habit you will drill this week).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** 11 June (the correction after "sorry") · Q2 **B** identification cards (two words, plural kept) · Q3 (new) **B** GARRICK (one word, spelled exactly; capitals are fine; "Building" is already printed). Dictation (Ex 1): 1 OKAFOR · 2 16 · 3 JG415 · 4 MALLORY · 5 4 August / August 4 · 6 0799 450 218 · 7 WHITFIELD · 8 240,000 · 9 50 · 10 BV7330. Part 1 form (Ex 2): photography · Ferreira · 82 · 07700 900482 · Wednesday(s) · 19 March · 70 · 40 · batteries · back. Plan (Ex 3): 11 **B** · 12 **F** · 13 **D** · 14 **G** · 15 **C** · 16 **H**. Parts 3–4 (Ex 4): 21 **B** · 22 **B** · 23 **B** · 24 **C** · 31 roofs · 32 moisture · 33 traffic · 34 white · 35 3 / three.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ state the shape of Academic Reading (3 passages of rising difficulty, 40 questions, 60 minutes, **no transfer time**) and plan about 20 minutes per passage
- ◆ **skim** a passage in 2–3 minutes (title, first and last sentences, topic sentences, signposts) to build a map of "what's where," and **scan** for a keyword to locate one answer
- ◆ find a question's **keyword**, predict its **paraphrase**, and match meaning rather than surface words, avoiding the **word-match trap**
- ◆ apply the right strategy to sentence completion, multiple choice, short answer and matching information, using **passage order** where it applies and leaving whole-passage types for last
- ◆ obey word limits, copy spelling exactly, and never leave a blank

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.2 (key words, language box, the passage "**Paths of Desire**", Exercises 1–5, dialogue, self-check, error tally)
- ◆ Slides 10–13 · Flashcards: skim / scan, question types, academic signposts · **Trap Bingo** grids (Set E, one per learner) · **Explain your route** cards (Set C) · a countdown timer · highlighters (two colors per learner, if possible)
- ◆ Script 2.2-A (Trap Bingo caller's list) · Script 2.2-B (scan-race questions, read aloud)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the clock. 3 passages · 40 Qs · 60 min · **NO transfer time** → write answers as you go. P1 ≈ 17 min · P2 ≈ 20 min · P3 ≈ 23 min. Stuck? Guess, mark it, move on. No blanks: there's no penalty for a wrong answer.

Center: skim → scan → locate → answer. SKIM (2–3 min): title · first + last sentence of each paragraph · signposts (*however, as a result, for instance*) = the **map**. SCAN: one question → keyword (name, number, term) → hunt its **paraphrase** → read closely there only.

Right: paraphrase, not word-match. Q: "with users' permission" → text: "with users' consent". Q: "similar sites" → text: "comparable sites". The sentence that repeats the question's words is often the trap. **In order:** completion, MCQ, short answer · **Any order, do last:** matching information / features / headings.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Trap Bingo	8	S (whole class)	Review C5. Each learner gets a Trap Bingo grid (Set E). Read the caller's list (Script 2.2-A): every call contains a trap (" <i>Room fourteen — sorry, forty</i> ", " <i>G-A-I-J-E</i> "). Learners cross out the final version only. First to complete a line calls "Bingo!" and reads the line back; if it contains a distractor, the game goes on. Stop at 7 minutes; quickly board any call that fooled several people.
Lead-in: the clock	4	T-S	Slide 10. Ask: "In your own language, how do you find the time of the last train on a timetable? Do you read every line?" (No: you jump to the right place.) Then the facts: 60 minutes, 3 passages, 40 questions, no transfer time. "What does 'no transfer time' mean for you?" (Write answers on the sheet as you go.) "The biggest leak in Reading isn't difficult words. It's the clock."
Strategy: skim vs scan	7	T-S	Slide 11. Compare the two modes (goal, eyes, what you read, when). Model skimming aloud on the passage title and paragraph A's first and last sentences: "I'm not answering anything yet; I'm building a map." CCQs (below). Point out the academic signposts (<i>however, as a result, for instance, perhaps</i>): they mark the joints of an argument.
Drill: skim or scan? + paraphrase ping-pong	4	T-S → S	Two quick rounds (see Drill script). Choral, then individual.
Skim (timed)	5	S → T-S	Workbook Ex 1. Learners turn the page to "Paths of Desire" and get exactly 2 minutes (timer on screen) to skim, then turn the passage face down and answer Ex 1 (main idea in one line; which paragraph is about technology, an experiment, a warning). Check. Most learners are surprised how much they know after 2 minutes: say so.
Scan race	5	S-S (teams)	Workbook Ex 2. Teams of 3. Read each scan question aloud (Script 2.2-B); the first team to shout the paragraph letter <i>and</i> the answer wins a point. Ask

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			each winner: "What did your eyes look for?" (A capital letter, a number, a year, quotation marks.) Six questions, fast.
Keyword → paraphrase (modeling)	6	T-S	Slide 12. Take Question 2 ("Kowalski's study suggests walkers consider comfort and ____ as well as time"). Think aloud: keyword = <i>Kowalski</i> (a name can't be paraphrased) → paragraph B → the question's <i>consider</i> becomes the text's <i>weigh; as well as time</i> becomes <i>alongside time</i> → answer: <i>perceived safety</i> (two words, copied exactly). Underline the keyword in one color and the paraphrase in another. CCQs.
Guided walkthrough: Questions 1–7	13	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 3. Slide 13 (strategy per type). For each question type, model the first item aloud, then pairs do the rest of that type: sentence completion (Q1–4: predict the word class, count words, copy exactly), multiple choice (Q5–7: read all options, find the text zone, eliminate; look for the option that repeats the text's words and ask whether it is a trap). Board-check each type before moving on.
Timed practice: Questions 8–13	8	S	Exam conditions: 7 minutes , silent, answers straight onto the page (no transfer). Short answer (Q8–10) first, because it follows passage order; matching information (Q11–13) last, because it doesn't. One minute's warning at 6 minutes: "Fill every blank."
Self-mark + paraphrase map + tally	7	S → S-S	Project the answers for Q1–13. Learners mark strictly (spelling, word limit), code every wrong answer (P missed the paraphrase · M fell for a word-match · W word limit / wrong form · S copied a word wrongly · T time / blank · O looked in the wrong place), then complete Ex 4 (the paraphrase map) for the questions they got right: "Prove you didn't guess."
Freer: Explain your route	9	S-S	Pairs, Explain your route cards (Set C). Each learner has three new questions on the same passage that their partner has not seen. They find their answers silently (3 min), then take turns guiding their partner to each answer <i>without saying it</i> : "Go to paragraph D. Find the word that means 'similar.' Now read the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			sentence it's in..." The partner must find and say the answer. ICQs first (below).
Time-budgeting clinic	5	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 5. Pairs decide what to do in three clock scenarios ("26 minutes on Passage 1 and three questions left..."), then fill in their own 60-minute plan . Agree a class rule: "At minute 20 and minute 40, I move on, whatever happens."
Feedback	4	T-S	Board 2–3 items from the tally ("Most of our misses were P and M today") and 2–3 language items from the route task: accuracy (" <i>in the paragraph B</i> ", " <i>the second sentence of the paragraph C</i> "), and range to praise (" <i>it's a paraphrase of...</i> ", " <i>the text says... whereas the option says...</i> ").
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.2 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..."
Total	90		8 + 4 + 7 + 4 + 5 + 5 + 6 + 13 + 8 + 7 + 9 + 5 + 4 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: skimming and scanning. Skimming is reading fast for the **gist and the structure** (which paragraph does what). Scanning is moving your eyes fast to **find one thing**, then reading closely only there.

SAY: "I read the first and last sentence of each paragraph." Skim or scan? (Skim.) Am I answering questions yet? (No: making a map.) · "I'm looking for the year 2011." Skim or scan? (Scan.) Do I read the sentences around it? (Only when I find it.) · Should you read the whole passage carefully before the questions? (No: that's the biggest time-sink.)

Meaning: keyword and paraphrase. The keyword is the part of the question that is hard to change: a name, a number, a place, a technical term. The rest of the question is usually **paraphrased** in the text.

SAY: "Critics are worried that data may not show how all groups of people walk." Which is the best word to scan for? (Critics, or data.) Will the text say "all groups of people"? (Probably not: maybe "older residents," "people with limited mobility.") · The question says "permission." The text says "consent." Same meaning? (Yes.) So is the sentence with "consent" a good place to look? (Yes.)

Meaning: the word-match trap. An option that repeats the text's exact words is not automatically right; it is often the distractor.

SAY: Question 5, option C: "appear mainly on university campuses." Does the text contain "university campuses"? (Yes.) Does it say paths appear mainly there? (No: the study was done there.) So is C right?

(No: it's a word-match trap.)

Form: how questions paraphrase.

Synonym	a different word, same meaning	permission → consent · similar → comparable · consider → weigh
Word class change	verb ↔ noun ↔ adjective	visible → easier to see · to maintain → maintenance · recover → recovery
Active ↔ passive	same fact, different subject	designers delayed the paths → paving was delayed
General ↔ specific	a category for an example	drones → technology · older residents → some groups
Negative ↔ positive	the same idea said the other way	far fewer shortcuts → not as many shortcuts
Order & signposts	completion, MCQ, short answer, T/F/NG follow the passage; matching types don't	however · as a result · for instance · perhaps · in contrast · increasingly

Pronunciation. Reading is silent, but learners need to *say* answers and routes in the pair task. Drill the stress on the passage's academic words: *pe-DES-tri-an*, *ge-O-gra-pher*, *in-sti-TU-tion*, **COM**-pa-ra-ble (not *com-PAR-a-ble*), *re-in-FORCE*, *phi-lo-SO-phi-cal*. And the letters: "paragraph E" /i:/ vs "paragraph A" /eɪ/ vs "paragraph I" /aɪ/: the C5 letter work pays off again.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Skim or scan?** (fast, choral): T: "Find the year the campus opened." → S: "Scan!" T: "What's the passage about?" → "Skim!" T: "Which paragraph gives a warning?" → "Skim!" (then scan for the warning signpost: *critics warn*). T: "Who is Hana Kowalski?" → "Scan!" (a capital letter).
- 2 **Paraphrase ping-pong** (individual): T: "permission" → S: "consent." T: "similar" → "comparable." T: "more visible" → "easier to see." T: "at first" → "initially." T: "cheaper" → "less expensive / lower cost." T: "a warning" → "critics warn / caution." T: "reduced" → "cut / fell / decreased."
- 3 **Trap or answer?** T reads one question and one sentence from the text; learners say "match" or "trap": Q: "The study took place mainly on campuses." Text: "A study of three university campuses..." (Match: it's about where the study happened.) Q: "Paths mainly form on campuses." Same text. (Trap: the text doesn't say that.)

◆ "EXPLAIN YOUR ROUTE" – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs.** Card A has three questions (a completion, a multiple choice, a "which paragraph"); card B has three different ones. Both sets are on "Paths of Desire," and the answers are on a fold-back strip at the bottom of each card.

- ◆ **Find (3 min, silent):** each learner answers their own three questions and underlines the evidence in the passage.
- ◆ **Guide (5 min):** A guides B to A's first answer in three steps: **where** ("paragraph C, near the middle"), **which words** ("find the words that mean 'more visible'"), **what to do** ("the answer is the noun after that"). B must find and say the answer. Then B guides A. Alternate.
- ◆ **Rule:** the guide may not say the answer or read the sentence aloud. That forces the paraphrase language: *"The question says X; the text says Y."*
- ◆ **Debrief (1 min):** "Whose route was the fastest? What made it fast?" (A keyword that can't be paraphrased: a name or a number.)

◆ ICQS BEFORE EXPLAIN YOUR ROUTE

SAY: Do you and your partner have the same questions? (No.) Can you say the answer? (No.) Can you read the sentence aloud? (No.) What can you say? (The paragraph, the paraphrase, what to look for.) How long to find your answers? (Three minutes.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

For slower readers, the 60-minute clock is the whole battle, so give them the **map** first: a copy of the passage with the first sentence of each paragraph already highlighted. In the timed stage, set Q8–10 and Q11 only. In the scan race, let them scan for numbers and capitals (the easiest targets). Teach the finger or card trick: move a card down the page to stop the eyes going back. Tell them honestly that IELTS offers **special arrangements** (for example extra time or enlarged print) for candidates with a documented need such as dyslexia or a visual impairment, and that they must apply through the test center well before the test date.

STRETCH (BAND 7+)

Strong readers often lose marks by **over-thinking** multiple choice and by writing more than the limit. Ask them to write, for each MCQ option, **why it is wrong** in five words ("A: contradicted, 'longer' in B"). Then give them the Passage 3 challenge: write two new questions on "Paths of Desire" with a deliberate word-match trap, for a partner to solve. Early finishers: which sentence in paragraph F states the writer's own view? (Most of it: "Perhaps the most important lesson...") That leads straight into Yes / No / Not Given in C7.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **The "read every word" habit:** learners from education systems built on close reading, translation or memorization (common in many countries) may feel that skimming is lazy or even dishonest. Frame it as a **professional skill** (lawyers, doctors and researchers skim every day) and ban dictionaries and translation apps during timed practice.

- ◆ **Script direction and speed:** readers whose first literacy is in Arabic, Persian or Urdu (right to left) or in a logographic script such as Chinese may read English more slowly at first even with strong vocabulary. Skimming by topic sentences helps them most. Never comment on reading speed publicly.
- ◆ **False friends in paraphrase:** Spanish, Portuguese, French and Italian speakers gain a lot from cognates (*comparable, institution, maintenance*) but can be misled by false ones: *eventually* (= in the end, not "possibly," Spanish *eventualmente*), *actually* (= in fact), *sensible* (= reasonable, not "sensitive"), *library* (not a bookstore, French *librairie*).
- ◆ **Articles and prepositions in answers:** "in the paragraph B," "at the page 3" (many languages). In the test, an extra word in an answer can break the limit: if the limit is two words and the answer is "clay," writing "the clay" is fine only if it fits.
- ◆ **Plurals copied wrongly:** learners whose languages do not mark plurals (Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai, Indonesian, Japanese, Korean) may copy "aerial photograph" for "aerial photographs." Copy the **exact** form the gap needs.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_05.html. Listen to the five academic topic sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz; do the timed mixed-type drill (the axolotl passage, or any short article), strictly to the clock. Workbook 2.2: finish Exercise 4 (paraphrase map) and Exercise 5 (your 60-minute plan), "My new words" and the journal (which mode, skim or scan, is weaker for you, and the one habit you will practice). Tell learners: "Next class is the last new lesson before Practice Test 1."

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C skim the whole passage quickly for gist and structure · Q2 C zero: three words break a two-word limit · Q3 (new) B guess the three, mark them, and move to Passage 2 now. Passage (Ex 3): 1 maintenance problem · 2 (perceived) safety · 3 clay · 4 aerial photographs · 5 B · 6 B · 7 C · 8 desire lines · 9 (a / one / a single) semester · 10 drones · 11 E · 12 C · 13 A.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ apply the core rule: **TRUE** = the text confirms it · **FALSE** = the text contradicts it · **NOT GIVEN** = the text is silent; and use the same logic for **YES / NO / NOT GIVEN** (the writer's views), writing the labels the instructions ask for
- ◆ tell False from Not Given with one question: "**Can I point to the words that clash?**"
- ◆ defend every label with the **Prove it** routine: the paraphrase pair (True), the clashing words (False), or the missing piece (Not Given)
- ◆ notice **qualifiers** that flip a statement (*all / some, always / often, only, the most, no more likely*) and ignore their own knowledge of the world
- ◆ match headings to a paragraph's **main idea**, not a detail, and match features (people, organizations) across the whole passage, last

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.3 (key words, language box, Passage A "**The Late Learner Advantage?**" with numbered sentences, Passage B "**Lighting the Night Differently**", Exercises 1–5, dialogue, self-check, error tally) · Workbook: **Practice Test 1 — before the test** page
- ◆ Slides 14–17 · Flashcards: qualifiers, contradiction signals · **T / F / NG answer cards** (one set per learner) · **Prove it** debate cards (Set D) · a countdown timer · highlighters
- ◆ Script 2.3-A (quick-fire T / F / NG drill)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the rule. TRUE = the text **confirms** it · FALSE = the text **contradicts** it (a clash) · NOT GIVEN = the text is **silent**. YES / NO / NOT GIVEN = the same logic for the **writer's views** (*argues, believes, suggests*). Write the words the instructions use. The deciding question: **Can I point to the words that clash?** Yes → F. No → NG.

Center: Prove it. Locate (passage order) → Underline → Label → Defend. **T:** the paraphrase pair ("*main prey*" = "*main food source*") · **F:** quote the clash ("*longer*" ≠ "*shorter*") · **NG:** "The text talks about X, but not Y." Traps: my own knowledge · qualifiers (*all/some · always/often · only · the most*) · half-true statements.

Right: matching. HEADINGS: main idea (topic sentence), not a detail · easy ones first · more headings than paragraphs · detail trap. FEATURES: underline the name → find every mention → match on meaning · letters can repeat · any order → **do last**.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: paraphrase relay	7	S-S (teams)	Review C6 with "Paths of Desire." Teams of 3 stand in a line; you call a paraphrase (" <i>a free source of information</i> " · " <i>people who can't walk easily</i> " · " <i>photographs taken from above</i> " · " <i>a single university term</i> "). The first learner in each line scans, finds the original words and writes them on the board with the paragraph letter; then goes to the back. Correct = 1 point. Check who remembered the time rule ("At minute 20 and 40, I move on").
Lead-in: False or just not there?	5	T-S	Board a one-line "text": " <i>The teacher arrived at 6:55 with a cup of tea.</i> " Then four statements: (1) <i>The teacher arrived before 7:00.</i> (2) <i>The teacher arrived after 7:00.</i> (3) <i>The teacher drank coffee.</i> (4) <i>The teacher came by car.</i> Learners vote with fingers. Discuss: (1) True; (2) False: "6:55" clashes with "after 7:00"; (3) tempting to say False, but can you point to words that say the teacher did <i>not</i> drink coffee? (No: the text only says what the teacher was carrying.) Not Given; (4) Not Given: the text is silent. "Today: the question that decides it."
Strategy: the core rule	8	T-S	Slide 14. The three answers and the deciding question. Show the difference between T/F/NG (facts) and Y/N/NG (the writer's views) and the zero-mark trap of writing "True" on a Yes/No task. Walk through the "Urban Bees" examples from the online lesson (learners saw them at home) in 2 minutes. CCQs (below).
Drill: T / F / NG cards	6	T-S → S	Each learner holds three cards (T, F, NG). Read Script 2.3-A : a one-sentence text and a statement, twice. Everyone shows a card on "3, 2, 1, show!" Pick a learner with each answer to justify (always ask the NG holders first when the class is split). Eight items; keep it fast.
Modeling: Prove it	6	T-S	Slide 15. Workbook Passage A. Model statements 1 and 2 aloud: locate (sentence 3 and 4, in order), underline, label, defend. Write the evidence in the three columns of Ex 1: label · sentence number · evidence words . For 2 (False), quote the clash: " <i>adults and teenagers often make faster progress</i> " vs " <i>young children make faster progress.</i> "
Controlled: T / F / NG with evidence	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1, statements 3–9, alone and silent (7 min). Every answer needs evidence in the right-hand column; for NG they write "The text talks about ____ but not ____." Then

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			pairs compare <i>evidence</i> , not just labels (3 min). Board-check only the disagreements.
Freer: Prove it debates	10	S-S	Slide 16. Pairs take a Prove it card (Set D): a statement about Passage A or B, plus an assigned side for each learner (e.g. A argues "False," B argues "Not Given"). Each has 30 seconds to make the case with evidence; the pair then agrees the real answer and the reason. Three cards per pair, rotate sides. ICQs first (below). Walk around and collect good evidence language.
Matching headings: technique + timed set	13	T-S → S	Slide 16. Teach the technique (main idea, easy ones first, eliminate, expect extra headings) using the example in Ex 3 (paragraph A → i). Point out one trap together: heading iii ("How screens affect our sleep") matches one sentence in C. Then learners read Passage B and do Ex 3 (paragraphs B-F) under time: 8 minutes .
Matching features (timed)	7	S	Workbook Ex 4, 5 minutes . Remind: underline each name (Hale, Nair, the council) everywhere it appears in the passage first; letters can be used more than once. Then 2 minutes to check each other's evidence.
Self-mark + error tally	5	S	Project the answers to Ex 1, 3 and 4. Learners mark and code their misses (F False/NG confusion · K used my own knowledge · Q missed a qualifier · H heading matched a detail · O looked in the wrong place). Ask for hands on each code; board the totals. "The two biggest in this room are the ones to watch in C8."
Practice Test 1 briefing	4	T-S	Slide 17. Tell learners exactly what C8 will be like (see the C8 plan): arrive 10 minutes early; pencil, eraser, water in a clear bottle; phones off and away; Listening read by you, once only, about 30 minutes; Reading up to 60 minutes; answers in capitals are fine; no penalty for wrong answers, so fill every blank. Say it kindly: "This test is for learning. It's a map of where to spend the next four weeks, not a verdict." Learners complete the "before the test" page in the workbook.
Feedback	4	T-S	Delayed correction from the debates. Accuracy: "The text don't say" · "It is not said about..." · "It's false because I know it's true in my country" (a K, not a language error, but worth naming). Range to praise: " <i>The text says X, whereas the</i>

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			statement says Y," "There's no mention of..." "This is a paraphrase of..." "The word 'only' makes it false."
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.3 and a 🗣️ button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 5 + 8 + 6 + 6 + 10 + 10 + 13 + 7 + 5 + 4 + 4 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: False vs Not Given. False needs a **clash**: the text and the statement cannot both be true. Not Given means the text **doesn't tell us**; the statement might be true or false in the real world, but this passage is silent.

SAY: Text: "The museum opened in 1980." Statement: "The museum was the first of its kind in the country." Does the text say it was the first? (No.) Does it say it wasn't? (No.) Can you point to clashing words? (No.) So? (Not Given.) · Text: "Urban parks offer a longer flowering season." Statement: "Parks offer a shorter season." Can you point to a clash? (Yes: "longer.") So? (False.)

SAY: "I know from the news that wolves eat deer, so it's True." Does the passage say it? (Let's check.) If it doesn't, what's the answer? (Not Given.) Does the test care what you know? (No: only what the text says.)

Meaning: qualifiers. Small words set how strong a claim is. A statement that is stronger than the text is usually False (if the text sets a limit) or Not Given (if the text says nothing about the extra strength).

SAY: Text: "Only a few species of frog can survive being frozen." Statement: "Most frogs can survive freezing." Clash? (Yes: "only a few" vs "most.") → False. · Text: "Age made little difference to progress." Statement: "Older learners made much slower progress." Clash? (Yes.) → False. · Text: "Learners used strategies such as note-taking." Statement: "Note-taking is the most effective strategy." Does the text rank the strategies? (No.) → Not Given.

Meaning: main idea vs detail. A heading must summarize the **whole** paragraph. A heading that fits one sentence is a trap.

SAY: Paragraph C of Passage B mentions phone screens in one sentence. Is the paragraph about screens? (No: about the color of streetlights and sleep.) So is "How screens affect our sleep" right? (No: it's the detail trap.) · Will you use every heading? (No: there are more headings than paragraphs.)

Form.

Absolute (easy to over-claim)	all · every · none · always · never · only · solely · the most · proves ·	often False or NG against a careful academic text
--------------------------------------	---	---

	completely	
Limited (what careful texts say)	some · several · many · often · usually · tends to · may · might · can · suggests	"The data suggest..." ≠ "The data prove..."
Contradiction signals	however · but · whereas · unlike · in contrast · rather than · no longer · failed to · by contrast	often the spot where a statement is contradicted
Opinion verbs (Y / N / NG)	argues · believes · claims · suggests · warns · welcomes · is cautious about	the statement is about what the writer (or a named person) thinks
Evidence language	for defending an answer	The text says X, whereas the statement says Y. · There's no mention of... · "Main prey" is a paraphrase of "main food source."

Pronunciation. In the debates, contrastive stress carries the argument: "The text says **SOME** researchers, not **ALL** researchers." "It says **three** years, not **MORE** than three." Model it, then have learners repeat with exaggerated stress. Say the labels clearly: *Not GIVEN* (stress on *GIV*), and "true" /tru:/ vs "through" /θru:/ for learners who merge them.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Show the card** (Script 2.3-A, eight items). After each: "Point to it!" (T or F) or "What's missing?" (NG).
- 2 **Stronger or weaker?** (choral) T: "some" → S: "all is stronger." T: "may" → "will is stronger." T: "often" → "always is stronger." T: "suggests" → "proves is stronger." T: "one of the main reasons" → "the main reason is stronger."
- 3 **Evidence frames** (individual, fast): T gives a label and a clue; S builds the sentence. T: "False · three years / more than three years" → S: "It's False: the text says three years, whereas the statement says more than three." T: "Not Given · women" → S: "It's Not Given: the text talks about the learners, but there's no mention of how many were women."

◆ "PROVE IT" DEBATES – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs, three cards each.** Each Prove it card (Set D) gives a statement about Passage A or B and two assigned positions: **Speaker A** argues one label, **Speaker B** argues another (for example, True vs Not Given). The positions are assigned, so nobody has to "lose" an argument they believe.
- ◆ **Round (3 min per card):** 30 seconds' silent preparation (find the evidence) → A speaks for 30 seconds → B speaks for 30 seconds → together they decide the real answer and write one evidence sentence on the card's line. The answer and reason are on a fold-back strip: check it only after deciding.

- ◆ **Evidence rules:** you must quote or point to the passage (sentence number in Passage A, paragraph letter in Passage B). "I think" and "I know" don't count as evidence.
- ◆ Swap positions on the next card. If a pair finishes early, they write a new statement of their own that is **Not Given** and test it on the next pair.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PROVE IT DEBATES

SAY: *Do you choose your position? (No: the card gives it.) Can you say "I know this is true"? (No: point to the passage.) How long does each speaker have? (30 seconds.) When do you look at the answer strip? (After we decide.) · Before matching headings: will you use all eight headings? (No.) Which paragraphs do you do first? (The easy ones.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Passage A is short and has **numbered sentences** on purpose (a classroom scaffold: the real test has none). For learners who read slowly, set statements 1–6 only and give them the "locate" step for free: the sentence number next to each statement. For headings, give a reduced list (the five right headings plus one trap) and let them do three paragraphs. Keep the T / F / NG cards: the drill is fully oral, so it is where they shine.

STRETCH (BAND 7+)

Strong readers are the ones who over-infer ("It must be True, because..."). Give them the job of **writing** statements: three for Passage B, one of each label, with at least one qualifier trap, to test on a partner. Then introduce **Yes / No / Not Given** with Passage B's paragraph F: "Does the writer think cities should consult residents? (Not the writer: Nair does. So a statement about the *writer's* view would be Not Given.)" That distinction, writer vs quoted person, is a band 8 skill.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Reading between the lines:** learners from school systems and cultures that reward inference ("What does the writer really mean?") will turn Not Given into True or False. Present IELTS logic as a **game with strict rules**, not as the right way to read: in this game, only stated meaning counts.
- ◆ **Answering negative questions:** Japanese, Korean, Chinese, and some other speakers answer a negative question by agreeing with it: "The text doesn't mention farmers?" "Yes" (= "right, it doesn't"). In pair debates this causes real confusion. Teach "Right, it doesn't" / "No, it doesn't" and model it.
- ◆ **"Not Given" as a concept:** many school tests only have true/false. Some learners also come from exam systems with **negative marking** and leave blanks when unsure. Say it plainly: IELTS never takes marks away for a wrong answer, so always write a label.
- ◆ **Qualifier translation:** *few* vs *a few* (Spanish *pocos / unos pocos*, French *peu / quelques*) changes the meaning: "few learners improved" is negative; "a few learners improved" is positive. Also *hardly* (=

almost not, not "hard"). Put these on the qualifier flashcards.

- ◆ **Stress in contrast:** learners whose languages mark contrast with word order or particles rather than stress (French, Japanese, Korean, Tagalog, and others) may argue flatly in the debates. The contrastive stress drill above helps listeners follow their argument.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_06.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and notice the exact wording; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz; do the "Reason out loud" task on the Yellowstone wolves passage, writing one evidence sentence per answer. Workbook 2.3: Exercise 5 (qualifiers), "My new words," the journal (your rule for False vs Not Given, in your own words), and the **"Practice Test 1 — before the test"** page. Before C8: sleep, eat, arrive 10 minutes early. No new studying the night before is needed.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Not Given (the text gives a date only) · Q2 **B** "The high cost of solar panels" (the detail trap) · Q3 (new) **B** False ("only a few" clashes with "most"). Passage A (Ex 1): 1 T · 2 F · 3 NG · 4 F · 5 NG · 6 T · 7 F · 8 T · 9 NG. Headings (Ex 3): B ii · C iv · D v · E vi · F viii (unused: iii, vii). Features (Ex 4): 6 B · 7 C · 8 A · 9 B · 10 A · 11 C.

There is no new language today. Learners sit the **Listening** and **Reading** sections of Practice Test 1 ([assessment/practice-test-1.html](#)) under conditions as close to the real test as your room allows. You read the Listening aloud. The test is **not marked today**: learners mark it themselves in the C9 warmer, using the key and the raw-score → band table in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#) , and then tally their error types. The purpose is **diagnostic**: it tells each learner (and you) where the marks are leaking, so the rest of the course and their homework can target it. Practice Test 2 (C15) repeats the process, so the two results can be compared.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ complete a full Listening practice test from one hearing, using the reading time to predict, and a full Reading practice test within the time limit, writing answers directly on the answer sheet
- ◆ manage their own time and nerves: keep going after a missed answer, move on at the passage time limits, and fill every blank
- ◆ (in C9) mark their own test strictly, estimate a band from the conversion table, code every wrong answer by error type, and choose two "leaks" to fix before Practice Test 2

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ **Practice Test 1** ([assessment/practice-test-1.html](#)): a question booklet and an answer sheet for every learner, plus 2 spares · the teacher's Listening script that goes with the test (rehearsed, and recorded if possible) · the key and conversion table ([assessment/answer-keys.html](#)) for C9, **not** in the room today
- ◆ Slide 17 (exam rules) on screen during the briefing · a large clock or a projected countdown timer · spare pencils, erasers and a sharpener · a "Practice test in progress" sign for the door (Set F) · the **calm card** (Set F) on each desk
- ◆ For C9: an **error-type tally sheet** and a **results tracker** (Set F) for each learner, and colored pens for marking

BOARD PLAN

Left: today. Listening: about 30 min · once only · read the questions when I pause · write on the question paper, then check your answer sheet at the end. Reading: **60 min** (or the time on the board) · 3 passages · no transfer time.

Center: the clock. Reading: P1 ends at __:__ · P2 ends at __:__ · finish at __:__ (write the real times).

Right: rules. Phones off and away · pencil · CAPITALS are fine · no dictionaries · no talking · stuck? guess, mark it, move on · **no blanks** (a wrong answer never loses marks) · feeling anxious? Pen down, breathe, carry on.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome, calm and briefing	5	T-S	Learners sit in exam seating (spaced, facing the front, bags at the side). Phones off and in bags. A short calm routine (the calm card: breathe in for 4, hold for 4, out for 6, three times). Then read the briefing script (Set F) with slide 17: what happens, how long, the rules, what to do if you feel anxious. Hand out the answer sheets and Listening question booklets face down. Learners write their names. Write the real clock times for Reading on the board now.
Listening	28	S	"You may turn over your question paper." Read the Listening script exactly as the test gives it: the instructions, the example, the reading-time pauses (timed with a stopwatch, not by feel), all four parts, once only . At the end give 2 minutes for learners to check their answer sheet (this matches the computer-delivered test; the paper test gives 10 minutes to transfer answers; tell learners which one you are using). See "Reading the Listening aloud" below.
Changeover	1	T-S	Collect the Listening booklets (learners keep the answer sheet if the test uses one sheet for both sections; otherwise collect it too). Hand out the Reading booklets face down. No talking.
Reading	54	S	"You may begin." Write the start time and the three checkpoint times on the board. Give 10-minute and 1-minute warnings, nothing else. At the end: "Stop writing. Pencils down." Collect booklets and answer sheets, and check every sheet has a name.
Close and C9 preview	2	T-S	Thank the class. Ask for one word each about how it felt (they can say "pass"). Say: "Next class you'll mark it yourselves. You'll see your score and, more useful, <i>why</i> you lost each mark." Do not discuss answers today.
Total	90		$5 + 28 + 1 + 54 + 2$

GIVING READING THE FULL 60 MINUTES

The real Reading test is 60 minutes, and the plan above can only give 54. **The better option:** in C7, ask learners to arrive 10 minutes early for C8. Run the welcome, calm and briefing before the official start time, and the 90 minutes become Listening 28 + changeover 1 + Reading 60 + close 1. If your program cannot open the room early, use 54 minutes and tell learners so before they start. Whichever timing you use, **write it on the results tracker** and use the same timing for Practice Test 2 in C15, so the two scores can be compared fairly. If the Listening in the test you are using runs longer than 28 minutes, take the extra minutes from Reading, never from the Listening pauses.

◆ READING THE LISTENING ALOUD – HOW TO DO IT WELL

- ◆ **Rehearse it the day before**, aloud, with a stopwatch. Mark every pause in the script ("You now have 30 seconds to look at Questions 11 to 15"), and time the pauses exactly in class. Learners use those seconds to predict; shortening them changes the test.
- ◆ **Record it if you can.** A recording made on a phone in a quiet room (you, or you and a colleague for the two-voice parts) is fairer than live reading: every class hears exactly the same speed, you can't accidentally stress an answer, and you can keep it for future groups. Test the volume from the back row before class. If you read live, stand still at the front, face the class, and don't walk around while reading.
- ◆ **Two or more voices.** For conversations, ask a colleague or a volunteer who is *not* taking the test. If you are alone, change your voice and position slightly for each speaker and say the speaker's name the first time they speak only if the script does.
- ◆ **Natural speed, flat emphasis.** Read at the speed of a normal, clear conversation (not slower "for learners"). Read the distractors and the corrections exactly as written, with no extra stress on the answer and no pause before it. Include the fillers and hesitations in the script ("um," "let me see"): they are part of the test.
- ◆ **Once only. No repeats, no answers to questions during the recording.** If a learner asks "Can you repeat?", smile and shake your head. You can explain afterwards: in the real test the recording doesn't stop, and learning to let one answer go is part of the skill.
- ◆ **If something goes wrong** (a fire alarm, loud noise outside, a phone ringing): keep going if you can. If a sentence was genuinely inaudible to the whole room, note the question numbers affected on your copy and remove those items from everyone's score in C9 (say so, and adjust the total). Never replay a section for one learner.
- ◆ **Accents.** The real test uses a range of English accents (British, North American, Australian, New Zealand and others). Your own accent is fine for practice; tell learners so, and point them to the online lessons' UK / US voice switch for variety at home.
- ◆ **Latecomers** enter only at a break between parts, quietly, and start from the current part. Write "joined at Part ___" on their answer sheet so their C9 score is read in context.

◆ WHAT TO SAY (AND NOT SAY) ABOUT NERVES

SAY: *"You will miss some answers. Everyone does, including people who get band 8. When you miss one, let it go and catch the next one." · "Feeling nervous is normal; it means this matters to you. If your heart is racing, put your pencil down, breathe out slowly, and carry on. The clock keeps going, like in the real test, so one or two breaths, then back in." · "This is practice. The score is information for you and me, not a label. Nobody else will see it unless you show them."*

Avoid: "This is really important," "Don't panic," "If you get under 25 you're in trouble," or comparing classes ("Last year's group did better"). If a learner becomes distressed, let them step outside for a moment with the calm card; they can come back and continue, and the time lost is noted, not counted against them in your feedback. Have tissues and water available without comment.

◆ INVIGILATING

- ◆ Walk slowly and quietly during the Reading, not the Listening. Check that answers are going on the answer sheet (a common first-test error is writing everything on the booklet in Reading and running out of time to copy it). You may point silently at the answer sheet; say nothing else.
- ◆ Don't help with vocabulary or explain a question, even a little. If a learner asks, say "Do your best: I can't help in the test." Note which questions caused questions: useful for C9.
- ◆ Note, privately, anything you see that the scores won't show: who stopped to re-read Passage 1 for a long time, who never turned the page to Passage 3, who froze in Listening Part 4. It makes your C9 feedback specific and kind.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY AND ACCESS

A practice test should show a learner's real starting point, so keep the conditions the same for everyone, with two exceptions. (1) A learner with a documented need (visual impairment, dyslexia, a hearing difficulty) should get the arrangement they would request from the test center: an enlarged-print copy, a seat at the front, extra time noted on the tracker.

Encourage them to apply for special arrangements with the test center early. (2) A learner whose literacy is clearly well below the test (who could not finish Passage 1) should still take the test, but you might tell them privately beforehand: "Do Passage 1 carefully; that's your target today." Their C9 goal is then about Passage 1 accuracy, not the total.

EARLY FINISHERS

Anyone who finishes Reading early stays seated and checks: every answer on the sheet? every blank filled? word limits? spelling copied exactly? True/False labels (not Yes/No) where the instructions ask for them? Tell strong learners in advance that finishing early usually means there is checking left to do. They must not leave the room or start other work.

◆ WATCH-OUTS: TEST HABITS FROM OTHER SYSTEMS

- ◆ **Negative marking:** learners who took exams where wrong answers lose points will leave blanks. Say it in the briefing: **IELTS never deducts marks. Fill every blank.**
- ◆ **Collaboration norms:** in some classrooms, helping a neighbor quietly during a test is tolerated or even expected. Explain the rule without judgment before the test starts, and seat friends apart.
- ◆ **Writing answers on the booklet only (Reading):** there is no transfer time. Remind them in the briefing and at the 10-minute warning.
- ◆ **Capital letters and handwriting:** learners with less practice in Latin handwriting can write answers in CAPITALS (accepted in the real test) to avoid unclear letters.

◆ RETURNING THE RESULTS: THE C9 WARMER (ERROR-TYPE TALLY)

Do not mark the tests between C8 and C9 (a quick look for missing names is fine). Learners mark their own. The Module 3 guide begins C9 with this warmer; here is the full procedure, which takes about **10 minutes** in class, with the tally finished at home.

- 1 **Frame it (1 min).** "Today you'll mark your own test. The score is useful, but the most useful thing is *why* you lost each mark. You're looking for your two biggest leaks."
- 2 **Mark (5 min).** Return the answer sheets. Learners mark with a **colored pen** as you project or read the key from `assessment/answer-keys.html`, section by section. Strict rules, stated once: spelling must be exact (British or American both fine), plurals count, over the word limit = wrong, True on a Yes/No question = wrong, a blank = wrong. Where the key lists alternatives, accept them. Remove any "void" items (see above) from everyone's total.
- 3 **Score and band (1 min).** Learners total each section out of 40 and read the **approximate band** from the conversion table in the answer-keys document. Say clearly: "This is an estimate from a practice test that I read aloud, not an official score. Treat it as a range, about half a band either side."
- 4 **Tally (3 min in class, finish at home).** Each learner takes an **error-type tally sheet** (Set F) and writes a code beside every wrong answer on their answer sheet, then counts the codes. They start in class with the Listening section (the codes are fresh from C5) and finish Reading at home.
- 5 **Two leaks.** At home, they circle their two most frequent codes and write their two-leak plan on the tally sheet (the sheet suggests a practice task for each code). They bring the sheet to C10.
- 6 **Class picture, no names.** In C10 (or at the end of C9), ask for a show of hands for each code and board the totals. Plan short, targeted listening or reading "clinics" in later warmers for the two biggest class-wide codes. Keep the individual scores private: learners record them on their own **results tracker** and you record them on yours.

If the Module 3 C9 plan cannot spare 10 minutes, do steps 1–3 in class (7 minutes) and set the whole tally as homework. If your program allows, a 15-minute version lets pairs compare their *codes* (never their scores)

and share one fix.

◆ USING THE RESULTS DIAGNOSTICALLY

- ◆ **The codes tell you what to teach.** Lots of **D** and **L**: build more "take the correction" and "let it go" practice into warmers (Trap Bingo is ready). Lots of **S** / **N**: 3-minute dictations of numbers, dates and spelled names at the start of classes. Lots of **T**: timed skim-and-scan drills with a strict 20-minute passage rule. Lots of **F** / **K** / **Q**: one T / F / NG statement a day with evidence. Lots of **H**: one-line paragraph summaries.
- ◆ **The section pattern tells you where the band is.** Many learners find that Listening and Reading are closer to their target than Writing and Speaking, which the next two modules address. For others, Reading speed is the main barrier. Tell each learner honestly which section is furthest from their target and what the fastest win is.
- ◆ **Comparing with Practice Test 2 (C15).** Use the same timing and the same marking rules. A rise of a few raw marks, or a change from "lots of D" to "a few D," is real progress even if the estimated band stays the same. Remind learners that a 0.5 band gain over the course is a good, realistic result, and that some will gain more and some less.
- ◆ **Privacy.** Never display scores, rank learners, or share one learner's result with another. A learner who does worse than they hoped needs a quiet conversation and one specific next step, not public reassurance.

◆ HOMEWORK

None required: rest. Optional: re-read the "I can..." lists for Lessons 2.1–2.3 in the workbook and the online lessons' key takeaways (lesson 2.1 · 2.2 · 2.3). Bring the workbook and a colored pen to C9. Next class starts Module 3 (Writing Task 1): https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_07.html.

◆ CHECK

Answers, the raw-score → band conversion table and the scoring notes for Practice Test 1 are in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#). Before C9, check that the key's alternatives match the Listening script as you actually read it (for example, if you said "Room forty" and the key lists 40 / forty, both are fine).

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C7 AND C9: MODULE 2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "hear it coming, find it fast, prove it": **predict the type · take the correction · spell it exactly** (Listening) → **skim to map · scan for the paraphrase · 20 minutes a passage · no blanks** (Reading) → **confirm, clash or silence · the main idea, not the detail** (the tricky types). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook at the end of C7; anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. After C9, the **two-leak plans** become the learners' personal Listening and Reading homework for weeks 5–7, alongside the Writing and Speaking modules. Check in on them briefly every week ("How's your D going?").

Watch for in Module 3: Writing Task 1 is the Listening and Reading skills in reverse. Describing a chart means **selecting key features** and **paraphrasing the prompt**, exactly what learners did when they read for main ideas and matched headings. Numbers and trend language (*rose sharply, fell by a third, roughly 40 percent*) recycle the C5 number work, and the "no more than the text supports" discipline of True / False / Not Given is exactly what stops learners over-claiming in a Task 1 overview.

Practice Test 2 (C15) repeats the Listening and Reading under the same conditions; the Module 4 guide plans that class. Keep each learner's Practice Test 1 tally sheet and tracker so they can compare error types, not just scores.

Module 3 — Academic Writing

Three writing workshops, and the first class after Practice Test 1. C9 opens by handing back the test results as an **error-type tally**, not a grade, then teaches **Writing Task 1**: the four-paragraph report, the band-critical overview, selecting and grouping data, and the language of trends, proportions, approximation and processes, practiced on five original charts. C10 turns to **Writing Task 2**: reading the question type, planning in five minutes, and building paragraphs that develop one idea instead of listing four. C11 hands learners the examiner's lens: **coherence and cohesion** in depth, the four writing criteria (paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors), and a **peer-marking workshop** in which panels band-estimate three anonymous scripts before re-marking their own essay.

3 lessons

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C9–C11

Weeks 5–6

90 min per class

Target band 6.0–7.5

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class is an exam-skills workshop with the same shape: **warmer** (review) → **lead-in** → **strategy** with the key language clarified through **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** and concept-checking questions (CCQs) → a short **drill** → **guided practice** (workbook, pairs) → **timed practice** under exam conditions → **self-marking** against paraphrased band criteria → **targeted feedback** → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-3-writing.html`. Print `materials/module-3/classroom-materials.html` before C9. It holds the flashcards, new identity cards, the **Chart Talk** information-gap cards, the **Plan Pitch** prompt cards, the **Examiner Panel** scripts, role cards and examiner commentary, the **Trend Bingo** game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**: 3.1 = `lesson_07.html`, 3.2 = `lesson_08.html`, 3.3 = `lesson_09.html`. Each has  Listen buttons for the model sentences.
- Protect the timed practice**. Every class includes writing against the clock (20 minutes for Task 1 in C9; a 5-minute plan plus 15 minutes of writing for Task 2 in C10; a timed rewrite in C11). Learners can read about structure at home; what they cannot do alone is write under pressure with a coach in the room. If you're running late, cut guided practice (set it for homework), never the timed block or the self-marking that follows it.

- ◆ **Writing is the paper learners can't self-mark from a key.** Listening and Reading have right answers; Writing has **criteria**. The whole module teaches learners to read their own work through those criteria. Always say "band **estimate**": your judgment, the learners' and even a trained examiner's can differ by half a band. That is normal, not a failure of marking.
- ◆ **Feedback on the criteria, not on "good English."** In every timed task, take notes in four columns: **TA/TR** (overview missing, part of the question ignored, opinion in Task 1), **CC** (no paragraphs, every sentence starting with a linker, a vague *this*), **LR** (*increase* five times, *rised*, *make a research*), **GRA** (*the number of people are*, missing articles, comma splices). In the feedback stage, board two items per column without names, and always one piece of range to praise.
- ◆ **Collect writing, but mark smart.** You will receive a Task 1 report in C9 and a Task 2 essay (homework) in C11. You don't need to correct every error. Use the **codes** the learners know from the workbook (TA/TR · CC · LR · GRA) plus one line: "Your strongest criterion is...; the one holding you back is...; next time, try..." Learners' band estimates of their own work go on their **band tracker** ([band-tracker.html](#)).
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and forms (*summarise*, *organised*, *analyse*, *levelling off*, *programme*, *favour*, *judgement*, *per cent*, *labelled*). Teach *summarize*, *organized*, *analyze*, *leveling off*, *program*, *favor*, *judgment*, *percent*, *labeled*. Tell learners clearly: **IELTS accepts both British and American spelling; what matters is being consistent** within one script. Never mark a correct British form wrong.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Report it → argue it → judge it. In C9 learners **report**: a neutral, selective summary of a chart with a clear overview and not a word of opinion. In C10 they **argue**: read exactly what the question asks, take a position and develop two ideas properly. In C11 they **judge**: they sit in the examiner's chair, band-estimate three anonymous scripts against paraphrased criteria, compare their estimates with an examiner-style commentary, then turn the same lens on their own essay. Each class produces a piece of writing another person reads: a timed Task 1 report, a planned Task 2 opening, and a set of panel judgments plus a targeted rewrite.

STAKES, ANXIETY AND REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS

Your learners are not practicing for fun: a band decides a university place, a professional license, a visa. Writing is the paper most of them fear most, and C9 begins with their first real practice-test result. Say these things explicitly, in the first ten minutes of C9 and again whenever you hand back writing:

- ◆ **A result is a map, not a verdict.** "Your score tells us where to dig. It doesn't tell us who you are or what you'll get on test day."
- ◆ **Realistic gains.** Over an 8-week course, a gain of about **half a band** in a skill is common and worth celebrating. Bigger jumps happen, especially when a learner fixes one "band-limiter" (no overview, no paragraphs, under length), but they aren't guaranteed. Never promise a band.
- ◆ **Writing moves more slowly than Reading and Listening**, because it depends on habits that take weeks to build. The fastest writing gains in this module come from structure (overview, question type, paragraphs, word count), which learners can control on test day even when they are nervous.
- ◆ **Never** say "you'll fail" or "that's a band 5 essay" in front of the class. Talk about the *script*, not the person, and always name a criterion and a next step: "This essay's Task Response is strong. Its Coherence is held back by the linking. Here's the fix."
- ◆ **Anxiety in timed writing** often shows as a blank page. Give everyone the same starter routine (Task 1: *underline, overview, then numbers*; Task 2: *type, position, two ideas*) so there is always a first move. Allow learners who freeze to start with the plan only; a good plan is a real achievement.

USING THE TWO PRACTICE TESTS DIAGNOSTICALLY

Practice Test 1 (C8, Listening + Reading) comes back in C9. The point is not the band; it's the **pattern of errors**. Learners tally every lost mark by type, using the same error codes as Module 2 (for example **S** spelling or plural, **W** word limit, **F** False/Not Given confusion, **M** word-match trap, **T** time), and each learner chooses **one error type** to fix before Practice Test 2. Writing was not part of Practice Test 1, so for writing the baseline is the C1 diagnostic writing sample; the C9 Task 1 report and the C10–C11 Task 2 essay become the next data points.

Practice Test 2 (C15–C16) includes Writing Tasks 1 and 2 (60 minutes); tell learners now that the Module 3 checklists are exactly what they'll use there.

TRAUMA-INFORMED WRITING TOPICS

All prompts and charts in this module are **original** and deliberately neutral: commuting, study habits, energy sources, food waste, sitting at work, public libraries. Real IELTS sometimes asks about politics, migration or religion; this kit doesn't, and you don't need to. When a task invites a personal example (C10's development practice, journals), learners may use their own life, a **new identity card** or a plausible invented example: IELTS rewards relevant examples, not true ones. Some learners are taking IELTS for a visa under real pressure; never ask anyone why they need the test or what their target band is in front of others. Targets go on the private band tracker.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Practice Test 1 results (C9 warmer).** Decide how learners get their scores. **Option 1 (recommended):** you marked the answer sheets after C8 using `assessment/answer-keys.html`; hand them back marked but *without* the band written on top. **Option 2:** learners self-mark in C9 from the projected answer strip (it takes about seven minutes for 80 items; budget for it). Either way, bring the raw-score → band conversion table from `assessment/answer-keys.html` and each learner's **band tracker**.
- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (Set A): trend verbs and nouns color-coded by movement, the topic picture cards and the criteria / linker cards. One set for the board.
- ◆ For C9: **Chart Talk** A/B cards (Set C), one pair per two learners. For the timed Task 1, learners use the bar chart in Workbook 3.1. Bring a visible timer.
- ◆ For C10: **Plan Pitch** prompt cards (Set D), one set per pair, plus the listener checklist.
- ◆ For C11: the **Examiner Panel** pack (Set E): one copy of Scripts A, B and C per learner, one set of criterion role cards per group of 4, and **one** copy of the examiner commentary per group, kept face down until the panels have committed to a band. Learners also need the Task 2 essay they wrote for homework after C10.
- ◆ **Trend Bingo** (Set F) is the C10 warmer and an early-finisher game.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** (Set B) and keep them on a side table.
- ◆ Read the three sample scripts and the commentary yourself before C11, and make your own estimate first. If your estimate differs by half a band, good: that's the conversation you want learners to have.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
—	C9 warmer	Practice Test 1 results: raw score → approximate band; error-type tally (Listening and Reading); one target error type for the study plan	name the error type that costs them the most marks and one concrete fix for it
3.1	C9 • wk 5	Writing Task 1: 150 words / 20 minutes, objective only; four paragraphs (introduction → overview → body A → body B); selecting and grouping key features; trend verbs + adverbs and adjectives + nouns; prepositions of change (<i>from, to, by, at, of, in</i>); proportion and comparison; approximation; process passive + sequencing; line, bar, pie, table and process visuals	write a 150-word Task 1 report in 20 minutes with a clear, figure-free overview and grouped, accurately described data, then self-mark it for Task Achievement
3.2	C10 • wk 5	Writing Task 2: 250 words / 40 minutes; question types (opinion, discussion, problem–solution, advantages–disadvantages, two-part) and the	identify any Task 2 question type, plan an essay in five minutes that answers every

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		structure each demands; the 5-minute plan ; thesis and topic sentences; paragraph architecture (topic sentence → why → consequence → example); the "so what?" test; register and relevance	part, and write an introduction and a fully developed body paragraph in 15 minutes
3.3	C11 · wk 6	The four writing criteria (paraphrased): Task Achievement / Response, Coherence & Cohesion, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range & Accuracy; coherence vs cohesion; linkers by function; referencing with this / these + summary noun ; the over-linking trap ; paragraphing; band-limiters; the four-pass self-assessment	band-estimate an anonymous essay criterion by criterion and justify each estimate with a quotation, identify the criterion holding their own essay back, and rewrite one paragraph to raise it

3.1 · C9

Writing Task 1 — Describing Data

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ read their Practice Test 1 result as a pattern of error types and choose one type to fix
- ◆ organize a Task 1 report in four paragraphs and write a **signaled overview** ("Overall, ...") that names the one or two main features **without figures**
- ◆ select the key features (highest, lowest, biggest change, crossover, stability) and **group** related data instead of listing it
- ◆ describe change accurately with verb + adverb (*rose sharply*) and adjective + noun (*a sharp rise in*), with the right prepositions (*rose from 6% to 31%, by 25 points; peaked at; a rise of 5% in sales*), and describe proportions, approximations and processes
- ◆ write a 150-word report in 20 minutes and self-mark it against a Task Achievement checklist

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Practice Test 1 answer sheets (marked, or with the answer strip for self-marking) · raw-score → band table ([assessment/answer-keys.html](#)) · band trackers
- ◆ Workbook 3.1 (Practice Test 1 tally, New words, Grammar box, Charts 1–5, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Chart Talk, timed task, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 2–7 · Trend flashcards (Set A) · **Chart Talk** A/B cards (Set C) · timer · Listening script 3.1-A (the line graph) and 3.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the shape. 1 Introduction (paraphrase: what · where · when) → 2 **Overview** ("Overall, ..." · 1–2 big features · no numbers) → 3 Body A → 4 Body B (figures, grouped). ≥ 150 words · ~20 min · no opinions · no invented causes · no conclusion.

Center: two ways to say it. Cycling **rose sharply** (verb + adverb) = There was a **sharp rise in** cycling (adj + noun). **from** 6% **to** 31% · **by** 25 points · **peaked at** 31% · **stood at** 14% · a rise **of** 25 points **in...** ✗ *risen*
✓ rose / risen.

Right: no time? compare. accounted for a third of · the largest share · twice as many as · just under / well over half · approximately. **Process:** passive + First, ... Next, ... After that, ... Finally, ...

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Practice Test 1 back	12	T-S → S	Slide 2. See Returning Practice Test 1 below. Frame it first (a map, not a verdict). Learners mark or read their sheets, convert raw scores to approximate bands, then tally every lost mark by error type in the Workbook 3.1 grid. Board the class totals by type, anonymously. Each learner circles one error type and writes one fix on their band tracker.
Lead-in: one glance	3	T-S	Slide 3. Show Chart 1 (the cycling line graph) for five seconds only , then hide it. "If you could tell me one thing about this chart, what would it be?" Take three answers. "That sentence is the most important sentence in Task 1. It's called the overview ."
Strategy: the four paragraphs	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 4. The Task 1 facts (150 words, ~20 minutes, worth less than Task 2, objective only). The four paragraphs and each one's job. Learners read the model report for Chart 1 (Workbook, Ex 1), label the four paragraphs and underline the overview. Pairs answer: "Is there a number in the overview? Is there an opinion anywhere? How is the data grouped?" CCQs.
Language: trends, proportion, process	12	T-S	Slides 5–6 and the Grammar box. Movement verbs and nouns with the trend flashcards (sort them into up / down / flat / up-and-down / peak). Verb + adverb ↔ adjective + noun. Prepositions of change. Then quickly: proportion and approximation with the pie chart, and the passive for processes. CCQs and pronunciation (see below).
Drill	5	T-S → S	Transformation drill (see Drill script): verb ↔ noun and the prepositions, choral then individual. Finish with 3 approximation prompts.
Guided practice + Chart Talk	13	S → S-S	Listen first: read Script 3.1-A once while learners follow Chart 1 and correct the two figures you say wrongly (a quick accuracy check: see the script). Then Workbook Ex 3 (write the overview for the pie chart) alone, 3 minutes; compare in pairs. Then Chart Talk (Set C, 6 min): A describes their card's data in about 60 seconds, overview first; B sketches it on the blank grid and asks one clarifying question; swap. ICQs first. Ex 2, 4 and 5 are homework unless a pair finishes early.
Timed practice: Task 1	20	S	Slide 7. Exam conditions: Workbook 3.1, the bar chart (Chart 2). 2 min plan (underline the biggest changes; decide two groups) → 14 min write → 4 min count words and check. Silent room,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			visible timer. Walk round but don't correct; note errors for feedback in four columns. Learners who freeze start with the overview only.
Self-marking	5	S → S-S	Learners run the Task Achievement checklist in the workbook on their own report, then swap with a partner who checks one thing only: "Can I find the overview in three seconds? Does it have a number in it?" Collect the reports (you'll return them in C10).
Feedback	5	T-S	Board four columns (TA · CC · LR · GRA) with two anonymous items each from the timed task, e.g. TA: an overview with figures in it · "because students need money" (invented cause); CC: one sentence per bar; LR: <i>increase</i> ×4 · "rised"; GRA: "the number of hours were." Learners fix them. Praise one piece of range (<i>a fivefold increase, overtaking</i>).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.1 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		12 + 3 + 10 + 12 + 5 + 13 + 20 + 5 + 5 + 5

◆ RETURNING PRACTICE TEST 1 – HOW TO RUN IT (12 MIN)

◆ Say this first (1 min):

SAY: "Before you look: this test is a map, not a verdict. It was your first full timed test, in a room, with a clock. Today we're not interested in the number on top. We're interested in **why** each mark was lost, because most lost marks come from three or four habits, and habits can be changed. Over eight weeks, half a band is a very good result. Some of you will move more, some less. Every one of you will know exactly what to practice by the end of today."

- ◆ **Scores (5 min):** hand back the marked sheets (Option 1), or project the answer strip and let learners mark in pencil (Option 2: allow 7 minutes and shorten the tally). Learners convert each raw score (out of 40) to an approximate band with the table from [assessment/answer-keys.html](#) and write both on their **band tracker**, next to their C1 diagnostic result. Remind them: the conversion is approximate, and a practice test taken in class is not the official test.
- ◆ **Tally (4 min):** learners go through every wrong or blank answer and put a stroke in the **Error-type tally** grid in Workbook 3.1. **Listening:** **D** distractor (wrote the first answer heard; the speaker then corrected it) · **S** spelling or plural · **W** word limit / wrong form · **N** number, letter or date misheard · **L** lost my place / froze (missed one, then several) · **P** missed the paraphrase · **X** transfer error (right answer, wrong box or illegible). **Reading:** **P** missed the paraphrase · **M** word-match trap (chose the option that repeats words

from the text with a different meaning) · **S** copied a word wrongly · **W** word limit / wrong form · **O** looked in the wrong place · **T** ran out of time / left a blank · **F** confused False and Not Given · **K** used own knowledge, not the text · **Q** missed a qualifier · **H** heading matched a detail, not the main idea · **X** transfer error. These are the Module 2 codes, so learners already know them. Anything that fits nowhere = "other."

- ◆ **Class picture (1 min):** ask for hands per type and board the totals with no names: "Spelling and plurals: 31 marks across the class. Not Given: 26. Time: 19." Learners see that their errors are shared and ordinary. That alone lowers anxiety.
- ◆ **One target (1 min):** each learner circles their **biggest** error type and writes one concrete fix on the tracker: "Spelling: after the test, check every answer letter by letter" · "Not Given: ask 'does the text say the opposite, or nothing?'" · "Time: move on after 90 seconds on one question." Point to the matching online lessons for review: 2.1 for Listening codes, 1.2 for **P**, 2.2 for **M S W O T** in Reading, 2.3 for **F K Q H**, 4.3 for **X** and timing (the full code-to-lesson table is in [assessment/answer-keys.html](#)).
- ◆ **Individual talks:** anyone whose result upset them gets two minutes with you during the timed writing or after class, never in front of others. Be specific and kind: "Your Reading score is lower than your Listening, and 9 of the 14 lost marks were blanks at the end. That's time, not English. That's very fixable."

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the overview. The overview is the big picture: the one or two things a reader would remember if they saw the chart for five seconds. It is not a summary of every line, and it is not a conclusion at the end.

SAY: "Overall, cycling became much more popular in Northport and Riverton, while it fell slightly in Eastvale." Is there a number? (No.) Could I say this after looking for five seconds? (Yes.) Where does it go: the start or the end? (Near the start, paragraph 2; many good writers put it straight after the introduction.) · "In 2004, 14% of commuters in Eastvale cycled." Overview or detail? (Detail: it has a figure and one year.) · Can I write "This is because Northport built bike lanes"? (No: the chart doesn't say why. That's an invented cause.)

Meaning: degree and speed. The adverb or adjective must match the size of the change on the chart.

SAY: From 10% to 12% in ten years: rose sharply or slightly? (Slightly.) From 80 to 15 in one year? (Plummeted / fell dramatically.) 50, 50, 50, 50? (Remained stable / leveled off.) Up, down, up, down with no direction? (Fluctuated.) · "Riverton drew level with Eastvale in 2016." Same number or different? (The same, 11%). · "Northport **overtook** Eastvale." Who was ahead before? (Eastvale.) After? (Northport.)

Meaning: prepositions of change. *to* = the new level; *by* = the size of the change; *at* = a point; *of* = the size after a noun; *in* = the thing that changed.

SAY: "Paid work rose **to** 12 hours." How many hours at the end? (12.) "Paid work rose **by** 6 hours." How many at the end? (We need the start: 6 + 6 = 12.) · "There was a rise **of** 6 hours **in** paid work." Which word gives the amount? (*of*.) Which introduces the topic? (*in*.) · "Solar accounted for 12% of electricity." Is that a change over time? (No: a proportion at one moment.)

Form.

Verb + adverb	subject + rose / fell / climbed / declined + <i>sharply, steadily, slightly</i>	Cycling in Northport rose steadily until 2012.
Adjective + noun	There was a / an + <i>sharp, steady, slight</i> + rise / fall / increase + in + topic	There was a sharp rise in cycling after 2012.
Irregular verbs	rise – rose – risen · fall – fell – fallen · grow – grew – grown · (<i>raise</i> needs an object)	✗ rised · ✗ was risen · ✓ has risen
Prepositions	from X to Y · by (the difference) · peaked at · stood at · a rise of X in Y	fell from 14% to 10% · by 4 points · peaked at 31%
Proportion	accounted for / made up · the largest share · twice as many as · the majority of	Hydroelectric power accounted for about a third.
Approximation	approximately · just over / under · well over · nearly · roughly	just over a quarter (26%) · well over half
Process	present simple passive + sequencers	First, the water is collected. It is then filtered.

Tense. Past data → past simple (*rose, fell*); a point before another past point → past perfect (*had overtaken by 2016*); no time / a process → present simple. Projections (*is expected to rise, is predicted to reach*) only if the chart shows future years.

Pronunciation. Noun vs verb stress: *an INcrease / to inCREASE, a DEcrease / to deCREASE*. Percentages: *perCENT*, "thirty-one percent," never "thirty-one percents." Fractions: *a third, a quarter, three fifths* /*fɪfθs*/. *Rose* /*rouz*/ vs *rows*; *fell* vs *fall*: learners who confuse them in speech often confuse them in writing too.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Verb → noun:** T: "Cycling rose sharply." → S: "There was a sharp rise in cycling." T: "Coal use fell slightly." → "There was a slight fall in coal use." T: "Paid work increased dramatically." → "There was a dramatic increase in paid work." (Stress the noun: an **IN**crease.)
- Noun → verb:** T: "There was a gradual decline in study hours." → S: "Study hours declined gradually." T: "There was a steady growth in wind power." → "Wind power grew steadily."
- To or by?** T: "6 hours, then 12 hours. Use *to*." → S: "It rose to 12 hours." T: "Use *by*." → "It rose by 6 hours." T: "14%, then 10%. *From... to*." → "It fell from 14% to 10%."
- Approximate it:** T: "26%" → S: "just over a quarter." T: "48%" → "just under half." T: "62%" → "roughly three fifths" / "well over half."

◆ ICQS BEFORE CHART TALK AND THE TIMED TASK

SAY: Chart Talk: Do you show your card to your partner? (No.) What do you say first: a number or the big picture? (The big picture, the overview.) What does your partner do? (Sketch the chart and ask one question.) How long do you talk? (About a minute.) • **Timed task:** How many minutes? (Twenty.) How many words? (At least 150.) Can you say why paid work increased? (No: only what the chart shows.) Do you write a conclusion? (No: the overview does that job.) What do you do in the last four minutes? (Count words and check.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the **sentence skeletons** strip (Workbook 3.1, Grammar box): "The chart shows ____ in ____ between ____ and _____. Overall, ____ while _____. In 2014, _____. By 2024, _____." The learner fills the gaps from the chart. For the timed task, target **introduction + overview + one body paragraph** (about 100 words) and a word count; that is a real achievement. In Chart Talk, let them go second and point at the grid while they describe. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–5.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Precision and flexibility. Ask strong learners to (1) vary the subject: *The figure for Riverton...* · *Riverton's rate...* · *The proportion of cyclists in Riverton...*; (2) use one past perfect and one participle clause (...*rising to 31%, the highest rate shown*); (3) compare within a sentence (*whereas, while, compared with, respectively*); (4) finish the report at 160–170 words, not 220: selection is a band-7 skill. In the timed task, give them the process diagram instead of the bar chart.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"the 60% of people":** Spanish *el 60%*, Portuguese *os 60%*, French *les 60%*, Italian *il 60%*. Teach *60% of people* and *the proportion / percentage of people*. Also *percent* (with a number) vs *percentage* (without): ✗ "the percent of cyclists."
- ◆ **Articles:** Arabic, Chinese, Russian, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese speakers drop or add them: "Number of cyclists rose," "There was sharp rise." Drill the chunk *there was a sharp rise in* as one unit; and *the number of* + plural noun + **singular** verb: *The number of cyclists was...* (✗ were).
- ◆ **Tense:** Chinese and Vietnamese don't mark tense on the verb, so learners often describe 2004 data in the present ("In 2004, Eastvale has 14%"). Board a timeline and ask "Is 2004 finished?"
- ◆ **Rise / raise / arise:** all L1s, especially Spanish (*subir / aumentar*) and Arabic speakers. *Raise* needs an object (*the company raised prices*); data *rises*.
- ◆ **"increase of" vs "increase in":** French *une augmentation de*, Spanish *un aumento de*, Russian *пoчм + genitive*. A *rise of 5 points* (amount) *in cycling* (topic).
- ◆ **Plural -s dropped in writing:** Vietnamese, Chinese, Thai speakers ("five activity," "12 hour"). The Practice Test 1 tally probably showed it in Listening too: link the two.

- ◆ **Giving reasons:** learners from school systems where "explain the data" was rewarded will add causes. Praise the thinking, then: "Great for Task 2. In Task 1, the examiner can't reward what the chart doesn't show."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_07.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and "Your Task" (the household-budget pie chart, 20 minutes, timed). Workbook 3.1: Exercises 2, 4 and 5 (if not done in class), "My new words" and the journal (copy the four-paragraph template and list the three trend words you overuse). Practice Test 1: one 15-minute session on your target error type.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** (the overview; without one, Task Achievement is capped around band 5) · Q2 **C** plummeted / fell sharply · Q3 (new) **A** "...rose from 6 to 12 hours, doubling over the period." Full answers for Ex 1–5 and a band-7 model for the timed bar-chart task are in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ identify five Task 2 question types from the instruction words (*to what extent... · discuss both views... · what problems... how... · do the advantages outweigh... · why...? what...?*) and name the structure each demands
- ◆ count the **parts** of a prompt and check that their plan answers every one
- ◆ plan in five minutes: type → position → two ideas → topic sentence + example for each
- ◆ write a thesis that states a position and topic sentences that announce each paragraph's single idea
- ◆ develop a point with **why → consequence → example** (the "so what?" test) instead of listing, and write an introduction plus one body paragraph in 15 minutes

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, Model essay A, dialogue, Plan Pitch, timed task, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 8–13 · **Trend Bingo** (Set F) for the warmer · **Plan Pitch** prompt cards + listener checklist (Set D) · topic picture flashcards (Set A) · timer · Listening script 3.2-A (two students planning) and 3.2-B (dictation) · learners' C9 Task 1 reports (marked with codes, to return)

BOARD PLAN

Left: what's the job? *To what extent do you agree?* → one position, held throughout · *Discuss both views + your opinion* → view A · view B · **you** · *Problems? Solutions?* → body 1 problems · body 2 solutions · *Advantages outweigh?* → both + a **verdict** · *Why? What can be done?* → answer **each** question. Count the parts: ①②③.

Center: the 5-minute plan. Type ____ · My position ____ · Body 1: idea → because → example · Body 2: idea → because → example · Conclusion = position again, no new idea. ≥250 words · 40 min · Task 2 counts twice as much as Task 1.

Right: build a paragraph. Topic sentence (one idea) → **why?** (because..., since...) → **so what?** (which means..., as a result...) → **for example** (a specific case) → link back. ✗ four ideas in four sentences ✓ one idea in five sentences.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Trend Bingo + reports	7	T-S → S	Review C9 with Trend Bingo (Set F): read the caller list; learners cross the phrase that fits each description; first full line calls

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
back			"Bingo!" and must read the phrases back. Then return the C9 reports with criterion codes; learners read your one-line comment and note their "holding-back" criterion. No discussion of individual bands in public.
Lead-in: what's the job?	4	T-S → S-S	Slide 8. Four prompts on one topic (working hours). "Same topic. Is it the same essay?" Pairs decide what each prompt asks the writer to <i>do</i> . Elicit: no, each one asks for a different job. "Most low Task Response scores come from answering the topic instead of the question."
Strategy: question types and parts	10	T-S → S	Slide 9. The five types and the structure each one pushes. Underline the instruction words; count the parts with ①②③ (a discussion prompt has three jobs: view A, view B, your opinion). Workbook Ex 1 (identify the type, count the parts) alone, then check. CCQs.
Strategy: the 5-minute plan (think-aloud)	8	T-S	Slide 10. Model a plan live for the discussion prompt on food waste (Workbook Ex 3): say every decision aloud ("Type: discussion, so three jobs. My view? I think businesses matter more. Idea for body 1: households waste the most... example: a community cooking course..."). Then learners read Model essay A in the workbook and find the plan inside it (Ex 5): thesis, two topic sentences, the example in each body.
Language: paragraph architecture	9	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Thin point vs developed point. The chain topic sentence → why → so what → example and the signal language for each step (Grammar box). The "so what?" test. Workbook Ex 4 (develop a thin point) in pairs. CCQs.
Drill: the "so what?" chain	5	T-S → S-S	See Drill script. T says a thin claim; the class pushes it one step with <i>because...</i> , the next learner adds <i>which means...</i> , the next <i>For example,</i> Then open pairs.
Guided practice: Plan Pitch	10	S-S	Slides 12–13. Read Script 3.2-A once (two students planning); learners say what the planner forgot (the second part of the prompt). Then Plan Pitch (Set D): A draws a prompt card, plans for 2 minutes, then pitches the plan in 1 minute ("It's a ____ question, so... My position is... Body 1..."). B, the listener, uses the checklist: type right? all parts? one idea per body? a specific example? B asks "so what?" once. Swap with a new card. ICQs first.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Timed practice: plan + opening	20	S	Slide 13. Exam conditions. Learners choose prompt P3 (sitting at work) or P5 (flexible hours) in the workbook. 5 minutes: the plan template. 15 minutes: the introduction (paraphrase + thesis) and body paragraph 1 , fully developed. Visible timer. Note errors in four columns.
Self-marking + feedback	7	S → T-S	Learners tick the Task Response checklist for what they wrote (type identified? position in the thesis? one idea, developed with why + example?). Then board two anonymous items per column (e.g. TR: a thesis with no position · CC: "Firstly... Secondly... Thirdly..." inside one paragraph · LR: "In this modern era" · GRA: "Although... but..."). Learners fix them. Praise one strong thesis.
Homework set- up	10	T-S	Show online lesson 3.2 and a 📶 button. The key homework: finish the essay at home under 40-minute conditions (or write the whole essay on the other prompt) and bring it to C11: it is the essay they will re-mark in the peer-marking workshop. Explain the online "Your Task" is optional extra practice. Answer questions about the homework; learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 4 + 10 + 8 + 9 + 5 + 10 + 20 + 7 + 10

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: question type = the job. The instruction words tell the writer what kind of answer counts. Writing a good essay about the topic but not the question is the most common reason for a low Task Response score.

SAY: "Discuss both views and give your own opinion." How many jobs? (Three: view A, view B, my opinion.) If I only write about the view I agree with? (Task Response is capped: one job is missing.) · "To what extent do you agree or disagree?" Do I have to agree completely? (No: I can partly agree, but I must say so clearly and hold that position.) · "Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?" Is a list of advantages and a list of disadvantages enough? (No: I have to **weigh** them and give a verdict.) · "Why is this happening? What can be done?" How many body paragraphs, at least? (Two: one per question.)

Meaning: thesis vs topic sentence. The thesis (end of the introduction) states the answer to the whole question. A topic sentence (start of a body paragraph) states the one idea of that paragraph.

SAY: "This essay will discuss both sides." Does it tell me the writer's position? (No: it's a plan, not a thesis. Add "...before arguing that...") · "Sitting all day causes several problems." Topic sentence: one idea or many? (Too general: which problem? Better: "The most serious problem is the effect on physical health.") · Does the conclusion add a new idea? (No: it restates the position.)

Meaning: development. A developed point answers "why?" and "so what?" and proves it with a specific example. Listing gives four claims and no proof.

SAY: "Working from home is convenient. It saves time. People like it." How many ideas? (Three.) How many are explained? (None.) · "...which means workers start the day rested." Is this a why or a consequence? (Consequence: so what.) · Does my example have to be a real statistic? (No: it should be specific and plausible, like "a company that let staff start at 10." Don't invent exact data.)

Form.

Thesis (opinion)	While / Although + concession, I believe / I would argue that + position	While education has value, I believe businesses bear greater responsibility.
Thesis (discussion)	This essay will examine both views before arguing that...	...before arguing that cooking should be compulsory.
Topic sentence	The most serious / compelling / obvious + noun + is (that)...	The most serious problem is the effect on physical health.
Why	This is because... · since... · as...	This is because the body burns very little energy.
So what	..., which means (that)... · As a result, ... · This can lead to...	..., which means they take more sick days.
Example	For example, ... · A clear example of this is... · ...such as...	A small firm that holds walking meetings, for example, ...
Hedging	can · may · tends to · many / some (not all) · often	Long hours at a desk can harm concentration.

Register. No contractions (*do not*, not *don't*), no *you* addressing the reader, no slang, no rhetorical questions in a row. Memorized openers ("In this modern era of technology...") are recognized by examiners and earn nothing.

Pronunciation (for the Plan Pitch and the dictation). Contrastive stress in a thesis: "**While** education has **value**, I believe **businesses** bear **greater** responsibility." A slight pause after the concession clause. *outweigh* /aʊt'weɪ/, silent *gh*; *thesis* /'θiːsɪs/, plural *theses* /'θiːsiːz/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Name the type** (quick-fire): T reads just the instruction words; S call out the type: "Discuss both views and give your opinion." → "Discussion — three jobs!" "Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?" → "Advantages–disadvantages — verdict!" "What are the causes, and what solutions can you suggest?" → "Problem–solution — two parts!"

- 2 **The "so what?" chain:** T: "Cooking lessons are useful." → S1: "...because students learn to prepare cheap, healthy meals." → S2: "...which means they are less likely to rely on fast food when they leave home." → S3: "For example, a teenager who can make three simple dishes can feed themselves on a student budget." Choral repetition of the full chain, then new claims: "Flexible hours help parents." · "Libraries are still important."
- 3 **Thesis upgrade:** T: "This essay will discuss both sides." → S: "This essay will discuss both sides before arguing that..." T: "I think it has good and bad points." → S: "Although it has some drawbacks, I believe its benefits are greater."

◆ PLAN PITCH – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Pairs, one set of prompt cards face down.** A draws a card and has **2 minutes** to fill the plan template in the workbook. No full sentences except the thesis.
- ◆ **Pitch (1 min):** A says the plan aloud: "This is a ____ question, so I need to _____. My position is _____. Body 1: _____ because _____, for example _____. Body 2: ...". B listens with the **listener checklist** (type right · every part answered · one idea per body · a specific example · no new idea in the conclusion) and asks "so what?" once, on the weakest point. A answers.
- ◆ **Swap** with a new card. If time allows, a third round with a new partner.
- ◆ **Why speak a written plan?** Saying it aloud exposes a missing part faster than reading it. Tell learners that's the only purpose; accuracy of speech isn't being judged.

◆ ICQS BEFORE PLAN PITCH AND THE TIMED TASK

SAY: Plan Pitch: How long do you plan? (Two minutes.) Do you write the whole essay? (No, only the plan and the thesis.) What does the listener check? (Type, all parts, one idea per body, an example.) What does the listener ask? ("So what?") · **Timed task:** How long is the plan? (Five minutes.) Then what do you write? (The introduction and body paragraph 1.) How many ideas in body 1? (One, developed.) Where's your position? (In the thesis, the last sentence of the introduction.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use the plan template as the whole task: type, position, two ideas with *because*, one example. For the timed block, the target is the introduction using the frames (*It is often argued that... While..., I believe...*) plus **four sentences** of body 1, one per step of the chain; give the chain labels (topic / why / so what / example) as a printed strip to write next to. In Plan Pitch, the learner can read the plan aloud rather than speak freely. Fewer items: Ex 1 items 1–3.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Nuanced positions. Ask strong learners for a qualified thesis (*...is largely positive, provided that...*), a **concession and rebuttal** inside a body paragraph (*Admittedly, ... However, ...*), and an example with a clear link back to the claim (*...which shows that...*). Challenge: plan the same prompt twice with opposite positions in five minutes each. For the timed task, they write the introduction and **both** body paragraphs.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"Although... but...":** Chinese (虽然...但是...), Vietnamese (*mặc dù... nhưng...*), Korean and Arabic speakers double the connector. Keep one: *Although X, Y.* or *X, but Y.*
- ◆ **Delayed position:** learners from Arabic, Persian, Japanese and some Latin American essay traditions often build up to the opinion at the end, or leave it implicit as a courtesy. Explain that the IELTS reader expects the answer **in the introduction**; it isn't rude, it's the genre.
- ◆ **Long coordinated sentences and comma splices:** Arabic (*wa...wa...*), Spanish and Russian writers join many clauses with *and* or commas. One idea per sentence in the chain; show a comma splice and its three repairs (full stop, semicolon, subordinator).
- ◆ **"On the contrary"** used to mean "on the other hand": French *au contraire*, Spanish *por el contrario*, Portuguese *pelo contrário*. *On the contrary* rejects the previous statement; for a second side, use *On the other hand* or *However*.
- ◆ **"People is / Everybody are":** Spanish *la gente es*, Portuguese *o povo é*. *People* is plural: *people are*.
- ◆ **Proverbs and set phrases** as openers, common in Chinese, Arabic, Persian and Indian English school writing ("As the saying goes..."). They aren't wrong, but they spend words without answering the question. Paraphrase the prompt instead.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_08.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. **Main task:** complete the timed essay (P3 or P5) as a full essay of 250+ words, in 40 minutes, by hand or typed, and bring it to C11. Workbook 3.2: Exercise 2, "My new words" and the journal (the question type that feels hardest and one fix).

Note for the teacher: the online lesson's own "Your Task" labels its digital-devices prompt "Opinion type," but its instruction words ("do you think the benefits outweigh the drawbacks?") make it an **advantages–**

disadvantages question. If learners do it, point this out: it's a good test of whether they read the instruction words.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** present both views fairly, and make your own opinion clear in the introduction and conclusion · Q2 **B** to state your position clearly · Q3 (new) **C** two-part question: a body paragraph for the reasons and one for the evaluation. A model essay for P3 and a plan for P5 are in the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain in their own words what each of the four writing criteria rewards (paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors), and why the weakest criterion holds the band down
- ◆ tell **coherence** (ideas in a logical order, one idea per paragraph) from **cohesion** (the links between sentences: linkers, reference, substitution)
- ◆ use linkers by function, and refer back with **this / these + summary noun** (*these pressures, such an approach*) instead of repeating
- ◆ recognize and repair **over-linking** (a signpost on every sentence)
- ◆ band-estimate an anonymous essay criterion by criterion as part of a panel, justify each estimate with a quotation, and apply a four-pass self-assessment to their own essay

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.3 (New words, the criteria table, Grammar box, Exercises 1–4, Examiner Panel grid, my-essay four-pass grid, dialogue, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · criteria and linker flashcards (Set A) · **Examiner Panel** pack (Set E: Scripts A–C, role cards, examiner commentary face down) · learners' homework essays from C10 · timer · Listening scripts 3.3-A (two versions of one paragraph) and 3.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: four criteria, 25% each. TR answered all of it? clear position? developed? · **CC** logical order? paragraphs? natural links? · **LR** range? precise? accurate spelling/collocation? · **GRA** variety? error-free sentences? Your band is held down by your **weakest**.

Center: coherence vs cohesion. Coherence = the **order** of ideas (one idea per paragraph, topic sentence first). Cohesion = the **links**: linkers (*however, as a result*) + reference (*it, this measure, these pressures, such an approach, the former*) + substitution. ✗ Governments could raise fuel taxes. ~~Raising fuel taxes~~ would... ✓ **This measure** would...

Right: the over-linking trap. ✗ Firstly... Moreover... In addition... Furthermore... Consequently... Therefore... = mechanical. ✓ Link only a **real** relationship. Four passes: TR → CC → LR → GRA. Estimate, quote, suggest.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: plan check	6	S-S	Review C10. Pairs swap their homework essays and check only the structure in 3 minutes: can the partner underline the thesis and the two topic sentences? Does the conclusion add a new idea? Then back to the owner. Anyone without an essay uses Model essay A from Workbook 3.2 (no penalty: say so).
Lead-in: four examiners	4	T-S	Slide 14. "Your essay isn't marked once. It's marked four times, by four questions." Show the four criteria. Read three quick faults aloud ("The essay never says what the writer thinks." · "The word <i>important</i> appears eleven times." · "It's one long block."); learners hold up the criterion flashcard (TR / CC / LR / GRA).
Strategy: the criteria and coherence vs cohesion	12	T-S → S	Slides 14–15 and the criteria table in the workbook (paraphrased bands 5–8). The weakest-criterion logic. Coherence vs cohesion. Read Script 3.3-A : the over-linked and the natural versions of one paragraph; learners count the linkers in each and say which sounds more skilled and why. Workbook Ex 1 (which criterion?) alone, then check. CCQs.
Language: this / these + summary noun	5	T-S	Slide 16. The single most useful cohesive move. Drill (see Drill script), then Workbook Ex 3 items 1–3 orally.
Guided practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (fix the over-linked paragraph) alone, then pairs compare: fewer linkers, one summary noun, ideas combined. Ex 3 items 4–6 and Ex 4 are homework.
Examiner Panel workshop	30	S-S → T-S	Slide 17. See Examiner Panel — how to run it . Groups of 4, one criterion each. Three anonymous scripts on the same prompt (public libraries). Script A: 9 min · Script B: 7 min · Script C: 7 min. Each panel commits to four criterion bands and an overall estimate per script, with one quotation per criterion. Then reveal (7 min): turn over the examiner commentary; panels compare, and the class discusses the biggest gaps.
My essay: four passes + rewrite	16	S	Learners run the four-pass self-assessment on their own C10 essay (Workbook grid): one read per criterion, a band estimate and a quotation for each. They circle the lowest criterion and write one concrete improvement per criterion. Then timed rewrite (8 min) : rewrite the one paragraph that most needs the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			fix. Early finishers swap and give one strength and one suggestion.
Feedback	4	T-S	Board the most common "holding-back" criterion in the room (by hands, no names) and one fix for each. Remind: self-assessment finds structure problems; a second reader finds accuracy problems. Collect the essays with the four-pass grids to read before C12.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.3 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick "I can..." and record their criterion estimates on the band tracker.
Total	90		6 + 4 + 12 + 5 + 8 + 30 + 16 + 4 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: four separate judgments. Each task is judged on four criteria that count equally; the task band is roughly their average, and Task 2 counts twice as much as Task 1 in the Writing band. A brilliant criterion can't fully rescue a weak one.

SAY: *An essay has excellent vocabulary but answers a different question. Which criterion suffers most? (Task Response.) Can the vocabulary save it? (Only partly: TR drags the average down.) · So which criterion should you practice first: your best or your weakest? (The weakest.) · Are the bands in the workbook table official? (No: they're paraphrased from the public descriptors, a guide for estimating.)*

Meaning: coherence vs cohesion.

SAY: *An essay has perfect linkers, but the ideas jump around. Coherent or cohesive? (Cohesive but not coherent.) · Each paragraph has one clear idea in a sensible order, but the sentences feel like separate islands. (Coherent but not very cohesive.) · Is paragraphing coherence or cohesion? (Coherence, and it's the cheapest gain: no paragraphs caps this criterion around band 5.)*

Meaning: referencing with a summary noun. *This / these + noun* points back to a whole idea and names it, so the reader never wonders what *this* means.

SAY: *"Cities face traffic, pollution and crowded trains. This makes action essential." What does this refer to? (All three problems, but it's vague.) Better? (**These pressures** make action essential.) · "Governments could raise fuel taxes. This measure would reduce car use." Measure = ? (Raising fuel taxes.) · Does "more linkers = higher band" hold? (No: the descriptors reward linking that is natural and accurate; overuse is marked down.)*

Form.

Adding	In addition, · Furthermore, · also · not only... but also	(use sparingly; often a new paragraph does the job)
Contrast	However, · whereas · while · Nevertheless, · On the other hand,	✗ On the contrary (= "that's wrong")
Cause / result	because · since · As a result, · Consequently, · which means	only for a real cause-effect
Example	For example, · For instance, · such as · A clear example is...	✗ For example + a list with no point
Reference	this / these + noun · such (a / an) + noun · the former / the latter · it / they · doing so	These pressures... · Such an approach... · Doing so would...
Summary nouns	trend · problem · measure · approach · change · development · view · risk · benefit	This trend... · These measures... · This view...

Pronunciation (for reading aloud, the best self-check for cohesion). Linkers at the start of a sentence take a slight pause after them: "*However*, | the trend carries a risk." Reading aloud slowly reveals over-linking: if you hear a signpost on every sentence, the reader will too. Stress the summary noun: "*These pressures* make action essential."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Name it with a summary noun:** T reads a sentence; S starts the next sentence with *This / These + noun*.
T: "Many companies now allow staff to choose their hours." → S: "**This trend...**" / "**This approach...**" T: "Cities could add bus lanes and cut fares." → "**These measures...**" T: "Some people believe libraries should only lend books." → "**This view...**" T: "Book budgets may shrink too far." → "**This risk...**"
- 2 Cut the signpost:** T reads an over-linked pair: "Firstly, cycling is cheap. Moreover, it is healthy." → S combines: "Cycling is both cheap and healthy." T: "In addition, it causes no pollution. Consequently, cities support it." → "Because it causes no pollution, cities support it." / "It also causes no pollution, which is why cities support it."
- 3 Which criterion? (fast):** T: "no paragraphs" → S: "CC!" · "eleven times *important*" → "LR!" · "no position" → "TR!" · "only simple sentences" → "GRA!" · "missing articles" → "GRA!" · "every sentence starts with a linker" → "CC!"

◆ EXAMINER PANEL – HOW TO RUN IT (30 MIN)

- ◆ **Groups of 4, four roles** (role cards, Set E): the **TR examiner**, the **CC examiner**, the **LR examiner** and the **GRA examiner**. Each reads the script once for meaning, then again for their criterion only, and uses the paraphrased criteria table in the workbook. Rotate roles for each script so everyone judges at least two criteria. In groups of 3, one person takes LR and GRA together.

- ◆ **All three scripts answer the same prompt** (public libraries adding new services; a positive/negative question). They are original, anonymous and presented in mixed order: learners are not told which is strongest. They were written to sit at roughly bands 5.5, 6.5 and 7.5, but **don't reveal this** until the panels commit.
- ◆ **Each examiner reports** (1 minute each): a band for their criterion (whole bands: 5, 6, 7, 8) and **one quotation** from the script as evidence ("Paragraph 2: every sentence starts with a linker, so CC 5"). The panel writes the four bands and the average in the Workbook grid. Average .25 → round **up** to the next half band; .75 → up to the next whole band. (Say it's approximate.)
- ◆ **Timing:** Script A 9 minutes (the first one is slower), Scripts B and C 7 minutes each. Keep a visible timer. If time is short, panels do A and C only (the two furthest apart) and do B for homework.
- ◆ **Reveal (7 min):** turn over the examiner commentary. Panels compare criterion by criterion and circle any gap of a whole band or more. Whole-class: "Where did you disagree with the commentary, and what's your evidence?" A panel can argue for a different band **if it quotes the script**; that's exactly the skill. Point out that the commentary itself says "about": two trained examiners can differ by half a band.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers and anxious learners.** Give your most confident speaker the role that needs the most careful reading (GRA, finding error-free sentences). Anxious learners often feel relieved to judge someone else's writing first; the scripts are anonymous and invented, so nobody's work is exposed. Keep the tone professional: "The script has..." never "The student is..."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE EXAMINER PANEL

SAY: *How many criteria does each person judge per script? (One.) What must you give with every band? (A quotation from the script.) Do you know which script is best? (No.) When do we turn over the commentary? (After all panels commit.) Is the commentary the "right answer"? (It's an expert estimate; we can disagree with evidence.) Do we talk about the writer or the script? (The script.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Reading three 250–300-word scripts is heavy. Give these learners the **CC role** first: it needs structure-spotting more than close reading (count paragraphs, circle every sentence-initial linker, underline *this / these + noun*). Pre-highlight the topic sentences on their copy. In the four-pass self-assessment, they do **two passes only** (TR and CC, which are the most reliable to self-judge) and rewrite one topic sentence rather than a whole paragraph.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Examiner-level precision. Strong learners write a three-sentence commentary for one criterion of Script A in the style of the reveal sheet (one strength, one limitation, band + reason). Then: "What exactly would move Script C from CC 7 to CC 8?" (seamless cohesion, flexible referencing, no over-used linker). In their own rewrite, target **one flexible reference chain** across a paragraph (*remote work* → *this arrangement* → *it* → *such flexibility*).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Linkers as good style:** many school systems (Chinese 然而...而且...而且, Arabic *وأي...ثاني*, Spanish *en primer lugar...*, Russian *во-первых...*) teach heavy signposting as a mark of a good essay. Learners genuinely believe it raises their score. Show the over-linked vs natural versions side by side and let them hear the difference (Script 3.3-A) rather than just saying "don't."
- ◆ **Vague *this / it*:** learners from pro-drop and topic-prominent languages (Spanish, Portuguese, Arabic, Chinese, Japanese, Korean) often use *this* or *it* for a whole paragraph of ideas. The summary-noun drill is the fix.
- ◆ **Repetition as clarity:** Chinese, Korean, Japanese and some formal Arabic writing repeat the full noun on purpose. English readers hear it as limited vocabulary (LR) and weak referencing (CC).
- ◆ **Paragraphing conventions:** some learners (for example, from Arabic, Persian or Vietnamese school traditions) write very long paragraphs or indent without a new idea. One idea = one paragraph; leave a blank line between paragraphs in the paper test so the examiner can see them.
- ◆ **Peer criticism and face:** in many cultures, criticizing a classmate's work openly is uncomfortable, and judging a teacher-provided text feels presumptuous. The anonymous scripts and the "quote the script" rule help. Model a kind, evidence-based comment first.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_09.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 3.3: Exercise 3 items 4–6 and Exercise 4, "My new words" and the journal (your four criterion estimates, the one holding you back, and the fix). Record the estimates on your band tracker. Optional: rewrite your whole essay with your four improvements and hand in both versions in C12.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** it lowers the Coherence & Cohesion band (mechanical, overused linking) · Q2 **A** Task Response · Q3 (new) **B** "These pressures make government action essential." Examiner Panel: Script A ≈ 6.5 (TR 7 · CC 6 · LR 6 · GRA 7) · Script B ≈ 5.5 (TR 6 · CC 5 · LR 5 · GRA 6) · Script C ≈ 7.5 (TR 8 · CC 7 · LR 8 · GRA 7). Full commentary in the answer key and in Set E.

END OF C11: MODULE 3 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "report it, argue it, judge it": **Overall, ... (no numbers) · rose sharply / a sharp rise in** (report) → **type → position → two developed ideas** (argue) → **four passes: TR · CC · LR · GRA; these pressures, not Firstly/Moreover** (judge). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook and update the band tracker. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you; the C12 warmer is a good place for a 10-minute Task 1 overview sprint.

Before C12, read the essays you collected. Don't re-mark everything: check whether each learner's own estimate is within half a band of yours, and write one line where it isn't ("You're harder on yourself than you need to be on TR" is as useful as the opposite). Learners who overestimated their GRA or LR need a gentle word: that is the pattern the online lesson predicts, not a failing.

Watch for in Module 4: Speaking is marked on four parallel criteria (Fluency & Coherence, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range & Accuracy, Pronunciation). Make the link out loud in C12–C13: the four-pass habit and the "weakest criterion" logic transfer directly. Speaking Part 3 answers use the same chain as a Task 2 paragraph (point → why → example). Task 1 language (*a sharp rise, roughly a third*) is also useful in Part 2 and Part 3.

Practice Test 2 (C15–C16) includes Writing Task 1 and Task 2 in 60 minutes. Tell learners to spend about 20 minutes on Task 1 and 40 on Task 2, and to use the Module 3 checklists in the last minutes of each task. The C16 debrief compares their Practice Test 2 writing with the C1 diagnostic sample and the C9–C11 work: look for the structural gains (overview present, question type answered, paragraphs, word count) first, because those are the ones that move in eight weeks.

Module 4 — Speaking & Test Mastery

The last five classes of the course. Three workshop classes on the Speaking test and on test day, then the two-class Practice Test 2. First, the shape of the interview and the one habit that lifts most candidates: **extending answers** (answer + why + example), a controlled Part 2 long turn (one minute of keyword notes, two minutes of talk) and a Part 3 answer built like a small argument. Then the marking: the four Speaking criteria, the pronunciation features that move the band (**chunking**, **stress**, **intonation**, not accent) and lexical range used naturally, with learners estimating each other's bands. Last, full practice and a test-day plan: timing for every paper, what to bring, computer- and paper-delivered differences, nerves, results and remark options. C15 and C16 run Practice Test 2, close with an individual band debrief and next-step plan, and end with a celebration.

3 lessons + Practice Test 2

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C12–C16

Weeks 6–8

90 min per class

Target band 6.0–7.5

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One block = one 90-minute class. C12–C14 follow the course's workshop shape: **warmer** (review of the last class) → **lead-in** → **strategy** with Meaning / Form / Pronunciation and concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **guided practice** (workbook) → **timed practice** in trios or pairs → **self- and peer-marking** against paraphrased band criteria → **targeted feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C15 and C16 are test classes with their own plans.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-4-speaking-mastery.html](#). Print [materials/module-4/classroom-materials.html](#) before C12. It holds the picture flashcards and word cards, the new identity cards, the **Part 1 question cards**, ten **original Part 2 cue cards** with linked Part 3 questions, the **mock-examiner kit** (examiner script, timekeeper card, observer sheet), the **Speaking band card** for peer estimation, the **test-day cards**, the **C16 kit** (interview schedule, stop-clock slips, speaking band slips, band profile card, certificates of completion), the **Keep Talking!** board game and the listening scripts.
- Practice Test 2 is a separate document: [assessment/practice-test-2.html](#) (learner copy) and [assessment/practice-test-2-key.html](#) (answers, raw score → band table, paraphrased Writing and Speaking criteria). Read both before C15. The section timings printed there overrule any number in this guide.

- ◆ The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home and copy the stress and intonation.
- ◆ **Speaking is the skill learners fear most and practice least**. Every Speaking class spends at least a quarter of its time on **timed, examiner-style practice** in small groups: mock-examiner trios (C12), band-estimation trios (C13) and a full speaking mock in pairs (C14). Protect that time. If you're running late, shorten the controlled practice (set the rest for homework), never the timed practice.
- ◆ **Feedback in three columns**. During timed practice, take notes in three columns: **accuracy** (errors that cost marks: *I am agree, since two years, people is, informations, the most of people*), **range** (well-chosen language to praise and spread: *it's grown on me, I'm in two minds about it, a heavy workload, arguably*) and **strategy** (test habits: the one-word answer, stopping at 50 seconds in Part 2, a memorized-sounding opening, a filler at the start of every answer). In the feedback stage, board 2–3 items from each column, without names.
- ◆ **Band estimates are estimates**. When learners rate each other with the Speaking band card, they give a **band per criterion with one piece of evidence** ("Lexical 6: *nice* three times, but *go-to place* used well"). Never let a peer estimate become a verdict. Your own estimate is also only an estimate: examiners are trained and standardized, and we are not. Say so.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard**. The online lessons use British spellings and words (*memorise, practise, analyse, favourite, travelling, flat, mum, centre*). Teach *memorize, practice (verb), analyze, favorite, traveling, apartment, mom, center*. The test accepts either variety, consistently used. Accept British forms whenever a learner uses them, and never mark an accent as "wrong."
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Say more → say it better → deliver it on the day. In C12 learners stop giving the examiner too little: every answer grows (answer + why + example), the long turn fills two minutes, and Part 3 becomes a small argument. In C13 they learn how the examiner turns talk into a number, and they lift the two criteria candidates neglect most: pronunciation (chunking, stress, intonation) and lexical resource (precise, natural, sometimes idiomatic). In C14 they rehearse the whole test and plan the run-up to test day, including the parts no textbook practices: the check-in, the clock, the nerves, the results. C15–C16 turn that plan into evidence: a second full practice test, a band profile set beside Practice Test 1, and a personal next step.

THE STAKES ARE REAL: HANDLE THEM KINDLY

Your learners need a band for a university place, a professional license or a visa. Some have already taken IELTS and missed their target; some are sitting it within weeks of C16. Speak honestly and gently about what an 8-week course can do. **A gain of about half a band in 8 weeks is common; bigger jumps happen but are not guaranteed**, and strategy gains (timing, question types, extending answers) come faster than language gains (range, accuracy). Never say "you'll fail" or "you're not ready." Say instead: "Here's where you are today, here's the gap, and here's the one change with the biggest payoff." Practice-test bands move up and down by about half a band from one day to the next for the same person; treat a single result as a snapshot, not a sentence. If a learner is clearly far from their target, talk to them privately about timing their test date, never in front of the group.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: PERSONAL QUESTIONS AND OFFICIAL CHECKS

Part 1 asks about home, family, work and hometown, and several cue cards invite personal memories. For some learners (refugees, people separated from family, people who have lost work or status) these questions are painful. Every personal task in this module offers **three equally good options**: your real life, a **new identity card**, or something invented. Say it every class: "In the test you can invent details. You're marked on your English, not on your life." None of our cue cards asks about a journey to a new country, a hard time, or a family member who is far away. Test day also brings **ID checks, photographs and sometimes a fingerprint scan**. For learners who have been through border or immigration interviews, that can feel very different from how it feels to others. In C14 describe check-in neutrally and in advance, so nothing is a surprise; never role-play an ID check, and let anyone skip that part of the discussion.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): Part 1 topic pictures, the four criteria cards, pronunciation-feature cards, collocation and idiom cards, filler and paraphrase cards, and the test-day kit pictures (bring / leave). Cut them before C12.
- For C12: one set of **Part 1 question cards** (8 sets) and **Part 2 cue cards** (10, each with its Part 3 questions on the back or on a stapled strip) per trio; one **examiner script**, one **timekeeper card** and one **observer sheet** per trio; a phone timer per trio (learners' own phones are fine); scrap paper and pencils for the prep minute.
- For C13: one **Speaking band card** per learner (keep them: they're used again in C14 and C16) and one **peer rating sheet** per learner per round. Optional: learners record their Part 2 on a phone for the homework re-record task.
- For C14: the **test-day cards** (bring / leave / check sort, timing-plan card, nerves toolkit card, countdown planner) and a full set of cue cards for the speaking mock. Print Practice Test 2 now so you're not printing it the night before C15.
- For C15–C16: [assessment/practice-test-2.html](#) (one per learner, plus answer sheets if it has separate ones), the key, a big clock or timer on the screen, pencils, erasers, lined paper for Writing, the **C16 kit** (interview

schedule, stop-clock slips, speaking band slips, band profile cards) and one **certificate** per learner (the shared toolkit's certificate template: `../instructor-toolkit/certificate.html` from the kit folder).

- Find a **side area** for the C16 speaking interviews now: a corridor corner, a small office, the far end of a quiet room. It must be out of earshot of the writers. If you can recruit a **co-teacher or trained volunteer** to invigilate (or to run a second interview area), book them for C16.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- Collect each learner's **Diagnostic** and **Practice Test 1** bands before C15 (from `assessment/answer-keys.html` and your C8–C9 records). You'll need them for the band profile in C16.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.1	C12 • wk 6	Speaking Parts 1–3: format and timing (11–14 min; Part 1 4–5 min, Part 2 3–4 min, Part 3 4–5 min); extending answers (answer + why + example / contrast / experience / hypothetical); the Part 2 cue card (1 min keyword notes, 2 min talk, keep going until stopped); Part 3 as a small argument (opinion → reason → other view → resolution → speculation); fillers that keep the flow; why memorized scripts hurt	answer familiar Part 1 questions in 2–3 developed sentences, give a two-minute talk from an unseen cue card after one minute of keyword notes, and develop an abstract Part 3 answer with an opinion, a reason and a counter-view, under real timing with a peer acting as examiner
4.2	C13 • wk 7	The four Speaking criteria (paraphrased): Fluency & Coherence, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range & Accuracy, Pronunciation; pronunciation features: chunking, word stress, sentence stress, intonation, linking (intelligibility, not accent); lexical range: topic vocabulary, collocation, less common words, idiomatic language used naturally, upgrading basic words, paraphrasing around a gap	estimate a peer's band on each criterion with evidence, mark chunks and stress in their own talk, use two or three less common or idiomatic expressions accurately, and talk around a missing word instead of stopping
4.3	C14 • wk 7	Full practice and test-day strategy: the toolkit review; a timing plan for each paper; what to bring and what to leave; computer-delivered and paper-delivered differences; managing nerves; results, remarks and retakes (factual); a dated countdown plan that tapers	complete a full speaking mock under real timing, state a timing plan for every paper, pack for test day, name two strategies for nerves, explain their results and remark options, and write a dated countdown plan to their test

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
PT2-A	C15 · wk 8	Practice Test 2, part A: timed Listening and Reading under test conditions	complete the Listening and Reading sections to time, using their timing plan and test-day habits
PT2-B	C16 · wk 8	Practice Test 2, part B: Writing (Task 1 + Task 2, 60 min) with short individual speaking interviews in a side area; self-marking with the key; band profile; next-step plan; celebration	write both tasks in 60 minutes, take a short speaking interview, read their band profile honestly, and leave with one clear next step to their test

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- describe the three parts of the Speaking test, their timing and what each one rewards, and explain why the topic moves from personal (Part 1) to abstract (Part 3)
- turn a one-line answer into a **2–3 sentence Part 1 answer** with the **answer + why + example** pattern, and use contrast, experience or a hypothetical to grow it further
- use the **one-minute prep** for keyword notes (not sentences) plus a personal angle, and **speak for the full two minutes**, covering each prompt in order and ending with a reflection
- answer a **Part 3** question with an opinion, a reason, another view and a resolution or a prediction, using hedging (*I'd argue that...*, *I suppose...*, *it's likely that...*)
- keep talking with a natural filler (*That's an interesting question...*, *The thing is...*) instead of freezing, and ask for repetition politely

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 4.1 (New words, Language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, mock-examiner timing grid, self-check)
- Slides 2–7 · Part 1 topic picture cards · **Part 1 question cards** (8 sets) · **Part 2 cue cards** (10, with Part 3 questions) · **mock-examiner kit** (examiner script, timekeeper card, observer sheet) · a phone timer per trio · scrap paper and pencils · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 4.1-A (two candidates, same Part 1 questions), 4.1-B (a model long turn) and 4.1-C (a Part 3 exchange)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the interview (11–14 min). Part 1 · familiar topics · 4–5 min · 2–3 sentences each → Part 2 · cue card · 1 min notes + 2 min talk (+ 1 short question) → Part 3 · abstract discussion · 4–5 min · 3–4 sentences each. Personal → general. Prepare the format, not the words.

Center: grow the answer. Do you like cooking? ✗ Yes, I do. ✓ Answer Yes, especially on weekends, why because it helps me switch off, example last Sunday I made soup for my whole building. + contrast (Unlike baking...) · experience (I remember...) · hypothetical (If I had more time, I'd...)

Right: Part 2 and Part 3. Prep minute: keywords per bullet + one personal angle + an ending. Keep going until "Thank you." Part 3: **opinion → reason → other view → resolution → future.** I'd argue that... · The main reason is... · That said, some people would say... · So perhaps... · In the long run, I imagine...

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: link it, don't over-link it	8	S-S	Review C11 (3.3, coherence and cohesion in Writing). Board a paragraph of four short sentences with no linking and a second one with a linker in every sentence (<i>Moreover... Furthermore... In addition...</i>). Pairs fix both in 3 minutes. Then the bridge: "Speaking is marked on coherence too. Today the linking happens out loud." Quick check of one C11 homework item (the self-assessed Task 2 paragraph). Note one error and one good piece of range.
Lead-in: the interview in three parts	5	T-S	Slide 2. Ask: "How long is the Speaking test? A machine or a person? Can you make notes?" Reveal the three parts and times. Ask learners to guess one Part 1 question, one cue-card topic and one Part 3 question. Point out the thread: Part 2's topic becomes Part 3's abstract discussion. "You can't know the questions. You can know the format so well it feels routine."
Strategy: extending answers (M/F/P)	10	T-S	Slide 3. Say "Do you like cooking?" and answer "Yes, I do." Stop. Hold the silence for three seconds. "What can the examiner mark?" (Almost nothing.) Build the strong answer on the board, move by move, eliciting each part. CCQs (below). Then the other moves: contrast, experience, hypothetical. Pronunciation: the answer comes in chunks , each with one strong stress (see note).
Drill: grow it	5	T-S → S	See Drill script. Choral for the chunked model answer, then the "grow it" chain round the room (each learner adds one move to the last learner's answer), then individual with a picture card.
Listening: two candidates	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.1-A : Candidate 1 (Hana) and Candidate 2 (Diego) answer the same four Part 1 questions. First listening: "Who will score higher? Why?" Second listening: learners tick the moves Diego uses for each question. Pairs compare. Then read Script 4.1-C (the Part 3 exchange) once: learners call

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			out the moves as they hear them ("opinion!", "other view!").
Guided practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (grow the answer) and Ex 3 (match the move) alone, then say the grown answers to a partner. Board-check Ex 3. Ex 5 (order the Part 3 answer) in pairs if time; otherwise homework.
Strategy: the long turn and Part 3	10	T-S → S	Slides 5–6. Show the model cue card (<i>a piece of technology you find useful</i>). Set a real one-minute timer and make your own keyword notes on the board, thinking aloud: one cluster per bullet, one personal angle, one ending. Read Script 4.1-B (the model long turn); learners tick each bullet as it's covered and note the signposts. Then Workbook Ex 4: learners make keyword notes for a new cue card in exactly 60 seconds . Check: "Did anyone write a full sentence?" Slide 6: the five Part 3 moves and the hedging bank.
Timed practice: mock-examiner trios	25	S-S (trios) → T-S	Slide 7. Trios: candidate , examiner (reads from the script and the cards), timekeeper-observer (times each part and fills the observer sheet). Three rounds of 8 minutes, roles rotate: Part 1 (1½ min, three questions from one card) → Part 2 (1 min prep + up to 2 min talk + one rounding-off question) → Part 3 (2 min, two questions) → feedback (1½ min: the observer gives one strength and one next step, quoting the candidate). Put a big timer on the screen and call each part change for the whole room. ICQs first. One minute to set up.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction in three columns. Accuracy, for example: "I am agree," "since two years," "people is." Range: "it helps me switch off," "that said," "I suppose it's possible that..." Strategy: the Part 2 talk that ended at 55 seconds, a Part 3 answer with an opinion but no reason. Learners fix the errors aloud. Ask two candidates: "What was the hardest moment? What did you do?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 4.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below): the recorded full speaking run is the key task. Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 5 + 7 + 10 + 10 + 25 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the trios. Cut in this order: (1) Script 4.1-C becomes homework; (2) Workbook Ex 2 shrinks to items 1-3; (3) the trios run as two 8-minute rounds plus one 6-minute round (Part 3 only one question). Every learner must be the candidate once.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: why extend? The examiner can only mark the language you produce. A one-line answer gives no evidence of range, grammar or fluency, so it caps the score even when it's correct.

SAY: "Do you like cooking?" "Yes, I do." Is it correct? (Yes.) Is it enough? (No.) Why not? (There's nothing to mark: no vocabulary, no grammar range, no fluency.) Does a longer answer mean a speech? (No: 2-3 sentences in Part 1.) Does the examiner want the truth? (They want English. You can invent details.)

Meaning: Part 2 and the prep minute. The minute is for a plan, not a script.

SAY: You have one minute. Do you write sentences? (No: keywords.) How many clusters? (One per bullet, plus an ending.) The examiner says nothing after 1 minute 20 seconds. Do you stop? (No: keep going until they say "Thank you.") You run out of ideas at one minute. What do you add? (Another reason, an example, a comparison, a feeling.)

Meaning: Part 3. The questions become general and abstract (people, society, the future), not about you.

SAY: "Should schools teach cooking?" Is the examiner asking about your school? (No: schools in general.) Is "Yes, they should" enough? (No: give a reason and consider another view.) Must you have a strong opinion? (No: "It depends on..." is fine if you explain what it depends on.) Is there a right answer? (No: they mark the English and the reasoning, not your opinion.)

Form.

Answer	respond directly first	Yes, I really do... · Not really, to be honest... · It depends, really...
Why	because / since + clause · The main reason is that...	...because it helps me switch off after work.

Example	<i>For example, / For instance, + past simple story</i>	Last Sunday, for instance, I made soup for the whole building.
Contrast	<i>Unlike + noun, I... · Whereas...</i>	Unlike my brother, who lives on takeout, I...
Experience	<i>I remember + -ing / when...</i>	I remember burning rice the first time I tried.
Hypothetical	<i>If I had..., I'd... (second conditional)</i>	If I had more time, I'd take a proper course.
Part 3 moves	opinion → reason → other view → resolution → future	I'd argue that... · mainly because... · That said, ... · So perhaps... · In the long run, I imagine...

Pronunciation. An extended answer is spoken in **chunks** (thought groups), each with one main stress and a short pause between them: *Yes, I really **DO** | especially on **WEEK**ends | because it helps me switch **OFF** after work*. Model it, then model the robot version (every word equal) and ask which is easier to follow. Fillers need a relaxed, falling tone (*Well, that's an interesting question... ↘*), not a panicked rise. Tomorrow's class goes deeper into chunking and stress: today just hear it.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Chunk it** (choral, then three individuals): T: "Yes, I really **DO** |" → S repeat. T: "especially on **WEEK**ends |" → S. T: "because it helps me switch **OFF** after work." → S. Then the whole answer, with the pauses.
- 2 Grow it** (a chain round the room): T: "Do you like mornings?" S1: "Not really." S2: "Not really, because I'm a night person." S3: adds an example ("Yesterday, for instance, I..."). S4: adds a contrast or hypothetical ("If I could choose, I'd start work at ten."). Next question, new chain: "Do you use public transportation?" · "Is your neighborhood a good place for families?" (new identity cards welcome) · "Do you enjoy music?"
- 3 Picture prompt** (individual, fast): hold up a Part 1 picture card (read, cook, hike, swim, play-the-guitar, park, market, mobile-phone). Nominate: "Do you like...?" The learner gives answer + why + example in under 20 seconds. Praise the move, not just the words: "Great, that was a contrast."
- 4 Buy time** (choral): T: "Why do you think some skills disappear?" S (all, falling tone): "Well, that's an interesting question..." T nominates one learner to finish with an opinion and a reason.

◆ MOCK-EXAMINER TRIOS – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Roles.** The **examiner** reads only from the examiner script and the cards: no chatting, no helping, a friendly neutral face. The **timekeeper-observer** runs the phone timer, says "Thank you" at 2 minutes in Part 2, and fills the observer sheet (ticks for extended answers, the Part 2 bullets covered, the Part 3 moves heard, one quote to praise, one to fix). The **candidate** speaks. Give dominant speakers the examiner or timekeeper job first: it asks them to listen.
- ◆ **One round (8 min):** Part 1, examiner takes one Part 1 card and asks three questions (1½ min) → Part 2, examiner hands over a cue card and says "You have one minute to prepare" (1 min), then "Please start

speaking now" (up to 2 min), then one rounding-off question (e.g. "Would you recommend it to others?") → Part 3, examiner asks the two Part 3 questions linked to that cue card (2 min) → feedback: observer gives **one strength and one next step**, both quoted (1½ min).

- ◆ **Call the parts for the whole room.** Everyone moves on your timer ("Part 2, prep minute starts... now"), so no trio drifts. If a talk ends early, the timekeeper writes the time on the sheet: that's useful data, not a failure.
- ◆ **Cue cards.** Deal each trio four different cue cards face down. The candidate never chooses: in the test you can't. Anyone may use a new identity card for Part 1, and invent every detail in Part 2.
- ◆ **You** sit in with a different trio each round and take three-column notes. Don't interrupt a candidate. If an examiner starts helping, whisper "Just the script."

SAY: ICQs: *How many roles? (Three: candidate, examiner, timekeeper.) Can the examiner help the candidate? (No: just the script.) In the prep minute, sentences or keywords? (Keywords.) The candidate stops talking at one minute. What does the timekeeper do? (Waits, writes the time; the examiner can say "Can you tell me more?" once.) Who chooses the cue card? (Nobody: take the top one.) Do you have to talk about your real life? (No: a new identity card or invented details are fine.) What does the observer give? (One strength and one next step, with a quote.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Some learners speak much more confidently than they write, and the prep minute's note-taking can slow them down. Offer **picture notes** (a quick sketch per bullet is fine: the test only needs notes you can read) or the **4-box note frame** from Workbook Ex 4 (what · who · how long · feeling). Give them the cue card read aloud as well as on paper. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–3, Ex 5 as a spoken task. Target: a Part 2 talk that covers all the bullets and passes 90 seconds, and one Part 1 answer with all three moves.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Band 7+ candidates speak at length **without** sounding prepared. Ask strong learners to (1) answer a Part 3 question with a **concession that changes their position a little** (*I used to think..., but now I'd say...*); (2) use **two different speculative structures** in one answer (*I suspect... · It wouldn't surprise me if... · There's every chance that...*); and (3) in Part 2, add a **flashback or a comparison** the bullets don't ask for, so the talk fills two minutes naturally. As examiners, they must ask one unscripted follow-up in Part 3 ("Why do you think that is?").

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I am agree" / "I am not agree"** (Spanish *estoy de acuerdo*, Portuguese *estou de acordo*, French *je suis d'accord*, Arabic and Farsi patterns): the most frequent Part 3 error. Board it every class: *I agree · I don't agree · I'm not sure I agree.*

- ◆ **Tense with *since/for*:** "I live here since two years" (Spanish, French, German, Russian, Polish use a present tense). Part 1 is full of these: *I've lived here for two years*.
- ◆ **Dropped *be* and articles** (Arabic, Chinese, Russian, Vietnamese): "My hometown very beautiful," "I am student." In speech these errors are frequent but don't usually block meaning; target them in feedback, but praise the extension first.
- ◆ **He/she** in stories about people (Tagalog *siya*, Chinese *tā*, Farsi *u*, Finnish, Turkish, Yoruba): long Part 2 stories about a teacher or friend expose it. Ask the observer to listen for it.
- ◆ **Very short "polite" answers:** learners from cultures where talking at length to an authority figure is rude (many East and Southeast Asian classrooms, some rural or formal cultures) may give short answers out of respect, not lack of English. Name it: "In this test, talking more **is** the polite thing to do."
- ◆ **Memorized openings:** learners from exam systems that reward memorization may arrive with a rehearsed "Let me introduce my hometown..." paragraph. Treat it kindly: keep the vocabulary, drop the script.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_10.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and copy the rhythm; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and "**Record a Full Speaking Run**" (Part 1, a Part 2 cue card with a real one-minute prep, Part 3, then self-review on the phone). Workbook 4.1: finish Ex 5, "My new words" and the journal (the shortest answer you gave today, rewritten as a fully extended one, and the filler you'll use next time instead of stopping). Bring the recording (or notes on it) to C13: we'll score it.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C "I love it, actually — it's how I switch off before bed..." · Q2 B Jot keywords for each bullet plus a personal angle · Q3 (new) B the answer with an opinion, a reason and another view. Listening (Ex 1): Diego, Q1 answer + why + example · Q2 answer + contrast + hypothetical · Q3 answer + why + experience · Q4 answer + why + example. Hana gives one-line answers throughout.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ name the **four Speaking criteria** and say, in their own words, what separates about band 5, 6 and 7 on each (paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors)
- ◆ speak in **chunks** (thought groups) with a pause between them, and stress the right syllable in common academic words (*pho**T**Ography, e**C**onomy, eco**N**omic, **CO**Mfortable*)
- ◆ use **sentence stress** for meaning and contrast, and **intonation** for questions, lists and closing a point (rise ↗ · fall ↘)
- ◆ replace over-used words (*good, nice, thing, very, a lot*) with precise ones, use natural **collocations** and one or two **idiomatic expressions** accurately and in the right register
- ◆ **paraphrase** around a word they can't find, and **estimate a peer's band** on each criterion with one piece of evidence

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.2 (New words, Language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, peer rating sheet, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 8–13 · Criteria cards · Pronunciation-feature cards · Collocation, idiom and paraphrase cards · **Speaking band card** (1 per learner) · **peer rating sheets** · Part 2 cue cards · phone timers · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.2-A (the same talk at about band 5 and about band 7) and 4.2-B (stress and intonation dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: four criteria, 25% each. FC Fluency & Coherence (keep going, link ideas) · LR Lexical Resource (range, precision, less common and idiomatic words, paraphrase) · GRA Grammatical Range & Accuracy (mix of structures, few errors) · P Pronunciation (easy to understand; stress, intonation, chunking). *Paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors.*

Center: clarity, not accent. chunks: *What I love about it | is the sense of SPACE | especially in the EARLY morning.* · word stress: PHOtO → phoTOgraphy → photoGRaphic · e**C**onomy / eco**N**omic · sentence stress: I didn't say SHE took it. · intonation: Do you live nearby? ↗ · Where are you from? ↘ · reading ↗, cooking ↗ and hiking ↘.

Right: range, used naturally. good → rewarding / worthwhile · nice → welcoming / scenic · thing → aspect / drawback · very tired → exhausted · a heavy workload · strike a balance · it's grown on me · I'm in two minds about it. Gap? *It's a kind of...* · *the thing you use to...* · *I don't know the exact word, but...* One natural idiom > three forced ones.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: speed Part 1	8	S-S	Review C12. Two lines facing each other (or an inner and outer circle). Line A asks one Part 1 question from a card; line B answers in 2-3 sentences with answer + why + example. Every 60 seconds, line B moves one place; swap roles halfway. Then 60 seconds of homework talk in pairs: "Your recorded run: the longest answer? The moment you nearly froze?" Note one error and one piece of range.
Lead-in: how does talk become a number?	5	T-S → S-S	Slide 8. Pairs get the four criteria cards and eight "what it rewards" strips (e.g. <i>stress and intonation, less common words, few errors, no long pauses</i>). They match in 90 seconds; check on the slide. Ask: "Which criterion is not about accent?" (All of them. Pronunciation is about being easy to understand.) "Which two do candidates neglect most?" (Pronunciation and Lexical Resource: today's focus.)
Strategy: pronunciation features (M/F/P)	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 9-10. Four quick steps, each with a CCQ (below): chunking (read a sentence with random pauses, then in thought groups; learners mark the slashes); word stress (the <i>photograph</i> / <i>photography</i> / <i>photographic</i> family, then <i>economy</i> / <i>economic</i>); sentence stress (the "I didn't say she took it" game: stress a different word, learners say what it means); intonation (yes/no ↗, wh- ↘, lists ↗ ↗ ↘, enthusiasm). Connected speech in one line: <i>an apple</i> → <i>a-napple</i> , <i>turn it off</i> → <i>tur-ni-toff</i> .
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: stress ping-pong, chunk-and-stress a Part 2 sentence, the list-intonation chain. Choral first, then individual. Then Script 4.2-B (dictation): learners write the sentence and mark the stressed word and the arrow.
Strategy: lexical range	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Board "It was a very nice place and the people were good." Elicit upgrades (<i>scenic, welcoming, friendly, attentive</i>) and ask "Which fits a

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			beach? a hotel? a doctor's office?" (precision, not just "bigger" words). Collocation cards: pairs join halves (<i>strike / a balance · a heavy / workload · pay close / attention</i>). Idiom cards: "Would you say <i>it's not my cup of tea</i> about a job interview? about a TV show?" Then the paraphrase game: one learner describes a word card without saying it, using a frame; the partner guesses.
Listening: band 5 vs band 7	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.2-A : the same Part 2 talk (a market the speaker likes) at about band 5, then about band 7. First listening: "Same ideas? Which is higher? Name one reason." Second listening (band 7 only): learners complete the six gaps and circle the paraphrase. Pairs compare. Slide 13: why each version sits where it does.
Guided practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (word stress, say them to a partner) and Ex 4 (upgrade and collocate). Board-check disagreements. Ex 3 (chunks and arrows) and Ex 5 (paraphrase) are homework if time runs short.
Timed practice: band-estimation trios	24	S-S (trios) → T-S	Slide 13. Trios: candidate, examiner, rater (with the band card and the peer rating sheet). Three rounds of 7½ minutes: Part 2 (1 min prep + 2 min talk) and one Part 3 question (1 min) → the rater estimates a band per criterion with one quoted piece of evidence and gives the candidate one target for a re-try (2 min) → the candidate re-does the first 30 seconds of the talk, hitting the target (1 min). Roles rotate. In the last 1½ minutes, calibration : you read one short answer aloud (from your notes) and everyone rates it; compare and discuss the spread.
Feedback	5	T-S	Three columns. Accuracy: "an informations," "I am very interesting in music" (interested), wrong stress (<i>DEvelopment, comFORTable, ecoNOMy</i>) that made a word hard to catch. Range: "a daunting task," "it's grown on me." Strategy: a forced idiom, a monotone list, a silence where a paraphrase

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			would have worked. Ask: "Raters, which criterion was hardest to judge? Why?"
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 4.2 and point at a  button. Set the homework (below): record, self-assess, re-record. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		$8 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 10 + 7 + 8 + 24 + 5 + 5$

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the band-estimation trios and the calibration minute: without calibration, peer bands drift wildly. Cut in this order: (1) Script 4.2-B dictation becomes two sentences; (2) Workbook Ex 4 goes to homework; (3) the re-try in each round shrinks to 20 seconds.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: Pronunciation is intelligibility. The criterion rewards being easy to understand and controlling features (stress, intonation, chunking, linking). It does not reward any particular accent.

SAY: *Does the examiner want a British accent? (No.) An American one? (No.) What do they want? (To understand you easily, first time.) Can a strong accent get a high band? (Yes, if it's clear and the features are well controlled.) Should you fix every sound? (No: only the ones that cause confusion.)*

Meaning: chunking and stress.

SAY: *"What I love about it | is the sense of SPACE." Where's the pause? (After it.) Why there? (It's the end of one idea.) Which word is strongest? (space.) Why that one? (It's the new, important information.) • "I didn't say SHE took it." Did someone take it? (Yes.) Who? (Someone else, not her.)*

SAY: *"Do you live nearby?" Up or down at the end? (Up: yes/no question.) "Where do you live?" (Down: wh-question.) "I like reading, cooking and hiking." Where does the voice fall? (On hiking: the list is finished.)*

Meaning: less common and idiomatic language. Higher bands use some less common words and idiomatic expressions **naturally and accurately**. Forced or wrongly used idioms pull the score down.

SAY: *"It's not really my cup of tea." Is it about tea? (No.) Positive or negative? (Mildly negative: I don't enjoy it much.) Formal or informal? (Informal, but fine in the Speaking test.) Would you use it in a Writing Task 2 essay? (No.) • "I'm in two minds about it." Am I sure? (No: I can see both sides.) Good for Part 1 or Part 3? (Both, especially Part 3.) • A candidate says "It was raining cats and dogs, so I was over*

the moon to see the moon." Natural? (No: forced, and it doesn't fit.) What should they say? (Something simpler that they control.)

Form.

Word stress	suffixes move it: <i>-graphy, -ic, -ity, -tion</i> stress the syllable before	PHO tograph · pho TO graphy · photo GRA phic · e CO nomy · eco NO mic · de VE lopment · COM fortable (3 syllables in natural speech: COMF-ta-ble)
Sentence stress	stress content words; glide over grammar words; shift stress for contrast	I usually head there with a couple of close FRIENDS . · I didn't go with my SIS ter, I went with my COU sin.
Intonation	↗ yes/no, unfinished list · ↘ wh-, statements, end of list	Do you enjoy it? ↗ · What do you do there? ↘ · reading ↗, cooking ↗ and hiking ↘
Upgrades	precise, not just "bigger"	good → rewarding / worthwhile / beneficial · nice → pleasant / welcoming / scenic · thing → aspect / factor / drawback · very big → enormous · a lot of → a wide range of / plenty of
Collocation	words that live together	make a decision · a heavy workload · strike a balance · pay close attention · a close-knit community · a daunting task · vividly remember
Idiomatic	conversational, used sparingly	it's not really my cup of tea · I'm in two minds about it · off the top of my head · it's grown on me · a bit of a game-changer · time flies
Paraphrase frames	describe around a gap	It's a kind of... · It's the thing you use to... · It's a bit like a... · I don't know the exact word, but... · It's what you'd call...

Pronunciation of the new language. Idioms carry their stress on the key content word: *not really my cup of TEA, I'm in TWO minds about it, it's GROWN on me*. Collocations are said as one chunk with no pause inside: *a heavy WORKload*. The paraphrase frames should sound calm and conversational: a falling tone on *I don't know the exact word, but...* ↘ tells the examiner you're in control.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Stress ping-pong** (choral, clap on the stress): T: "PHOtograph" → S: "phoTOgraphy." T: "phoTOgraphy" → "photoGRAphic." T: "eCOonomy" → "ecoNOmic." T: "deVELOp" → "deVELOpment." T: "enVironment" → "environMENTal." T: "TECHnical" → "techNOlogy." T: "COMfortable" (three syllables).
- 2 Chunk and stress** (choral, then individual): "What I love about it | is the sense of SPACE | especially in the EARly morning | when there's hardly anyone AROUND." Say it robot-style first, then in chunks. Ask

one learner to conduct the class with a hand for each chunk.

- 3 **The list chain:** T: "What do you do on weekends?" S1: "I go SWIMming ↗..." S2: "...SWIMming ↗, CYcling ↗..." S3: "...and I SLEEP ↘." Next topic: "What do you need for a picnic?" "What makes a good neighbor?"
- 4 **Upgrade it** (fast, individual): T: "a very nice view" → S: "a stunning / breathtaking view." T: "a very big problem" → "a serious / major problem." T: "a good job" → "a rewarding job." T: "a lot of choices" → "a wide range of choices." T: "a bad experience" → "a disappointing / unpleasant experience."

◆ BAND-ESTIMATION TRIOS – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **The band card** (materials set E) has the four criteria, with short descriptions at about bands 5, 6, 7 and 8, **paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors**. Walk the class through one row before they use it: "On Lexical Resource, what's the difference between 6 and 7?" (At 7, some less common and idiomatic words are used well, and paraphrase is flexible.)
- ◆ **One round (7½ min):** the examiner gives a cue card (1 min prep, up to 2 min talk) and asks one linked Part 3 question (1 min). The rater listens and writes **quotes**, not judgments, on the rating sheet: one per criterion. Then the rater gives a band per criterion with the quote as evidence, and **one target** ("Next time, stress the last item of your list" / "Swap *good* for something more precise") (2 min). The candidate re-does the first 30 seconds of the talk with the target (1 min). Rotate roles.
- ◆ **Whole bands only.** Raters give a whole band per criterion (5, 6, 7 or 8). If they can't decide, they write "6/7" and the evidence for each. That's honest, not weak.
- ◆ **Calibration (last 1½ min):** read aloud one answer you noted in a trio (anonymously, or a model from Script 4.2-A). Everyone rates it silently, then shows fingers for Lexical Resource. Discuss the spread: "Why a 5? Why a 7? What would move it up?" This minute makes the difference between useful peer rating and guesswork.
- ◆ **Kindness rule:** the rater gives the bands and evidence **to the candidate only**, quietly, and starts with the strongest criterion. No bands are shared with the class.

SAY: ICQs: What does the rater write while listening, opinions or quotes? (Quotes.) How many bands do you give? (Four: one per criterion.) Half bands? (No: whole bands, or "6/7" with evidence.) What does the candidate get besides bands? (One target.) Then what does the candidate do? (Re-do the first 30 seconds.) Who hears the bands? (Only the candidate.) Is the rater's band the real score? (No: an estimate.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

The band card is text-heavy. Give these learners the **one-line version** (the "look for" line under each criterion: *keeps going?* · *precise words?* · *mix of sentences?* · *easy to understand?*) and a rating sheet with **tick boxes** instead of written quotes; they can say their evidence aloud. For stress work, use **big and small dots** above the syllables (● •• for PHOtograph) instead of capitals. Fewer items: Ex 2 items 1–6, Ex 4 items 1–3. Target: rate one criterion with one spoken example, and say three words with the right stress.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

At bands 7–8 the difference is often **control**: less common words used with precise collocation and register. Ask strong learners to (1) upgrade a Part 3 answer by adding one **precise collocation**, one **hedge** and one **idiomatic expression**, then justify why each fits; (2) use **contrastive stress** deliberately in a Part 3 comparison (*It's not the COST that worries people, it's the TIME*); and (3) act as the calibration reader: choose an answer that sits between two bands and argue for one of them with evidence.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Syllable-timed rhythm** (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, Turkish, Tagalog, Hindi-Urdu, Cantonese, many West African languages): every syllable gets equal weight, so sentence stress and chunks disappear. Clapping the stressed syllable and "robot vs chunk" contrasts help more than explanation.
- ◆ **Extra vowels**: Spanish and Portuguese speakers add *e-* before *s* + consonant (*es-tudy*, *es-peak*); Arabic and Farsi speakers insert vowels in clusters (*pi-lease*); Japanese speakers add final vowels (*desk-u*). Only fix these if they cause confusion.
- ◆ **Dropped final consonants** (Vietnamese, Cantonese, Mandarin, Thai): *walk / walked*, *like / likes* merge, which also hides grammar and can cost Grammatical Range & Accuracy. Target the *-ed* and *-s* endings in the long turn.
- ◆ **Specific sounds that cause real confusion**: *p / b* (Arabic: *people / beebble*), *l / r* (Japanese, Korean: *collect / correct*), *v / w* (Hindi-Urdu, German), *th → s / t / f* (many L1s). Work only on the pair that affects each learner.
- ◆ **Flat or falling intonation that sounds uninterested** (German, Russian, Polish, some Chinese speakers when nervous): the examiner may hear boredom. Practice the rise-fall of enthusiasm: *It was absolutely ↗ aMAzing ↘*.
- ◆ **Cognate stress**: Spanish, Portuguese, French and Italian speakers carry their L1 stress into cognates (*comforTABLE*, *developMENT*, *ecoNOMy*, *phoTOgraph*). The Ex 2 word list targets exactly these.
- ◆ **"I am very interesting in..."** (*-ed / -ing* adjectives: Spanish, Arabic, Chinese, Russian): frequent in Part 1 hobby answers.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_11.html. Listen to the five model sentences with  and copy the stress and word groups; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and **"Record, Self-Assess, Re-record"** (a Part 2 turn, scored on all four criteria with the band card, one target per criterion, a second recording). Workbook 4.2: Ex 3 and Ex 5 if not finished, "My new words" (five over-used words and their sharper alternatives) and the journal (your band estimate on each criterion with one line of evidence, and the one criterion you'll target this week).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Being clearly understood, with good use of stress, intonation and connected speech · Q2 **A** Paraphrase: describe the word so the examiner understands · Q3 (new) **C** "I used to find jazz a bit chaotic, but it's really grown on me." Listening (Ex 1): 1 go-to 2 bustling 3 catch up 4 vividly 5 wide range 6 recharged; paraphrase: "that thing, I don't know the exact word, where you argue about the price" (= haggling / bargaining).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ rate themselves **solid** / **shaky** / **not yet** on the course's twelve band-raising moves, and choose where revision hours go first
- ◆ state a **timing plan** for each paper (Listening, Reading, Writing, Speaking) and apply it under the clock
- ◆ say **what to bring, what to leave and what to check** on test day, and describe the main practical differences between **computer-delivered** and **paper-delivered** tests in general terms
- ◆ use two or three **strategies for nerves** (a breathing reset, self-talk, a pre-test routine) and plan **if-then responses** to test-day problems
- ◆ explain **results, remark and retake options** factually, and write a **dated countdown plan** that front-loads their weakest skill and tapers before the test
- ◆ complete a **full speaking mock** under real timing

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.3 (New words, Language box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, countdown planner, self-check)
- ◆ Slides 14–16 · Test-day kit picture cards (bring / leave) · **Test-day cards** (bring / leave / check sort, timing-plan card, nerves toolkit card) · Part 1 question cards and Part 2 cue cards · **Speaking band cards** (from C13) · phone timers
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.3-A (a test-day briefing) and 4.3-B (self-talk dictation)
- ◆ Practice Test 2 printed and ready for C15 (don't hand it out)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the clock. Listening ~30 min · 4 parts · 40 Q · read ahead · never a blank (paper: extra time to transfer at the end · computer: a short check at the end). Reading 60 min · 3 passages · ~20 min each · **no extra transfer time**. Writing 60 min · Task 1 ~20 min (150+) · Task 2 ~40 min (250+; worth more). Speaking 11–14 min · same day or a few days apart.

Center: the day. BRING the ID you registered with · pencils / pens as instructed · water (usually a clear, label-free bottle) · CHECK address, travel time, reporting time, format · LEAVE phone and watch in the locker, notes at home. Nerves: breathe out longer than in · "One mark each: guess, mark it, move on." · If-then: If I miss an answer, I'll go to the next one.

Right: after the test. Results: online first, then the Test Report Form; computer-delivered usually faster. Unhappy with a score? Ask your test center about a **remark** (enquiry on results) within the allowed period. Retake: the full test any time; some centers offer a **one skill retake**. Check that your university or employer accepts it. Countdown: technique → timed → full mocks → taper → rest.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Keep Talking!	8	S-S (groups of 3-4)	Review C12–C13 with the Keep Talking! board game (materials set H): roll, move, do the square (extend a Part 1 answer, stress a word, upgrade a word, paraphrase, a Part 3 opinion). Stop at 7 minutes; nearest the finish wins. One minute of homework talk: "Which criterion did you target in your re-recording? Did it move?"
Lead-in: your toolkit	7	S → S-S	Workbook 4.3, toolkit table: learners rate each of the twelve band-raising moves (one per lesson) solid · shaky · not yet . Pairs compare their two "not yet" rows and say which one costs them

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			most marks. Ask three learners (volunteers only) to share one "shaky" row. "Today we plan what to do about it, and we practice the one paper nobody can mark alone: Speaking."
Strategy: timing and format	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 14. The timing plan for each paper (board, left). Read Script 4.3-A (a teacher's test-day briefing). Workbook Ex 1: learners complete the checklist gaps. Then the computer / paper comparison (see note below): learners say which format they've booked and, in pairs, which difference matters most for them. CCQs.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Strategy: test day, nerves and results	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15: groups sort the bring / leave / check cards (picture cards on the board: passport, pencil, pen, water; phone and notebook in the "leave" column). Describe check- in neutrally (ID check, a photo, sometimes a fingerprint scan). Slide 16: the nerves toolkit. Teach the longer out- breath (in for 4, out for 6, three times) and do it together once. Then results, remarks and retakes (factual note below). Workbook Ex 5 part B: three if- then plans.
Drill: self- talk and time- buyers	4	T-S → S	See Drill script. Script 4.3-B as a quick dictation of the self-talk lines, then choral time-buyers with a calm

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			falling tone, then an individual "problem → plan" round.
Guided practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (spot the test-day error), Ex 3 (order the countdown) and Ex 4 (diagnose the profile). Pairs check; board-check Ex 4 carefully: "nothing below 6.0" requirements surprise many learners.
Timed practice: full speaking mock	26	S-S (pairs, or trios with an observer) → T-S	Test conditions: pairs sit facing each other, the examiner with the script and a timer. Two rounds of 12 minutes , then swap: Part 1 (3 min, two question cards) → Part 2 (1 min prep, 2 min talk, one rounding-off question) → Part 3 (4 min,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			three or four questions) → the examiner fills the band card silently and gives the candidate two bands with evidence (the strongest and the weakest criterion) and one target (2 min). Use a new cue card each round. You circulate and listen to every candidate for at least one minute. Two minutes for set-up.
Feedback & countdown plan	13	T-S → S	First, three-column feedback on the mock (5 min): Accuracy ("since two years," "people is"), Range ("it depends largely on...", "a bit of a game-changer"), Strategy (a strong opening that ran out at 1:20, a Part 3

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			answer that never gave a reason). Then learners write their dated countdown plan in Workbook 4.3 (8 min): real dates, the weakest area front-loaded, a full mock two weeks out, a taper in the last week. Circulate and check each plan has dates and one weekly Writing or Speaking feedback slot.
Looking ahead & homework	5	T-S	Slide 17: preview C15 and C16 (Practice Test 2). "Next class: Listening and Reading, timed like the real thing. Bring pencils, an eraser and water; arrive five minutes early so we can start on time. C16: Writing, short speaking interviews,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			your band profile and a celebration." Set the homework (below). Learners tick the 4.3 "I can..." list.
Total	90		8 + 7 + 8 + 10 + 4 + 9 + 26 + 13 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the full speaking mock and the countdown plan. Cut in this order: (1) the Keep Talking! warmer stops at 5 minutes; (2) Workbook Ex 2 and Ex 3 become homework (keep Ex 4); (3) Part 3 in the mock shrinks to 3 minutes. **Never cut Looking Ahead:** learners must leave knowing exactly what happens in C15 and what to bring.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: timing plans. The clock is part of the test. A plan decides in advance what to do when a question takes too long.

SAY: *In Reading, is there extra time at the end to copy answers? (No: write them on the answer sheet as you go.) About how long for each passage? (About 20 minutes.) A question is taking five minutes. What do you do? (Guess, mark it, move on.) Is a hard question worth more? (No: one mark each.) • In Writing, which task first? (Either, but most people do Task 1 first, in about 20 minutes.) Which task is worth more? (Task 2.) So which one must never be short? (Task 2.)*

Computer-delivered and paper-delivered: the general picture. Describe differences in general terms and send learners to their **test provider's official information** for the details of their own booking. Content, question types, timing and difficulty are the same in both formats, and the **Speaking test is face to face with an examiner in both**. The practical differences: on computer, answers are typed or clicked straight in, Writing shows a word count, text can usually be highlighted, and Listening gives a short check time at the end rather than time to transfer answers; results usually arrive sooner. On paper, Listening and Reading answers go on an answer sheet (in Listening there's extra time at the end to transfer them; in Reading there isn't), Writing is handwritten so legibility matters and you estimate your own word count (count the words in three lines, average them, multiply). **Practice in the format you've booked.**

SAY: *Is the computer test easier? (No: same content, same difficulty.) Is Speaking done with a computer? (No: with a person, in both formats.) On paper, how do you know your word count? (Estimate: words per line × lines.) Which format should you practice in? (The one you've booked.)*

Results, remarks and retakes: factual. Results are released online first and then as a **Test Report Form**; computer-delivered results usually arrive faster than paper-based ones. Many universities and employers accept results for about two years, but **each organization sets its own rules**. If a candidate believes a score doesn't reflect their performance, they can ask their **test center** for a **remark** (officially an "enquiry on results") within a limited period after the test; they can usually choose which sections are re-marked, a fee is charged, and it's refunded if the band score goes up. Candidates can take the full test again whenever they like. In many locations there's also a **one skill retake** option for a single section. Check with the test center and with the receiving organization before relying on either. Don't quote fees, deadlines or turnaround times in class: they vary by country and change. Show learners where to find them.

SAY: *Can you ask for a remark for any reason, any time? (No: within a limited period, through the test center.) Is it free? (No, but the fee is returned if your score goes up.) Does every university accept a one skill retake? (Not necessarily: check first.) Where do you find the exact rules and dates? (The test provider's official information and your test center.)*

Form: planning language.

Plans	<i>I'm going to / I'll + verb · I'm taking (arranged)</i>	I'm taking the test on May 14. · I'm going to do one timed Reading every Tuesday.
If-then plans	<i>If + present, I'll + verb</i>	If I miss a Listening answer, I'll go straight to the next one. · If my mind goes blank, I'll say "Let me think for a second."
By test day	<i>By + time, I'll have + past participle</i>	By the end of April, I'll have done two full timed mocks.
Time-buyers	calm, falling tone	That's an interesting question — let me think for a second. · Off the top of my head, ... · Sorry, could you repeat that? · Do you mean ... or ...?

Pronunciation. Time-buyers only work if they sound calm: slow down, lengthen the stressed syllable and fall at the end (*let me **THINK** for a second* ♪). A rising, rushed filler sounds like panic. Dates in plans: American English says *May fourteenth* or *May fourteen*; British English says *the fourteenth of May*; both are fine.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Self-talk** (choral, quiet and slow, as if to yourself): "One mark each: guess, mark it, move on." · "The recording moves on; so do I." · "Overview first, then answer the question." · "It's a conversation, not an interrogation."

- 2 **Time-buyers** (choral, calm falling tone): "That's an interesting question ↘ — let me think for a second ↘." · "Sorry, could you repeat that? ↗" · "Do you mean at school ↗ or at work ↘?"
- 3 **Problem → plan** (individual, fast): T: "You can't find the answer to question 14." → S: "If I can't find it, I'll guess and move on." T: "You've written 180 words of Task 2 and there are 8 minutes left." → "I'll write a short conclusion right now." T: "You don't understand a Part 3 question." → "I'll ask the examiner to repeat it." T: "Your hands are shaking before Listening." → "I'll breathe out slowly, three times."

◆ FULL SPEAKING MOCK – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Real conditions.** Rearrange the room so pairs face each other across a table, as in the test. The examiner uses the examiner script word for word, including the opening ("Good afternoon. My name is... Can you tell me your full name, please?" — learners may give a new-identity name).
- ◆ **Timing (12 min per candidate):** Part 1, 3 min (two question cards, about six questions) → Part 2, 1 min prep + 2 min talk + one rounding-off question → Part 3, 4 min (the linked questions plus "Why do you think that is?") → 2 min: the examiner completes the band card silently, then gives two bands with evidence (the strongest and the weakest criterion) and one target. Swap.
- ◆ **Odd numbers:** make one trio with an observer who times and takes quotes; the observer is the candidate in round 3 if time allows, or does their mock with you during the countdown-plan stage.
- ◆ **You** walk the room and listen to every candidate for at least a minute, noting one strength per learner for the C16 debrief. If a candidate freezes, catch the examiner's eye and mouth "Next question," exactly as a real examiner would move on.
- ◆ **Afterwards:** ask "How did the nerves feel compared with C12? What helped?" Normalize: nerves are expected, and they fade with each rehearsal.

SAY: ICQs: *How long is the whole mock for each candidate? (About 12 minutes.) Does the examiner chat or help? (No: script only.) How many bands does the examiner say out loud? (Two: strongest and weakest.) Do you have to use your real name? (No.) If the candidate stops in Part 2 before two minutes, what does the examiner say? (Nothing at first; then once, "Can you tell me more?")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Test-day information is dense. Give these learners the **picture version** of the bring / leave cards and a **one-page timing card** with clock faces instead of text. For the countdown plan, let them fill the Workbook planner by choosing one activity per row from three you write on the board (*practice my weakest skill · a timed test · rest*). In the mock, they may have their **four-box note frame** for Part 2. Target: a countdown with real dates for the last four weeks, and a Part 2 talk that passes 90 seconds.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Strong learners risk **over-preparing the wrong thing**. Ask them to (1) analyze their Practice Test 1 errors by **error code** (the Module 2 codes, e.g. **P** paraphrase, **T** time, **S** spelling, **D** distractor, **F** False/Not Given) and build the countdown around the biggest category, not the weakest paper; (2) in the mock, be examined with **unscripted follow-up questions** in Part 3 ("Why?" "Is that true everywhere?" "What would happen if...?"); (3) write a one-paragraph test-day plan for a friend who is less prepared, using if-then structures.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Dates and times:** *on* + date (*on May 14*), *at* + clock time (*at 8:30*), *in* + month (*in May*). Spanish, Portuguese and French speakers often say "in the 14 of May"; Arabic and Farsi speakers may mix *in* / *on*; Chinese and Vietnamese speakers may drop the preposition.
- ◆ **Future with present simple** ("Tomorrow I study Reading," Spanish, German, Russian, Chinese): for plans, push *I'm going to* / *I'll*.
- ◆ **Word count habits:** learners from systems that reward long answers may think "more is always better" in Task 1. Remind them: 150+ words, but quality and an overview matter more than 250 words of detail.
- ◆ **Asking the examiner to repeat** feels rude in some cultures (many East Asian, South Asian and West African classrooms). Say it plainly: "Asking for repetition is normal and doesn't lower your score. Silence does more harm."
- ◆ **Ordinal numbers** in dates and on answer sheets: *twenty-first*, *thirty-second*. Spelling errors in Listening answers cost marks: *Wednesday*, *February*, *accommodation*, *environment*, *government*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_12.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. **Skip the full mini mock this week:** Practice Test 2 in C15–C16 replaces it. Instead, do the Speaking part only (a recorded Part 2, self-assessed). Look up your own test booking: format, center address, reporting time and the ID you registered with. Workbook 4.3: finish the countdown planner, "My new words" and the journal (your test date at the top, and "The one change with the biggest payoff for my band is ____, and this week I will ____").

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** The ID you registered with · Q2 **B** Paraphrasing · Q3 (new) **B** Ask the test center for a remark (an enquiry on results) within the allowed period. Listening (Ex 1): 1 registered with 2 reporting time 3 clear / label-free 4 locker 5 twenty / 20 6 forty / 40.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ complete the **Listening** and **Reading** sections of Practice Test 2 under test conditions and to time
- ◆ apply their timing plan (read ahead, about 20 minutes per passage, guess and move on, never leave a blank)
- ◆ use their test-day routine (desk set-up, breathing reset, self-talk) and notice what helps

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ [assessment/practice-test-2.html](#) : the Listening and Reading sections, one copy per learner, plus answer sheets if the test uses them · the Listening scripts or audio exactly as the practice test provides them
- ◆ Slide 17 · a large clock or countdown timer on the screen · spare pencils and erasers · a "Test in progress, please don't enter" sign for the door
- ◆ Exit slips (Workbook, Practice Test 2 page, box 1)

BOARD PLAN

Today: Listening (start __:__ · end __:__) → Reading 60 min (start __:__ · end __:__). Phones off and in bags. Pencil answers. Write answers on the answer sheet as you go in Reading: no extra time at the end.

Your plan: read ahead · predict the answer type · the recording moves on, so do I · ~20 min per passage · one mark each: guess, mark it, move on · never leave a blank.

C16: Writing 60 min + short speaking interviews + your band profile + celebration 🎉

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Settle & reset	2	T-S → S	Learners set out the desk as on test day: pencil, eraser, water, nothing else. Phones off and in bags. One breathing reset together (in for 4, out for 6, three times). "Today isn't a verdict. It's information."
Instructions & ICQs	2	T-S	Slide 17. Fill in the start and end times on the board. Read the practice test's instructions aloud. ICQs (below).
Listening	26	S	Run the Listening section exactly as the practice test directs : the reading-ahead pauses, each part heard once only , and its check or transfer time at the end. If you read the scripts aloud, read at a

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			natural pace, keep the pauses the test prints, and don't repeat or slow down on request (say kindly, "In the test it's once only"). Collect the Listening answer sheets or have learners turn them face down.
Reading	60	S	Hand out the Reading section face down; start the 60-minute timer on the screen. Announce the time at 40, 20, 10 and 5 minutes remaining, and nothing else. Answer questions about instructions only , never about content or vocabulary. At 60 minutes, "Pencils down." Collect everything, including question papers (they're used in C16). Hand out exit slips as learners leave (one line: "One thing that went better than Practice Test 1; one thing to look at").
Total	90		2 + 2 + 26 + 60

IF THE LISTENING RUNS LONGER THAN 26 MINUTES

The practice test's own timings come first. Don't shorten the Reading silently to make the class fit: five lost minutes can cost two or three answers and make the band profile misleading. Instead, ask the class at the end of C14 to **arrive five minutes early** so the settle-and-instructions stage happens before the official start. If you do have to shorten Reading, tell learners the new time before they start and write it on the score sheet, so the band isn't compared unfairly with Practice Test 1.

◆ RUNNING A FAIR TEST IN A COMMUNITY CLASSROOM

- ◆ **Conditions matter more than the room.** Quiet, spaced seats if possible, a visible clock, a sign on the door. If a learner arrives late, let them join the section in progress without catching up on missed Listening; note it on their paper so the result is read fairly.
- ◆ **Accommodations.** If a learner will have special arrangements on the real test day (extra time, enlarged print, a separate room), give them the same arrangements here and note it. If you suspect a learner needs arrangements they haven't requested, mention privately after class that test providers offer them and must be asked well in advance.
- ◆ **Distress.** If a learner becomes very upset, let them step out, and let them decide whether to continue or finish the section at home as untimed practice. Mark the paper "untimed" so it isn't read as a band. A practice test is never worth more than a person's wellbeing.
- ◆ **Marking.** Learners swap-mark Listening and Reading with the key at the start of C16. If you have time between classes, you can mark them yourself (40 + 40 answers are quick with the key) and use those 10 minutes in C16 for a longer debrief. Either way, check spelling rules from the key: in Listening and Reading, a misspelled answer is wrong.

SAY: ICQs: How many times do you hear each part of the Listening? (Once.) Can I ask what a word means during the test? (No: only questions about the instructions.) In Reading, is there extra time to copy answers at the end? (No: write them as you go.) Leave a blank? (Never: guess.) Where's your phone? (Off, in my bag.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

The test is the same for everyone: it has to be, or the band profile means nothing. Support comes before and after. Before: seat these learners where the clock and your voice are clearest, and remind them of the plan to guess and move on. After: in C16, sit with them while they mark and help them read the error pattern (often **time** and **long passages**, not understanding). If they didn't finish Reading, their band is still useful information: note the question number they reached.

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Strong learners who finish Reading early should **check the question types they found hardest in Practice Test 1** (often True/False/Not Given and matching headings), not leave early or stop working. In C16, ask them to classify every wrong answer by cause and question type: at band 7+, one question type often costs most of the lost marks.

◆ HOMEWORK

No new online lesson. Review online lesson 4.3 (https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/lesson_12.html), the Writing sections of lessons 3.1–3.3 (the Task 1 overview, the Task 2 structure) and your Writing error notes. Sleep well before C16: it's a 60-minute Writing test. Bring your workbook (the Practice Test 2 page) and your Diagnostic and Practice Test 1 bands if you have them.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ write **Task 1** (150+ words) and **Task 2** (250+ words) in 60 minutes, using their timing plan
- ◆ take a **short speaking interview** (Parts 1–3, shortened) with the teacher
- ◆ mark Listening and Reading with the key, convert raw scores to bands and complete a **band profile** beside the Diagnostic and Practice Test 1
- ◆ read their profile honestly and write **one next-step plan** to their test date
- ◆ celebrate what they have achieved in eight weeks

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ `assessment/practice-test-2.html` : the Writing tasks and the Speaking questions · `assessment/practice-test-2-key.html` : Listening and Reading answers, the raw score → band table, and the paraphrased Writing and Speaking criteria (one key per 2–3 learners for marking, or a projected copy)
- ◆ Lined paper, pencils and pens · the C15 answer sheets (returned for marking) · Slide 17 · a timer on the screen
- ◆ **C16 kit** (materials set G): interview schedule, **stop-clock slips**, **speaking band slips**, **band profile cards** · Workbook: Practice Test 2 page (band profile and next-step plan)
- ◆ A certificate of completion for each learner (the shared toolkit's certificate template) · optional: snacks and drinks brought by the class (check allergies and fasting)

BOARD PLAN

Writing (60 min): start __:__ · end __:__ · Task 1 about 20 min, 150+ words, overview! · Task 2 about 40 min, 250+ words, answer the question! · Called for your interview? Write your "out" and "back" times on your stop-clock slip. You get every minute back.

Then: mark Listening and Reading with the key → raw score → band → band profile → your next step → celebrate 🎉

Remember: a practice band is a snapshot, not a sentence. About half a band in eight weeks is a real gain. Compare yourself with **you**, not with anyone else.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Settle & instructions	3	T-S	Desk set-up and a breathing reset. Explain the interviews: "While you write, I'll invite you one by one to a short speaking interview in [the side area]. Write your 'out' and 'back' times on your stop-clock slip. You'll get those minutes back at the end." Show the interview order (alphabetical or random, never by level). ICQs.
Writing + speaking interviews	60	S · T-S (side area)	Writing: Task 1 and Task 2 from the practice test, 60 minutes. Announce the time at 40 minutes remaining ("You should be on Task 2 now"), 10 and 5. After the first 3 minutes (everyone started, no questions pending), begin the interviews : about 6 minutes each , one learner at a time, following the practice test's Speaking questions (see "How to run the interviews"). Fill in each speaking band slip immediately after the learner leaves (1 minute), then call the next.
Make-up time & marking	10	S · S-S	Learners who were interviewed use this time to finish their Writing (their stop-clock minutes). Everyone else swap-marks the C15 Listening and Reading sheets with the key, then checks their own. Convert raw scores to bands with the table in the key. Learners who were writing mark theirs at the start of the next stage or at home (the key's table is on the band profile card).
Band profile & debrief	6	T-S → S	Slide 17. Collect the Writing scripts. Learners fill in the band profile (Workbook, Practice Test 2 page): Diagnostic · Practice Test 1 · Practice Test 2 for Listening and Reading; your speaking band slip for Speaking; Writing "to follow." Say the four sentences on "How to read a band profile" (below). Then, silently: "Circle the skill that moved most. Circle the skill that matters most for your target."
Next-step plans	6	S → T-S (1:1)	Learners complete the next-step plan : target band and any minimum per skill, the gap, the one change with the biggest payoff , three specific weekly actions, and their test date (or "I'll book when..."). You move round and check each plan

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			for one concrete, weekly action, starting with learners whose profile shows the largest gap.
Celebration	5	T-S → S-S	Stand in a circle. Round 1: each learner says one thing they can do now that they couldn't in week 1 ("I can talk for two minutes," "I finish Reading on time"). Round 2: each learner writes a one-line good-luck message on a card for the person on their left. Present the certificates by name. Thank them.
Farewell	–	T-S	Tell learners when and how they'll get their Writing band and feedback (for example, by email within a week, or at a pickup session). Remind them the online course stays open for review. "Go and get the band you need."
Total	90		3 + 60 + 10 + 6 + 6 + 5 (farewell is part of the celebration)

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect the Writing time (a full 60 minutes, plus every interviewee's make-up minutes) and the celebration. The next-step plan can be finished at home if it must, but the **band profile debrief** must happen in class: nobody should read their numbers alone for the first time.

◆ HOW TO RUN THE INTERVIEWS

- ◆ **Format (about 6 minutes):** a short Part 1 (1½ min, three questions) → Part 2 (1 min prep + 1½–2 min talk, from the practice test's cue card; stop them politely at 2 minutes) → Part 3 (1½ min, two questions). You won't have time for the full 11–14 minutes. Tell learners so: the estimate is less certain than a full test.
- ◆ **How many fit?** With 6 minutes per interview and a minute to fill in the slip, about **eight interviews** fit into the Writing hour. With a larger class: (1) a trained co-teacher or volunteer runs a second interview area with the same questions and band card; (2) two or three more learners are interviewed during the make-up-and-marking stage; (3) anyone left gets a 10-minute slot just before or after class, or you use their **C14 full-mock bands** (peer-estimated) plus their recorded Part 2 homework, clearly labeled as such. Never cut the Writing time to fit interviews in.
- ◆ **Order.** Use a fixed order that doesn't signal anything about level (alphabetical by first name, or drawn at random in C15). Consider starting with a confident, relaxed learner so the room settles.
- ◆ **The stop-clock slip.** The learner writes the time they leave and the time they return. At the end of the Writing hour they write for that many extra minutes during the make-up stage. Check the slips as you

collect scripts.

- ◆ **Be the friendly examiner.** Use the practice test's questions and a neutral, warm manner. Don't correct or teach during the interview. As soon as the learner leaves, fill in the **speaking band slip**: a band per criterion (whole or half), an overall estimate given as a **range** (for example, "about 6.0–6.5"), one strength with a quote, and one next step. Paraphrased criteria are in the practice-test key and on the band card.
- ◆ **Trauma-informed:** use a new-identity name without comment if a learner gives one, and skip any Part 1 question a learner visibly doesn't want to answer ("Let's talk about something else: what do you do in your free time?").

SAY: ICQs (before Writing): How long for Writing? (60 minutes.) Which task is worth more? (Task 2.) When I call your name, what do you write on your slip? (The time I leave and the time I come back.) Do you lose those minutes? (No, you get them back at the end.) How long is the interview? (About six minutes.)

◆ HOW TO READ A BAND PROFILE (SAY THIS, KINDLY)

- ◆ **"This is a snapshot, not a sentence."** The same person can score half a band higher or lower on a different day. Look at the **trend** across Diagnostic, Practice Test 1 and Practice Test 2, not one number.
- ◆ **"Half a band in eight weeks is a real gain."** Many learners improve by about that much in a course of this length; some improve more, some hold steady while their technique improves and the band catches up later. Bigger jumps are possible but not guaranteed.
- ◆ **"Your overall band is the average of the four skills,** rounded to the nearest half band" (an average ending in .25 rounds up to the next half band and one ending in .75 rounds up to the next whole band). Check your target: many universities and professional bodies also set a **minimum for each skill**. One low skill can matter more than a high average.
- ◆ **"Compare yourself with you."** No one reads anyone else's profile. The only question is: what's your gap, and what's the one change with the biggest payoff?

Using the two practice tests diagnostically. Ask learners to look beyond the band. For Listening and Reading, list every wrong answer by **question type** (form completion, multiple choice, map or plan labeling, True/False/Not Given, matching headings...) and by **error code** (the Module 2 codes. Listening: **D** distractor · **S** spelling or plural · **W** word limit / wrong form · **N** number, letter or date misheard · **L** lost my place / froze · **P** missed the paraphrase · **X** transfer error. Reading: **P** · **M** word-match trap · **S** copied a word wrongly · **W** · **O** looked in the wrong place · **T** ran out of time / left a blank · **F** False vs Not Given · **K** own knowledge · **Q** missed a qualifier · **H** heading matched a detail · **X**). Compare with Practice Test 1: a question type that's wrong in both tests is the clearest target. For Writing and Speaking, compare criterion by criterion: a criterion that stays lowest across both tests is the "one change." The Workbook's Practice Test 2 page has a table for this.

Returning Writing bands. Mark the Writing scripts against the paraphrased Writing criteria in the practice-test key (Task Achievement / Task Response, Coherence & Cohesion, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range & Accuracy; Task 2 counts for more than Task 1). Return each script with a band estimate given as a range, one

strength, one next step, and one rewritten sentence of the learner's own as a model. If you promised email, send it within a week, while the next-step plan is still fresh.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Sit with these learners during marking and help with the raw score → band table (a ruler under the row helps). For the next-step plan, offer the **circle-the-option** version on the band profile card (three choices per box) and let them tell you their plan aloud while you or a peer write the key words. The celebration round can be spoken or shown (a thumbs-up card with a drawing is fine).

STRETCH (TOWARD BAND 7.5+)

Strong learners often look only at the lowest skill. Ask them to find the **cheapest half band**: which skill is closest to the next band boundary (raw score two or three marks short)? Ask them to set a plan that protects their strong skills (one maintenance session a week) while working on the weakest, and to write one sentence on what they'd do differently in the real test's first ten minutes.

◆ WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Comparing bands across the room:** learners may ask "What did you get?" Keep profiles private; the band profile card folds in half.
- ◆ **A lower band than Practice Test 1:** it happens, especially when a learner changed technique. Look at the question types together: often the new technique is working and one section went badly. Never say "you got worse."
- ◆ **"Should I cancel my test?"** Don't answer in class. Talk privately, look at the gap and the test date together, and offer options (keep the date and focus on the weakest skill; move the date if the provider's rules allow). The decision is the learner's.
- ◆ **Food at the celebration:** check allergies, dietary rules and fasting periods before anyone brings food. A celebration can be just words, certificates and good-luck cards.

◆ AFTER THE COURSE

Send (or hand out at a pickup session) the Writing bands and feedback. Point learners to the full online course for review (<https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/>), their workbook toolkit table and their countdown plan. If your program has a "results day," invite learners to come back and share their real results: it's the best motivation for the next group.

END OF C14: SPEAKING & TEST-DAY WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "say more, say it better, deliver it on the day": **answer + why + example · one minute of keywords, two minutes of talk · opinion → reason → other view** (say more) → **chunk, stress, fall at the end · the precise word, one natural idiom, paraphrase around a gap** (say it better) → **the timing plan · the right ID · breathe out slowly · guess, mark it, move on** (deliver it on the day). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you: use those notes when you write each learner's next step in C16.

What Practice Test 2 tells you. It's the course's second full set of evidence. Read it next to the Diagnostic (C1) and Practice Test 1 (C8): the **trend** is the finding, not any single band. Expect Listening and Reading to move most (strategy gains); expect Writing and Speaking to move more slowly (language gains), with Speaking often lifted by extension and fluency before accuracy catches up.

If you teach the course again: keep your three-column notes from C12–C14. The most common errors (*I am agree, since two years, people is, informations*) and the strategies that failed most often (the short Part 2, the reason-less Part 3) are the best warmers for the next group.